

“十二五”普通高等教育本科国家级规划教材

NEW HORIZON COLLEGE ENGLISH

第四版 FOURTH EDITION

新视野大学英语

总主编：郑树棠

读写教程 3

READING AND WRITING

思政智慧版

外语教学与研究出版社
FOREIGN LANGUAGE TEACHING AND RESEARCH PRESS

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前　言

党的二十大擘画了全面建成社会主义现代化强国、实现第二个百年奋斗目标的宏伟蓝图，指明了以中国式现代化全面推进中华民族伟大复兴的发展道路，从“实施科教兴国战略，强化现代化建设人才支撑”的高度，将教育、科技、人才进行统筹部署，并指出以高水平对外开放推动高质量发展，构建人类命运共同体。

面对新形势与新要求，我国高等教育必须全面贯彻党的教育方针，坚持为党育人、为国育才，全面提高人才培养质量，才能开拓教育新局面。作为高等教育的重要组成部分，大学外语教育应与时俱进，立足我国现代化发展全局，深化改革、探索创新，扎根中国、融通中外，为党和国家培养更多高层次国际化人才，讲好中国故事，传播好中国声音，为引领中国更好走向世界、世界更好了解中国作出新贡献。《新视野大学英语》（第四版）系列教材正是在这样的时代背景下设计编写而成。

《新视野大学英语》是一套根据国家高等教育教学质量要求和改革精神、针对全国普通高等院校非英语专业学生编写的通用英语教材。自 2001 年首次出版以来，以其独到的教学理念、创新的教学模式得到高校师生的广泛好评。为服务新时代国家战略发展需求，《新视野大学英语》编写团队认真学习最新政策文件，广泛收集教材使用反馈，持续进行系统的修订与完善。《新视野大学英语》（第四版）在继承原有特色的基础上，深入落实课程思政，全面优化教材设计，深度融合先进技术，进一步提升教材的思想性、科学性与时代性，体现我国高等外语教育发展的新趋势与新要求。

编写依据

《新视野大学英语》（第四版）以党的二十大精神为引领，以新时期高等外语教育改革和人才培养方向为指导，参照最新政策文件要求，通过先进的教学理念、科学的教学设计、数智化的教学手段，全方位支持大学英语教学，助推中国式教育现代化。

在教学目标上体现课程思政，落实立德树人根本任务

培养什么人、怎样培养人、为谁培养人是教育的根本问题。育人的根本在于立德。第四版教材全面贯彻党的教育方针，以落实立德树人根本任务为核心指导思想，深入践行《高等学校课程思政建设指导纲要》，内容设计寓价值塑造于知识传授和能力培养之中，致力于培养德智体美劳全面发展、堪当民族复兴大任的社会主义建设者和接班人。

在教学内容上实现工具性与人文性有机结合

第四版教材充分体现大学英语教育兼具工具性和人文性的特点，依据《大学英语教学指南（2020版）》“基础目标”和“提高目标”的教学要求进行设计，有机衔接《普通高中英语课程标准》和《中国英语能力等级量表》。教材编写遵循语言学习规律，着力培养学生英语听、说、读、写、译等语言技能，全面提高语言综合应用能力。同时，通过主题丰富、视角多元、语料真实的选材以及生动多样的活动设计，帮助学生在探索世界的过程中传递中国声音，提高跨文化交际能力和思辨能力，实现综合发展。

在教学理念上体现“以教师为主导、以学生为主体”

第四版教材依据“以教师为主导、以学生为主体”的教学理念，结合当代大学生的心理特征、学习特点与教师的教学需求，设计讨论式、探究式、项目式等学习活动，提供科学实用、深入浅出的策略讲解。上述设计既有利于学生锤炼语言、提升能力，进行自主学习和合作学习，也便于教师灵活指导，有效组织教学，启发学生深度思考，使教学活动真正调动“教”和“学”的双向主动性与积极性。

在教学模式上依托先进技术重构数智教学新生态

第四版教材依托全新升级的“U校园智慧教学云平台3.0”（以下简称“U校园3.0”），为教、学、测、评、研提供一站式教学解决方案。通过科学智能的教学管理平台、高效便捷的备授课工具、丰富立体的教学资源与无缝对接的多终端支持，推动院校更新教学理念、创新教学模式、重构教学流程，加快数字化转型；帮助教师将课内课外、线上线下有机结合，优化教学流程，丰富教学设计，同步开展教学研究，实现教研相长。灵活多样的学习资源满足学生在多模态环境下的个性化学习需求，优化学习体验，实现智慧学习。

教材特色

价值引领，深化课程思政

教材从主题设定、素材选择和活动设计等方面入手，全方位融入党的二十大精神与社会主义核心价值观，弘扬正能量，深化爱国主义、集体主义、社会主义教育，将价值塑造、知识传授和能力培养融为一体，以润物无声的方式帮助学生提升政治觉悟、思想水平、道德修养，树立正确的世界观、人生观、价值观，成为担当民族复兴大任的时代新人。

选材丰富，彰显中国文化

话题选材强调经典性、时代性与趣味性的结合，使学生在学习语言的同时，开阔视野、了解世界，探索人与自我、人与社会、人与自然的关系。教材多维度彰显中国文化，将社会主义先进文化、革命文化和中华优秀传统文化有机融入到选材、练习活动与单元任务中；不同分册还专设特色板块，集中呈现中国相关内容，帮助学生坚定文化自信，厚植爱国情怀。

因材施教，促进全面发展

在对大学生英语水平和大学英语教学现状广泛调研的基础上，教材优化主题内容，合理调整难度梯度，满足不同水平学生需求，同时注重培养多元能力，系统提升练习活动的丰富性、应用性与思想性。一方面，遵循语言学习的内在规律，提高常用词汇的覆盖率与复现率，确保语言技能讲解与训练环环相扣，既提供单项技能训练，夯实基础语言能力，也设置综合语言运用活动，引导学以致用。另一方面，活动设计注重思维培养，通过批判性问题启发学生深度思考、进行跨文化反思，通过场景真实的产出任务培养学生讲好中国故事以及解决实际问题的能力。

数智创新，赋能智慧教学

教材充分体现信息化时代的最新技术变革，通过完善的服务体系、先进的数字平台、优质的线上资源，智能驱动外语教学创新模式、提质增效。U 校园 3.0 实现升级迭代，完善备课功能，实现教学课件、试题库与其他教学资源的有效融通；优化授课与测评功能，提供灵活多样的授课工具与智能测评手段，多维度收集学生学习数据，支持完善的全景化数据分析，实现教评研一体化发展。教材还配备数字课程、微课视频、随身学、“外研 U 词”小程序和伴学数字人等丰富的学习资源与工具，助力学生主动学习、个性化学习，创新学习模式，提升学习效果。

教材构成

《新视野大学英语》（第四版）系列教材包含 1—4 级，供两个学年使用。每一级别包含《读写教程》（配教师用书）、《视听说教程》（配教师用书）、《综合训练》和《长篇阅读》。教材提供教学管理平台、数字课程、微课视频、移动学习应用、教学课件、试题库等立体丰富的教学资源。不同课程、不同媒介资源之间紧密联系，互为补充，共同构建立体化、个性化教学环境。

《读写教程》以价值塑造为导向，以夯实语言基础为核心，提供角度多元、内涵丰富的选篇以及循序渐进的练习活动，在着重提高学生读、写、译能力的同时，坚定理想信念，锤炼思维品质。新增 Stories of China 板块，集中展现中国在经济、社会、文化、科技与生态文明建设等方面的成就，培养家国情怀，提升民族自豪感。

《视听说教程》改编自培生教育出版集团的经典教材 *Speakout*，视听资源生动地道，文化信息丰富，交际场景真实，帮助学生在轻松愉快的学习氛围中提升听说能力和跨文化交际能力。特别增设 Listening to China 板块，引导学生讲好中国故事，传播好中国声音。

《综合训练》与《读写教程》紧密相联，对标学业考试最新要求，提供相关词汇、语法、阅读、翻译和写作等方面的练习，形式多样、可操作性强，助力学生巩固语言知识，提高语言能力。

《长篇阅读》通过科学训练，帮助学生掌握阅读策略，提高在快速阅读中获取、理解关键信息的能力。每单元新增一篇中国选篇，引导学生在阅读中了解中国，在思考中融贯中西。

使用建议

《新视野大学英语》（第四版）遵循“分类指导、因材施教”的原则，设置不同级别与不同分册，配备丰富立体的教学资源，为各校教学提供广阔的选择空间。第四版教材的编写基于对全国高校大学生英语水平和大学英语教学情况的调研，起点词汇约为3200词。覆盖的词汇有大学通用英语阶段应该掌握的词汇，尤其是搭配能力强、词义多重、使用面广的词汇，也有与学生专业学习或未来工作密切相关的词汇。中学阶段已经学过的重要词汇在教材中也有复现和巩固，体现语言学习必要的重复和循环。

认真学习《新视野大学英语》（第四版）1—3级，能够达到通用英语阶段的“基础目标”教学要求；学习1—4级，能够达到通用英语阶段的“提高目标”教学要求。院校可根据人才培养目标、课程设置方案以及学生起点水平，对教材进行个性化选择和灵活搭配。教师也可根据不同的教学目标和课时情况，自主选择教学材料、教学方法和教学模式，落实有效教学。

编写团队

《新视野大学英语》（第四版）教材总主编为上海交通大学郑树棠教授。来自上海交通大学、同济大学、中国人民大学、西北工业大学、郑州大学等全国数十所高校的几十名专家学者和中青年骨干教师参与了系列教材的设计与编写。

自本世纪初第一版出版以来，《新视野大学英语》始终不忘初心，担当使命，服务国家战略需求与高校外语教育发展。《新视野大学英语》（第四版）诞生于全面建设社会主义现代化强国的关键时期，教材坚持正确政治方向，落实立德树人根本任务，体现思想性与科学性相统一，力争更好地服务新时代高校大学英语教学改革创新，为广大师生打开新思路、开启新视野。欢迎各位专家、教师和同学在审阅与使用教材的过程中，多提宝贵意见，以使教材不断更新与完善。

编写及使用说明

《读写教程》是《新视野大学英语》（第四版）系列教材的主干教材之一。本教程充分考虑新时期国家人才需求以及当代大学生的学习特点和兴趣，以《大学英语教学指南（2020版）》为指导，对接《中国英语能力等级量表》，充分融合先进信息技术，帮助学生在夯实语言综合运用能力的基础上，锤炼道德品质和思维能力，落实立德树人根本任务。

编写重点

本教程在秉承第三版教材特色的基础上，对原有内容结构进行全面优化和调整，篇幅上适当减少，质量上进一步提升，整体设计更贴近当前大学英语教学改革需求。本次编写重点如下：

融合课程思政要求，落实立德树人

教材全方位、多维度融入党的二十大精神和社会主义核心价值观等关键议题。单元开篇即点明单元蕴含的思政要素，提炼并阐述选篇蕴含的价值观念和精神内涵，如爱国、富强、敬业、和谐、友善等。同时，教材将价值塑造有机融于话题素材、练习设计、思辨论点、单元任务之中，在润物细无声中达到立德树人的目的。

凸显中华文化元素，充满时代气息

教材在保留原有优秀内容的基础上，新增多个全新话题与选篇，生动体现当今时代发展与文明进步，特别反映中国在经济、社会、文化、科技与生态文明建设等方面的最新成就。每册均有数篇课文与中国紧密相关，涉及航天成就、英雄人物、智慧城市、新时代青年等。每单元单设阅读板块 Stories of China，集中讲述中国故事，帮助学生增强文化自信，厚植家国情怀。

合理调整教材内容，设计循序渐进

根据语言难度和认知规律，重新编排各册话题与选篇，调整阅读、写作、构词等技巧讲解的顺序和详略程度，确保梯度呈螺旋式上升。同时，语言练习和单元任务设计等紧贴学习需求，注重搭建脚手架，在夯实语言基础的同时，引导学生举一反三、学以致用，提高语言综合应用能力。

技术深度赋能教学，创新教学模式

对教材内容、教学平台和资源进行一体化设计，打造纸质教材与数字产品深度融合的新形态。基于U校园3.0，实现线上教学管理、课堂互动、智能评测、大数据分析等功能，推动教学提质增效。数字课程突出思政育人与思辨培养，提供丰富的微课视频与相关练习，实现价值观培养与语言能力提升。“外研U词”小程序为学生提供移动单词学习工具，支持随时随地背单词，拓展学习空间，提升学习成就感。

单元结构

《读写教程》设置 1—4 级，每级包含 6 个单元。每单元内容围绕特定主题展开，层层深入。单元结构具体如下：



Quotation

精选与单元主题相关的中外名言警句，凸显主题内涵。

Preview

由一段简洁生动的文字引出单元主题，点明单元蕴含的思政要素，同时以启发式的问题激发学生学习兴趣和深入思考。

Section A

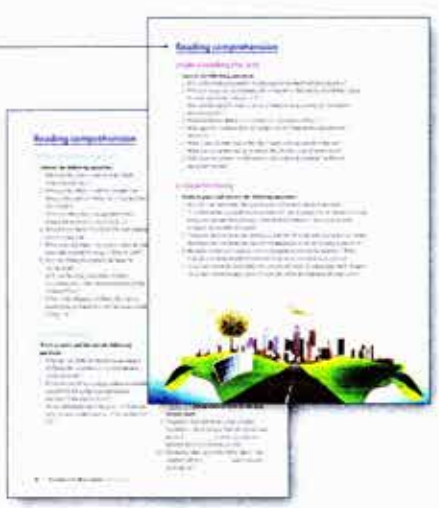
单元主要学习板块，包括一篇课文（Text A）、写作技巧讲解和相关练习。



Pre-reading activities

通过听力理解、图片讨论、调研问卷、信息匹配等生动有趣的活动，引出文章主题和思政要素，激活知识储备，为深入学习文章做好铺垫。

Reading comprehension



- Understanding the text 通过问答题的形式，剖析文章大意、重要细节以及作者写作手法、写作意图等深层信息，帮助学生由浅入深地领悟课文，全方位提高阅读理解能力。
- Critical thinking 围绕课文设置开放式问题，引导学生就主题内容和思政要素进行延伸讨论，培养探究能力和思辨能力。

Language focus

包括 Words in use、Word building、Banked cloze 和 Expressions in use。从词、句、篇章入手，通过多样的语言练习加强学生对核心词汇的理解和运用，并提供词汇学习策略指导，帮助学生掌握构词法，扩展词汇量。



Structure analysis and writing

包括 Structure analysis（结构分析）和 Structured writing（基于结构分析的写作练习），两部分互为依托，相辅相成。结构分析以 Text A 为范例，分析典型段落或篇章的结构特点；写作练习基于结构分析，辅以提纲和范文，训练和培养学生完成段落或篇章写作的能力。



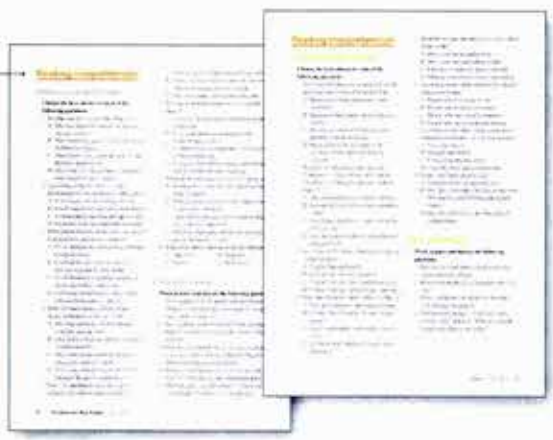
Section B

提供一篇课文（Text B）、阅读技巧讲解和相关练习。



Reading skills

以 Text A 为实例详细阐述阅读技巧，并通过 Text B 落实应用，侧重培养阅读技巧和策略，讲练结合，有效提升阅读能力。



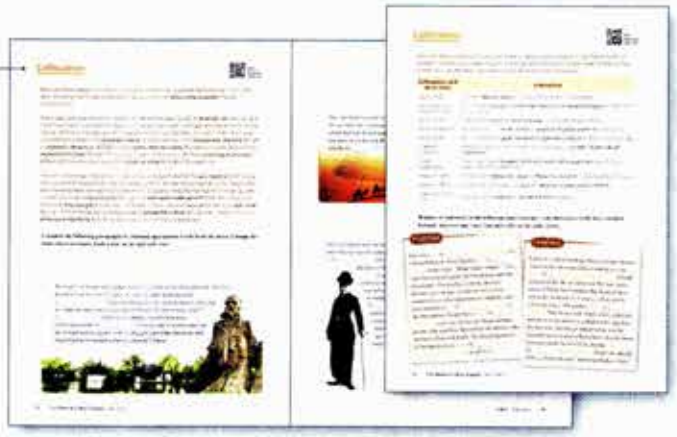
Reading comprehension

- Understanding the text 配合相关语言阅读能力测试，设置单项选择题，帮助学生对课文进行不同层次内容的理解。
- Critical thinking 同 Text A 相应部分。

Collocation

选取与主题相关的语篇素材，通过课文重点搭配讲解以及配套练习，帮助学生掌握核心、通用词汇的常用搭配，提高语言实际运用能力。

此外，学生可扫描二维码，在线上进行更多补充语言练习，加强对核心词汇、句型及语法点的训练。



Section C

集中呈现中国相关内容，包括一篇阅读短篇和一道翻译练习。

Stories of China

提供一篇中国内容的阅读短篇。题材生动时新、文本类型多样，既注重呈现新时代中国社会的发展成就和人民的精神风貌，如航空航天、清洁能源、乡村振兴等，也大力弘扬包括五四精神、京剧文化等在内的革命文化和中华优秀传统文化。学生可扫描二维码进行线上练习，领悟中国智慧，坚定文化自信。



Translation

翻译内容聚焦中国文化。1—2 级为句子翻译，各句之间主题相关，帮助学生提高对同类主题内容的翻译能力；3—4 级为段落翻译，确保难度循序渐进，切实提高学生的翻译和文化沟通能力。



Unit project

依据单元主题，设计口头汇报、写作、短剧等形式多样的综合性语言任务，特别加大中国情境下的交际任务比重。基于真实的情境设计、清晰的步骤指导，引导学生通过调研、信息搜索、讨论等方式完成交际任务，在培养创新思维、沟通能力和合作意识的同时，提高讲好中国故事、传播好中国声音的能力。



数字课程

《新视野大学英语》（第四版）数字课程依托U校园3.0，将自主学习、课堂教学与数字技术深度结合。通过微课视频、补充练习等丰富的学习资源，以及在线交互式课件、智能评阅引擎等全新升级的教学工具，全方位提升学习体验和教学效果，支持师生合力打造智慧课堂，开展智慧教学。

打造优质微课视频，纸数深度融合

提供优质的微课视频，包括单元导学、思政讲解和思辨指导三类，与纸质教材有机结合、相互支持。通过形式活泼、内容实用的讲解以及练习，导入单元话题，解读思政育人元素，传递中华文化思想精髓，同时进行正向思辨指导，培养学生正确分析、评价信息与观点的思维能力。

提供全新教学工具，提升教学效果

教学云平台新增在线交互式课件，教师可直接编辑并生成个性化在线教学课件，教学课件与平台的课中互动功能深度融合，创设师生高效互动、便捷协作的智慧课堂。数字课程引入写作智能评阅引擎，丰富评价方式，帮助教师高效检查作业，掌握学习动态，提升教学效果。

拓展学习模式与内容，推动自主学习

打造伴随学生学习的专属数字人“子言”，创设数字人导学、伴学、促学模式，为学生自主学习提供全流程指导，增强沉浸式学习的体验感。同时，通过设置词汇卡学习、补充拓展练习活动、提供单元测试题目，延展学习内容，构建以学生为中心的语言学习环境，推动学生自主学习。

《新视野大学英语》系列教材一贯秉承“以教师为主导、以学生为主体”的教学理念，为广大师生提供高质量、体系化、多类型的数字教育资源与工具。各校教师可结合实际教学需求，有选择地使用相关资源或工具，开展混合式教学，实现线上线下融合互动，以此推动课堂教学模式更新，有效提升教学效果，落实课程思政建设。

以下为《读写教程》数字课程单元结构示意图，以及混合式教学模式使用建议，供各校教师在教学实践中参考：


线上
学生在U校园观看单元导学微课，提前熟悉单元内容，激发学习兴趣
Unit preview
单元导学微课
Section A
线上
学生在U校园完成读前导入练习、交互式课文和词汇学习，并通过思政讲解微课及配套练习，初步理解思政元素
教师可在后台查看学生自主学习数据，掌握预习情况，为课堂教学作准备
Reading the text
Pre-reading activities 读前导入练习
Reading in detail 交互式课文学习
Chinese view 思政讲解微课及练习
Vocabulary learning 词汇卡学习
Reading comprehension
Understanding the text 课文理解练习
Critical thinking 思辨指导微课及练习
线下
教师课上讲解、剖析Text A重难点，启发学生进行深入讨论。同时可结合微课讲解思政要素、进行思辨指导，并引导学生完成相关练习
线上
学生在U校园完成语言练习
Language focus
教材配套语言练习
线上
学生在U校园学习结构分析讲解，完成写作任务，并通过写作智能评阅引擎，进行自动评分
教师可在后台查看智能评阅数据，了解学生写作的薄弱环节
Structure analysis and writing
Structure analysis 结构分析讲解
Structured writing 写作范文及练习
线下
教师课上进一步讲解结构分析及写作技巧，展示引擎评阅情况，并讲评学生作文
Section B
Reading skills
阅读技巧讲解与练习
线下
教师课上讲解阅读技巧，并引导学生完成练习
线上
学生在U校园完成交互式课文学习和词汇学习
Reading the text
Reading in detail 交互式课文学习
Vocabulary learning 词汇卡学习
Reading comprehension
Understanding the text 课文理解练习
Critical thinking 思辨练习
线下
教师课上组织学生完成Text B的理解练习和思辨练习
线上
学生在U校园完成语言练习和词汇搭配练习
Language focus
补充语言练习
Collocation
词汇搭配讲解与练习



编写团队

《新视野大学英语》（第四版）系列教材总主编为上海交通大学郑树棠教授。

《新视野大学英语（第四版）读写教程 3》主编为杨小虎和赵勇。参加编写的人员有杨小虎、赵勇、欧邦明、钟乐平、王胜利、李金满、谢都全。

《新视野大学英语（第四版）读写教程 3》由郑树棠教授审定全稿。

Map of the book

Unit	Section A		Section B
	Text A	Structure analysis and writing	Reading skills
1 **The digital age: Are we ready?** *p2*	Connection or conversation *p5*	Developing an argumentative essay *p14*	Following the structure of a text *p18*
2 **Life stories** *p30*	Zheng He, the great ancient Chinese explorer *p32*	Developing a biographical narrative essay *p41*	Distinguishing between facts and opinions *p44*
3 **Let's go** *p58*	The surprising purpose of travel *p60*	Developing a cause-and-effect essay *p69*	Reading with background knowledge *p72*
4 **When work is a pleasure** *p84*	Will you be a worker or a laborer? *p87*	Developing a comparison / contrast essay *p95*	Recognizing signal words *p98*
5 **China's space dream** *p110*	No limit for China's astronauts in their space exploration endeavors *p112*	Developing an exemplification essay *p120*	Identifying the sequence of events *p124*
6 **The economy: power behind everyday life** *p136*	Surviving an economic crisis *p138*	Further developing a cause-and-effect essay *p147*	Recognizing definitions in a text *p150*

	Section C	Unit project
Text B	Stories of China	
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Audrey Hepburn – a true angel in this world *p46*	Mei Lanfang – a Peking Opera legend *p54*	Writing a profile article *p56*
Traveling solo – a blessing overall! *p74*	Touring the world after 60 *p81*	Planning a three-day trip *p83*
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Economic bubbles: causes and conditions *p151*	The sharing economy turns a new page with books *p159*	Conducting an interview on Chinese college students' finances *p161*

Unit 1

The digital age: Are we ready?

Any sufficiently advanced technology is indistinguishable from magic.

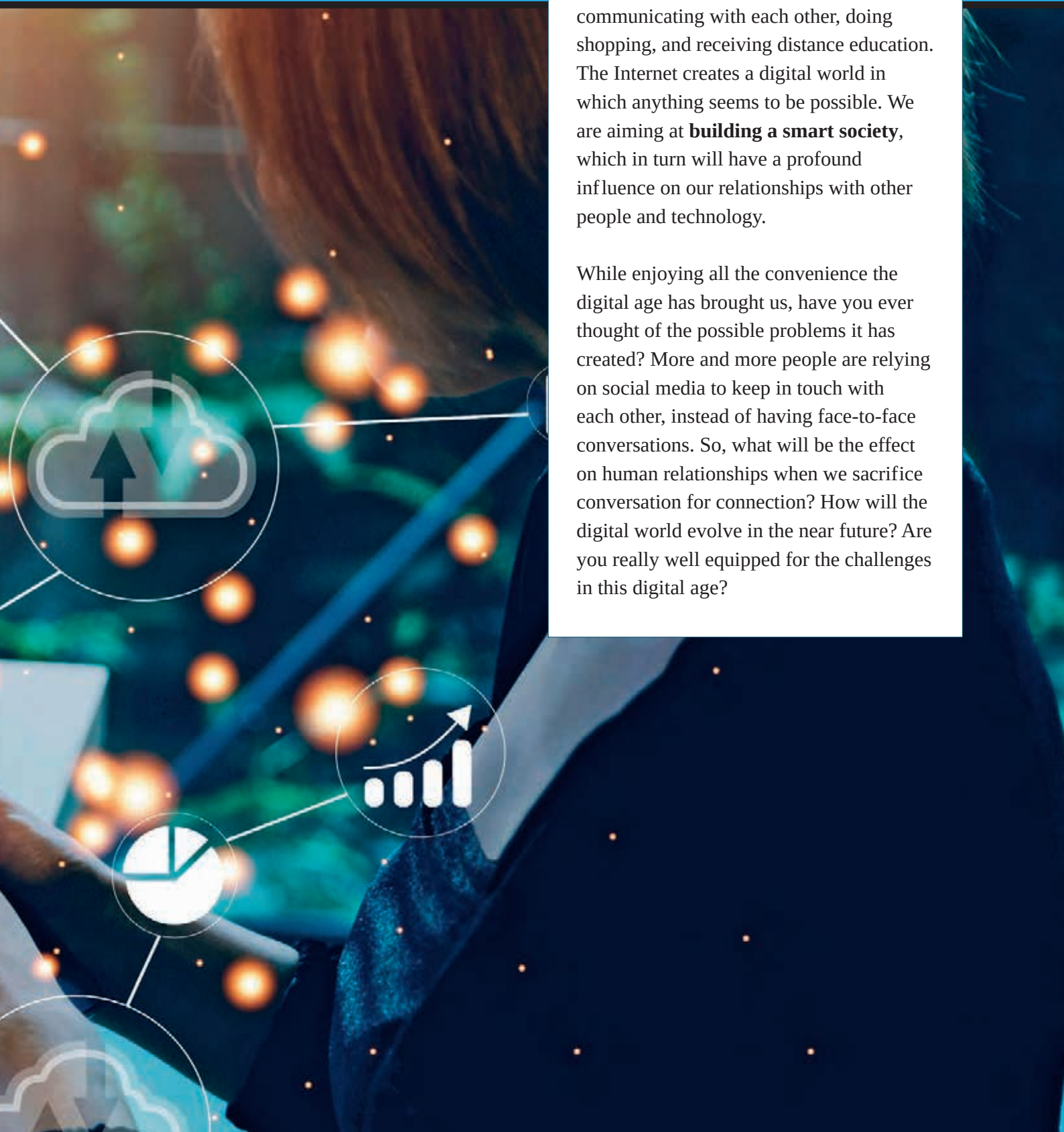
— Arthur C. Clarke (*British writer*)



Preview

The Internet has **changed our lives in almost every way possible**. We are connected online anytime and anywhere, communicating with each other, doing shopping, and receiving distance education. The Internet creates a digital world in which anything seems to be possible. We are aiming at **building a smart society**, which in turn will have a profound influence on our relationships with other people and technology.

While enjoying all the convenience the digital age has brought us, have you ever thought of the possible problems it has created? More and more people are relying on social media to keep in touch with each other, instead of having face-to-face conversations. So, what will be the effect on human relationships when we sacrifice conversation for connection? How will the digital world evolve in the near future? Are you really well equipped for the challenges in this digital age?



Section A

Pre-reading activities

1 Are you addicted to your smartphone? Rate each statement below and circle the score that represents your opinion to make an assessment.

1 = Strongly disagree	5 = Somewhat agree
2 = Disagree	6 = Agree
3 = Somewhat disagree	7 = Strongly agree
4 = Neutral	

1 I would feel uncomfortable without constant access to information through my smartphone.

1 2 3 4 5 6 7

2 I would be annoyed if I could not use my smartphone when I wanted to.

1 2 3 4 5 6 7

3 I would be scared if my smartphone ran out of battery.

1 2 3 4 5 6 7

4 If I did not have a data signal or could not connect to Wi-Fi, I would constantly check to see if I had a signal or could find a Wi-Fi network.

1 2 3 4 5 6 7

5 If I could not check my smartphone for a while, I would feel a desire to check it.

1 2 3 4 5 6 7

If I did not have my smartphone with me,

6 I would feel anxious because I could not instantly communicate with my family or friends.

1 2 3 4 5 6 7

7 I would be nervous because I could not know if someone had tried to get hold of me.

1 2 3 4 5 6 7

8 I would be nervous because I would be disconnected from my online identity.

1 2 3 4 5 6 7

9 I would be uncomfortable because I could not stay up-to-date with social media and online networks.

1 2 3 4 5 6 7

10 I would feel weird because I would not know what to do.

1 2 3 4 5 6 7

Now add up your score. The higher the score, the more likely you are to be addicted to your smartphone.

2 Work in pairs. Share your assessment result and discuss the following questions.

1 What impacts do you think smartphones have on your relationships with people around you?

2 What suggestions can you offer to those who are addicted to smartphones?



Text A

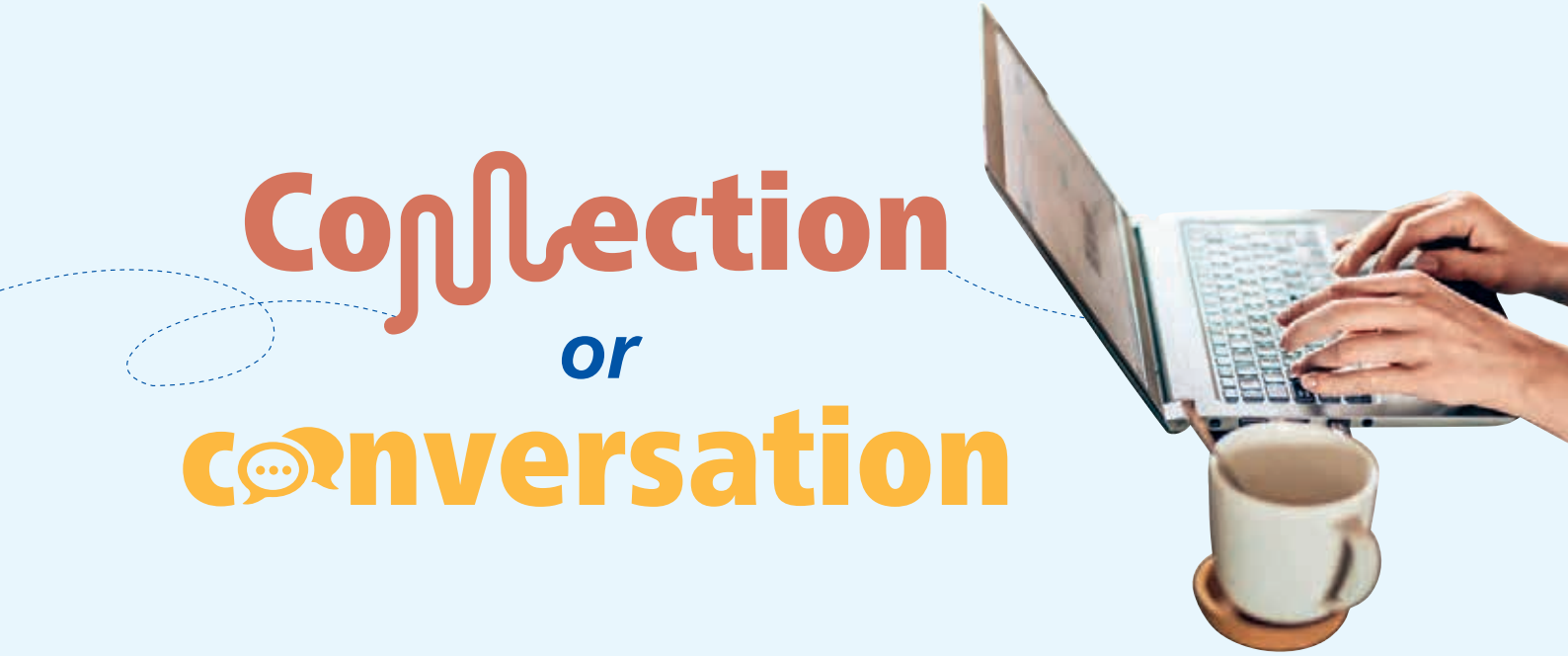
1 On a quiet Saturday afternoon, Paul and his wife Maria are sitting at home reading their favorite books. Opposite to where they sit are their two sons: 15-year-old Jason and 12-year-old Jack, absorbed in playing chess. What's the **scenario** here? The family calls it their "offline day". From Friday night through Sunday evening, there are no video games, no computers, and no cell phones.

2 In our "always on" lives, such a scenario of family **convention** seems gone. Are we too **immersed** in the brilliance of the digital world? Perhaps. We cannot seem to resist the **lure** of our cell phones, even when we are in the company of others. Apparently, we have sacrificed conversation for connection.

3 At home, families sit together, texting, and reading emails. At work, **executives** text during board meetings. We also text when we're on dates. Walking through a college library or the campus of a high-tech company, one sees an **identical** scenario: People are together, but each of them is in their own bubble, **furiously** connected to keyboards and tiny touch screens. The little **devices** most of us carry around are so powerful that they change not only what we do but also who we are.

4 It's true we've already become accustomed to a new way of being "alone together". Technology-enabled, we are able to be with one another, and also elsewhere, connected to wherever we want to be. We've been used to the idea of being in a **tribe** of one, loyal to our own party. In the silence of connection, we are comforted by being in touch with "invisible" friends and significant others, not too close, nor too far, just right.

5 A senior partner at a law firm describes vividly a scene in his office. Every morning, young



associates would first lay out their **suite** of technologies: laptops, **tablets**, and multiple phones. Then they would put their earphones on. “Big ones. Like pilots. They have **converted** their desks into **cockpits**,” he said. With the young lawyers sitting in their cockpits, the office becomes quiet, a quiet that does not ask to be broken. They have completely **plunged** into their virtual world.

6 As we can see, there is no limit to time and space in this digital world. Connection can be anytime and anywhere. Gradually, we’ve picked up a habit of **deletion** – wiping out rich human relationships. The move from conversation to connection, for example, is part of this. In fact, online connection is often a **deceptive** illusion in which we cheat ourselves, assuming we’re not alone. Worse, over time we’ll stop caring and forget there is a difference between online connection and face-to-face conversation.

7 We are tempted to think that our little “sips” of online connection add up to a big swallow of real conversation. No, they don’t. Even though all of these sips have their places – in politics, **commerce**, romance, and friendship, I would claim, no matter how valuable they are, it’s impossible for them to **substitute** for real conversation, where people exchange ideas and share viewpoints dynamically.

8 Yes, connecting in sips may work for gathering **discrete** bits of information, or for saying “I am thinking about you”, or even for saying “I love you”, but it’s far from the **adequacy** of communication when it comes to understanding and knowing one



another. Real conversation, on the other hand, is a more informative process, in which we're more caring and **observant**. We hesitate and pause and go silent, and we reveal ourselves to one another through tones and **nuances**.

9 While communicating on our digital devices, we unconsciously raise our expectations as well. As we increase the **volume** and **velocity** of online connection, we start to expect **acceleration** – faster answers. We ask one another simpler questions; we dumb down our communication, even on the most important matters. Face-to-face conversation, by contrast, unfolds slowly, so it teaches us patience.

10 In addition, our move from conversation means diminished opportunities to learn skills of self-reflection. These days, social media **continually** asks us what's "on our mind", but we have little motivation to say something truly self-**reflective**. Imagine how hard it is to do something with thousands of online friends! It is through the conversation with trusted others that we learn to **converse** with ourselves – to be honest with ourselves.

11 I'm not a **critic**, but I am a **partisan** for conversation. To make room for it, I see some first steps. At home, we can create "**sacred**" spaces for conversation while doing **domestic chores**: the kitchen, the dining room. We can make our cars a place free of little devices. We can be a **consultant** to our children through the demonstration of the value of conversation. At work, we can do the same thing. Employees asked for casual Fridays; managers may "**collaborate**" and introduce conversational Thursdays.

12 Although an "offline day" may be unbearable for tech **enthusiasts** who need to **alter** their habits, experts say it is beneficial to **assess** both the merit and **burden** of digital technology. Let's take some time away from the beeps and rings to evaluate our relationship with technology. Try to make some changes. At the beginning, it might be hard, but after a few months when a habit forms, we'll begin to realize we have already gained a lot from it. So, look up, look at one another, and let's start a conversation.

(*892 words*)

Culture notes

casual Friday (*also* **dress-down Friday**)**:** In some companies, employees are allowed to wear clothes that are more informal than usual on Friday. This day is known as a casual Friday.

New words

scenario /sə'nɑːriəʊ/ *n.* [C]

1 a situation that could possibly happen 可能发生的事；可能出现的情况

2 a written description of the characters, place, and things that will happen in a film, play, etc.（电影、戏剧等的）剧情梗概

▲ **convention** /kən'venʃən/ *n.*

1 [C, U] behavior and attitudes that most people in a society consider to be normal and right 习俗；惯例；常规

2 [C] a large formal meeting for people who belong to the same profession or organization or who have the same interests 大会；会议；集会

3 [C] a formal agreement, esp. between countries, about particular rules or behavior（尤指国际性的）公约，协定

immerse /ɪ'mɜːs/ *vt.*

1 (**~ oneself in sth.**): become completely involved in an activity 潜心于某事；专注于某事

2 put sb. or sth. deep into a liquid so that they are completely covered 使浸没（于液体中）

immersed /ɪ'mɜːst/ *a.* (**~ in**) 潜心于某事的；专注于某事的

lure /ljʊə/

n. [usu. sing.] sth. that attracts people, or the quality of being able to do this 诱惑物；诱惑力；吸引力

vt. persuade sb. to do sth., esp. sth. wrong or dangerous, by making it seem attractive or exciting 引诱；诱惑

▲ **executive** /ɪg'zekjətɪv/ *n.* [C] a manager in an organization or company who helps make important decisions（机构或公司的）主管，经理

▲ **identical** /aɪ'dentɪkəl/ *a.* exactly the same, or very similar 完全相同的；非常相似的

furious /'fjʊəriəs/ *a.*

1 (*usu. before noun*) done with a lot of energy, effort, or speed 猛烈的；强烈的；激烈的

2 very angry 狂怒的；暴怒的

furiously /'fjʊəriəsli/ *ad.*

1 猛烈地；强烈地；激烈地

2 狂怒地；暴怒地

▲ **device** /dɪ'vaɪs/ *n.* [C] a machine or tool that does a special job 设备；仪器；装置

tribe /traɪb/ *n.* [C]

1 a social group consisting of people of the same race who have the same beliefs, customs, language, etc., and usu. live in one particular area ruled by their leader 部落

2 a group of people with the same interests – used esp. to show disapproval（兴趣相同的）一批（人），一伙（多含贬义）

▲ **associate**

n. /ə'səʊʃiət/ [C] sb. who you work or do business with 同事；（生意）伙伴

vt. /ə'səʊʃieɪt/ make a connection in your mind between one thing or person and another 联想；联系

suite /swiːt/ *n.* [C]

1 a group of related things intended to be used together; a set（同类物的）系列，组，套

2 a set of rooms, esp. expensive ones in a hotel 套房（尤指酒店豪华套房）

▲ **tablet** /'tæblɪt/ *n.* [C]

1 (*also* **~ computer**) a small, flat computer that is controlled by touching the screen or by using a special pen 平板电脑

2 a small round hard piece of medicine which you swallow 药片

注：标▲单词为四级词，未做标记单词为六级词，斜体单词为超纲词。

▲ **convert** /kənˈvɜːt/ *v.*
1 (cause sb. or sth. to) change in form or character（使）转变；（使）转换
2 change to a new religion, belief, opinion, etc., or make sb. do this（使）改变（宗教、信仰、观点等）

cockpit /ˈkɒkˌpɪt/ *n.* [C] the area in a plane, small boat, or racing car where the pilot or driver sits（飞机、赛车的）驾驶舱；（小船的）座舱

▲ **plunge** /plʌndʒ/
v. (always + *ad.* / *prep.*) move, fall, or be thrown suddenly forward or downward（使）突然向前冲；（使）跌落
vi. (of prices, temperatures, etc.) decrease suddenly and quickly（价格、温度等）暴跌，骤降，突降

▲ **deletion** /dɪˈliːʃən/ *n.* [U] the action or process of deleting sth. 删除

▲ **deceptive** /dɪˈseptɪv/ *a.* likely to make you believe sth. that is not true 欺骗性的；误导的；骗人的

▲ **commerce** /ˈkɒmɜːs/ *n.* [U] the buying and selling of goods and services 买卖；贸易；商务；商业

▲ **substitute** /ˈsʌbstɪtjuːt/
v. take the place of sb. or sth. else; use sb. or sth. instead of sb. or sth. else（以…）代替；取代
n. [C] a person or thing that you use instead of the one that you usu. have, because the usual one is not available 代替物；替代品

discrete /dɪˈskriːt/ *a.* clearly separate 分开的；分离的；离散的

▲ **adequacy** /ˈædɪkwəsi/ *n.* [U] the quality of being good enough or great enough in amount to be acceptable 充分；足够

▲ **observant** /əbˈzɜːvənt/ *a.* good or quick at noticing things 观察力敏锐的；机警的

nuance /ˈnjuːɑːns/ *n.* [C] a very slight, hardly noticeable difference in manner, color, meaning, etc.（方式、颜色、意义等的）细微差别

▲ **volume** /ˈvɒljuːm/ *n.*
1 [C, U] the amount of sth. 量；额
2 [C, U] the amount of space that an object or a substance fills; the amount of space that a container has 体积；容积；容量
3 [U] the amount of sound produced by a television, radio, etc. 音量；（音）响度

velocity /vəˈlɒsəti/ *n.* [C, U] the speed at which sth. happens or moves 速度

▲ **acceleration** /əkˌseləˈreɪʃən/ *n.* [sing., U] a process in which sth. happens more and more quickly 加快；增速

▲ **continual** /kənˈtɪnjuəl/ *a.* (*only before noun*)
1 repeated many times, often in a way that is harmful or annoying 多次重复的，频繁的（往往有害或恼人）
2 continuing for a long time without stopping 持续的；不间断的

continually /kənˈtɪnjuəli/ *ad.*
1 频繁地
2 持续地

▲ **reflective** /rɪˈflektɪv/ *a.*
1 thinking quietly about sth. 沉思的；深思的
2 a reflective surface reflects light（物体表面）能反光的

▲ **converse**
vi. /kənˈvɜːs/ (*fml.*) have a conversation with sb. 谈话；交谈
n. /ˈkɒnvɜːs/ [sing.] (*fml.*) (**the ~**) the opposite or reverse of a fact or statement 相反的事物；（事实或陈述的）反面

▲ **critic** /ˈkrɪtɪk/ *n.* [C]
1 sb. who criticizes a person, organization, or idea 批评者
2 sb. whose job is to make judgments about the

good and bad qualities of art, music, films, etc.（艺术、音乐、电影等的）评论家，批评家

partisan /ˌpɑːtɪˈzæn/
n. [C] a person who strongly supports a particular leader, group, or idea 坚定的支持者；铁杆拥护者
a. strongly supporting a particular political party, plan, or leader, usu. without considering the other choices carefully（对某个政党、计划或领导人）偏袒的，盲目支持的

sacred /ˈseɪkrɪd/ *a.* very important or greatly respected 很重要的；神圣的；深受尊重的

▲ **domestic** /dəˈmestɪk/ *a.*
1 (*only before noun*) relating to family relationships and life at home 家庭的；家事的
2 relating to or happening in one particular country and not involving any other countries 国内的；本国的

▲ **chore** /tʃɔː/ *n.* [C] a small job that you have to do regularly, esp. work that you do to keep a house clean 家庭杂务；日常琐事

▲ **consultant** /kənˈsʌltənt/ *n.* [C] sb. whose job is to give advice on a particular subject 顾问

▲ **collaborate** /kəˈlæbəreɪt/ *vi.* work together with a person or group in order to achieve sth., esp. in science or art（尤指在科学或艺术方面）合作，协作

▲ **enthusiast** /ɪnˈθjuːziæst/ *n.* [C] sb. who is very interested in a particular activity or subject 热衷者；爱好者；热心的人

▲ **alter** /ˈɔːltə/ *v.* change, or make sb. or sth. change（使）变化；（使）改变

▲ **assess** /əˈses/ *vt.*
1 make a judgment about a person or situation after thinking carefully about it 评价；评定
2 calculate the value or cost of sth. 对…估价；估计…的成本

▲ **burden** /ˈbɜːdn/
n. [C] a duty, responsibility, etc. that causes worry, difficulty, or hard work（义务、责任等的）重担，负担
vt. **(be ~ ed with / by sth.)** have a lot of problems because of a particular thing 被某事物所困扰；承受某事物的负担

Phrases and expressions

plunge into sth. enter earnestly or wholeheartedly into some activity or situation（认真而专注地）开始从事，投身于

pick sth. up learn a new skill or start a habit without intending to（无意间）学会（新技能）；开始养成（习惯）

wipe sth. out destroy, remove, or get rid of sth. completely 彻底毁灭；勾销；去除

add up to sth. produce a particular total or result 总数是；结果是

dumb sth. down present news or information in a simple and attractive way without many details so that everyone can understand it – used to show disapproval（为使大家能够理解而）降低…的标准，使…简单化（含贬义）

make room for sb. / sth. provide space for sb. or sth. 为…提供空间

Proper names

Maria /məˈriːə/ 玛丽亚（人名）
Jason /ˈdʒeɪsən/ 贾森（人名）

Reading comprehension

Understanding the text

1 Answer the following questions.

1 What activities are the family not allowed to do on their "offline days"?
2 According to Para. 3, to what extent are we influenced by the little devices most of us carry around?
3 What does the author think of the idea that our little "sips" of online connection will substitute for real conversation?
4 According to Para. 8, what can we do in real conversation but cannot in online connection?
5 What can a face-to-face conversation teach us?
6 What can we learn from the conversation with trusted others?
7 What is the author's attitude toward conversation?
8 What is the author's suggestion for evaluating our relationship with technology?

Critical thinking

2 Work in pairs and discuss the following questions.

1 Do you believe people can truly get to know each other simply via online communication? Why or why not?
2 What impact does social media have on people's social skills?
3 How do you think technology will change communication in the future?

Language focus

Words in use

3 Fill in the blanks with the words given below. Change the form where necessary. Each word can be used only once.

alter assess collaborate
discrete furious immersed sacred
scenario substitute velocity

1 He entered the film industry, taking small roles and writing _____ for a famous film company.
2 In doing translation, one should not _____ the meaning of the original to suit one's own taste.
3 Without warning, there was a(n) _____ storm and the waves swept over the boat.
4 Doctors consider it their _____ duty to protect and save the lives of their patients.
5 The question was how to maintain that kind of _____ for a vehicle that weighed considerably more than 3,300 pounds.
6 They are able to take _____ ideas, thoughts, and generalizations and weave them into meaningful patterns.
7 They needed someone to _____ for a pianist who couldn't make it, and her professor recommended her.
8 Let's embrace Chinese culture this summer and get _____ in the richness of traditional Chinese music and dance!
9 The Chinese scientific community will _____ with their international peers in frontier science research.
10 At the end of the semester, students will be _____ on their proficiency in writing and speaking in English.

Word building

-ance

与某些动词结合构成名词，表示相关的行为、状态或过程。

attend	attendance
endure	endurance
perform	performance
admit	**admittance**
assure	**assurance**
clear	**clearance**
dominate	**dominance**
rely	**reliance**

-ed

及物动词的过去分词常可用作形容词，表示事物已受到相应影响。一些不及物动词的过去分词也可作形容词，表示某人或某物已完成某事。

assure	assured
excite	excited
involve	involved
distract	**distracted**
retire	**retired**

注：粗体单词为本单元新学派生词。

4 Fill in the blanks with the words given below. Change the form where necessary. Each word can be used only once.

admittance assurance clearance
distracted dominance
reliance retired

1 The _____ of the Internet and mobile devices means that anything that can be used effectively with them is likely to be a success.
2 Younger children may have problems paying attention in class, and would easily get _____.
3 The competitive entrance examination for _____ to this university was such that hundreds of applicants were turned down each year.
4 My dad is _____ and decides to devote his leisure time and energies to his passion: painting.
5 Too much _____ on teachers telling them what to do next might hinder the development of children's independent thinking.
6 Investors need _____ that the risk taken by the company is acceptable to them.
7 The careless _____ of trees could cause economic damage through degradation (退化) of the soil.



Banked cloze

5 Fill in the blanks by selecting suitable words from the word bank. You may not use any of the words more than once.

A	anticipate	**F**	diminishes	**K**	mutual
B	approval	**G**	furnishes	**L**	obsession
C	attain	**H**	immersed	**M**	removal
D	concentrate	**I**	lure	**N**	scenario
E	continual	**J**	maintain	**O**	succession

Through online interactions, young people can share ideas, acquire information, and be exposed to many opportunities out there. Social media gives them the avenue to make new friends and allows them to 1) _____ contact with their old friends.

However, too much social media also leads to addiction. We are quite familiar with the 2) _____ of people sitting next to each other, not talking, but just staring at their phones. Young people are more likely to be 3) _____ in social media rather than spend time with their families and friends. They may check their social media accounts first thing in the morning and check social media updates last thing before going to sleep. With too many distractions, they cannot fully 4) _____ on their tasks.

Social media also leads to 5) _____. Some people are crazy about likes and comments and they will do anything to get them on a daily basis. Everything they do, they want to post on social media to get some form of 6) _____ from strangers. They work tirelessly to buy the latest clothes, eat expensive meals, and visit unusual places, just for a show. They even do things that they would never do in real life just to impress people. Since they cannot get the same popularity in real life as they do in social media, they yield to the 7) _____ of social networks. However, many of them live in 8) _____ fear of being less popular. Everything falls apart when their popularity really 9) _____, and they may even get into serious psychological problems.

The creators of social networks perhaps did not 10) _____ that their creations would bring these problems. Doing away with social media may not be practical, but some form of regulation should be put into place to ensure that people can really benefit from the technology.

Expressions in use

6 Fill in the blanks with the expressions given below. Change the form where necessary. Each expression can be used only once.

add up to dumb … down
in the company of lay … out make room for
pick … up plunge into wipe … out

1 The cheerful guy who wore virtual reality glasses _____ the virtual world.
2 It has been the tradition in China that elderly people live in a familiar environment, preferably _____ their children.
3 Chinese isn't a subject that can be _____ in a month, and you can't accomplish your goal of mastering the language unless you work at it for years.
4 He _____ the map across the table and took another look at it.
5 The live music, the wild dancing, and the amazing lights all _____ an exciting theatrical experience.
6 Since space is limited, we sometimes have to say goodbye to old things in order to _____ new items.
7 The magazine has a reputation for being very thorough, although critics claim that it has been _____ in recent years to cater to the mass market.
8 This marks another historic step toward _____ the absolute poverty that has plagued the nation for centuries.

Structure analysis and writing

Structure analysis

Developing an argumentative essay

In writing an argumentative essay, the writer attempts to make a strong argument for or against a controversial point or defend a position on which there is a difference of opinion. Generally, the writer starts by stating a position on an issue, and then gives reasons, supported by evidence, for agreeing with that position. In this unit, you will learn about the typical structure of an argumentative essay and some specific tips on how to write it.

A good argumentative essay may follow the following structure:

1 **Introduction:** The first part of your essay should introduce the topic with a brief explanation of it, some background information, and a thesis statement. Your thesis is a statement of your position on a specific controversial topic, and it should be a concise, one-sentence summary of your main point or claim.
2 **Body:** This part usually comprises several paragraphs that explain the reasons why you support your thesis. Each paragraph should explain a different idea or give a different piece of evidence. You could use the patterns of development such as exemplification, comparison / contrast, and cause / effect that have been talked about previously.
3 **Refutation / Opposition (optional):** You can also address opposing points of view and explain why you disagree with them. Considering a topic from different angles adds credibility and helps you gain the reader's trust.
4 **Conclusion:** In this part, you should restate your thesis and summarize what has been discussed in your body paragraphs. Rather than introducing new facts or more arguments, a good conclusion appeals to the reader's emotions. In some cases, you may include a call for action. By inspiring the reader to agree with your argument, you can tell them what they need to think about, do, feel, or believe.

The structure can be best illustrated by Paras. 7-11 of Text A as a mini version of an argumentative essay, as is shown on the next page.

Introduction (Para. 7)

Controversial argument:

We are tempted to think that our little "sips" of online connection add up to a big swallow of real conversation.

↓

Thesis statement:

I would claim, no matter how valuable they are, it's impossible for them to substitute for real conversation, where people exchange ideas and share viewpoints dynamically.

Body (Paras. 8-10)

Connecting in sips is far from the adequacy of communication when it comes to understanding and knowing one another.	In online communication we unconsciously raise our expectations. We start to expect acceleration – faster answers.	Online communication means diminished opportunities to learn skills of self-reflection.
↕	↕	↕
Real conversation is a more informative process, in which we reveal ourselves to one another through tones and nuances.	Face-to-face conversation teaches us patience.	Conversation with trusted others helps us learn to converse with ourselves – to be honest with ourselves.

Conclusion (Para. 11)

Restatement of the thesis statement:

I'm not a critic, but I am a partisan for conversation.

↓

Call for action:

To make room for it, I see some first steps.

Structured writing

Read the sample essay and see how the essay is structured.

Topic
Is big data a good thing?

Introduction
Controversial argument: Big data will invade people's privacy and we should ban the use of it.
Thesis statement: We should not ban the use of big data, for big data can benefit people in many ways.

Body
Supporting point 1: People can use big data to improve their lives.
Supporting point 2: Companies can use big data to improve their operations and services.
Supporting point 3: The government can use big data to improve its management efficiency.
Refutation / Opposition: The concern about the invasion of people's privacy is overstated.

Conclusion
Big data is playing a more and more important role in our society.

Big data is changing people's lives in ways they could have never imagined. Some people worry that big data may invade their privacy and urge that we should ban the use of it. However, from my point of view, we should not ban the use of big data, for big data can benefit people in many ways.

First, people can use big data to improve their lives. With the help of big data, they can have a better understanding of their health and thus make some improvements. Through analysis, big data knows a lot about people's tastes in music, movies, shopping, or even travel, and it can help them make the proper choice whenever they need to.

Second, companies can use big data to improve their operations and services. Based on big data analysis, they can refine their marketing, cut unnecessary costs, and better use their resources. They can also develop better business strategies, and be more responsive to customers' wants and needs.

Third, the government can use big data to improve its management efficiency. Take emergency responses, for example. In stopping the spread of a pandemic, the government, relying on the analysis of big data, is able to take control of the whole situation and make feasible plans to deal with the various problems it has to face.

Some people may worry about the invasion of people's privacy and see big data as a monster. In fact, this concern has been overstated. Lawmakers have already taken that into consideration and new laws have been passed to protect people's privacy and ensure their security in using big data. So there's no need to be too worried about it.

To conclude, big data is playing a more and more important role in our society. As long as we can keep a close watch on it, big data can help build a better life for all.

7 Write an essay of no less than 140 words on one of the following topics. One topic has an outline that you can follow.

Topic
Is smart technology making us dumb?

Introduction
Controversial argument: Smart technology is damaging our cognitive abilities and making us dumb.
Thesis statement: Smart technology is actually making us smarter.

Body
Supporting point 1: Smart technology helps us become more knowledgeable.
Supporting point 2: Smart technology helps us learn better.
Supporting point 3: Smart technology helps us be more innovative.
Refutation / Opposition: People worry that smart technology is making us dumb, but this is not true and not supported by scientific evidence.

Conclusion
Smart technology is changing our lives and benefiting us in positive ways.

More topics
- Will AI (artificial intelligence) cause mass unemployment?
- Should parents monitor their children's use of the Internet?

Section B

Reading skills

Following the structure of a text

The structure of a text, which helps to fulfill the author's purpose in writing, refers to the internal pattern of organization of a text. There is considerable evidence that knowing how a text is organized influences the comprehension of the text. Readers who are familiar with the structure of a text expect the information to unfold in certain ways, and they can better recognize the author's purpose and follow the author's ideas efficiently.

In this unit, you will learn how to follow the text structure to facilitate reading comprehension. Generally, most texts contain structural elements that the author uses to arrange and connect ideas. Structural elements in texts vary. It is important to get to know various text structures, which mainly include the following ones.

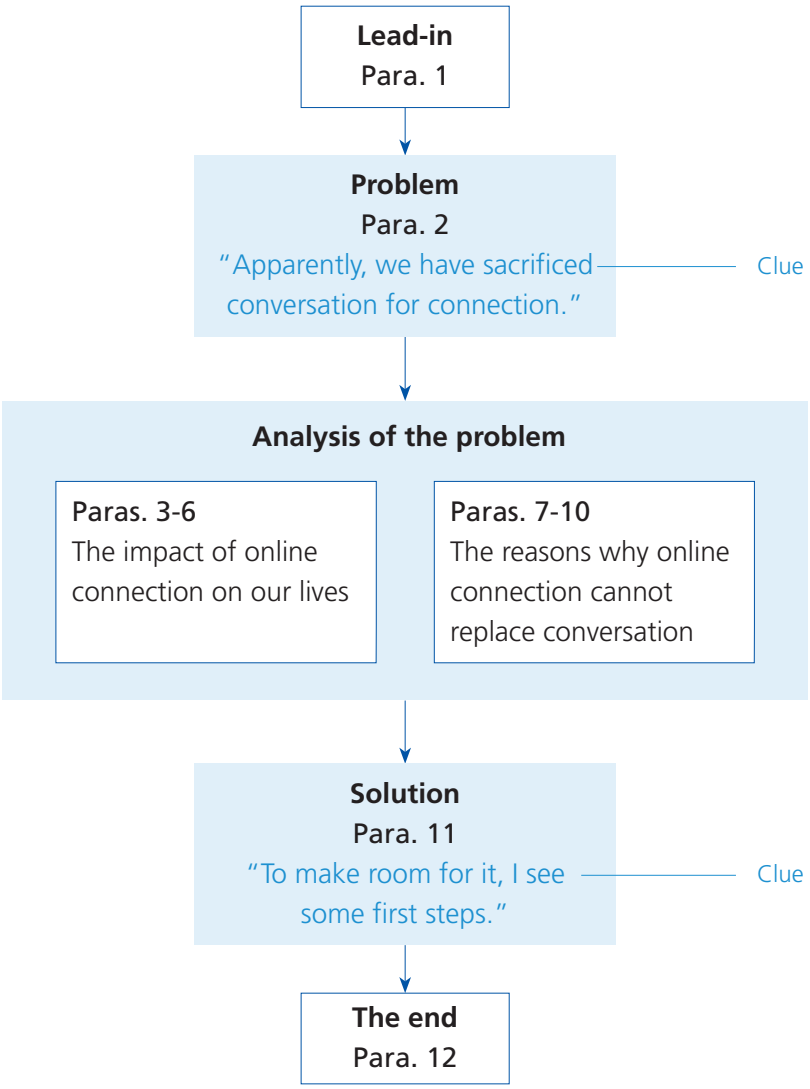
- **Description:** The author describes a topic.
- **Sequence:** The author lists items or events in numerical or chronological sequence, either explicitly or implicitly.
- **Comparison / contrast:** The author compares and / or contrasts two or more related events, topics, or objects that are alike and / or different.
- **Cause / effect:** The author explains one or more causes and / or describes effects.
- **Problem / solution:** The author raises a problem and then offers solutions.

The ability to identify and analyze these text structures helps you to comprehend the text more easily by understanding how one paragraph relates to another and to the whole text. So it is important that you be able to identify the clues which indicate text structures, and have a clear picture in your mind for each structure.

Take Text A, for example. Para. 1 starts with the description of a family "offline day", which serves as an attention-getter in the text. The purpose of the attention-getter is to grab the reader's attention and give them some context of the text. At the end of Para. 2, the concluding sentence "Apparently, we have sacrificed conversation for connection" is actually introducing the problem that echoes the title of the text "Connection or conversation". From Para. 3 on, detailed description of how serious the problem is in our family, on campus, and in the office unfolds step by step to show us the drawbacks of online connection in our lives.

If you are familiar with the text structures introduced above, you will naturally infer that this could be a problem / solution text structure. To test whether it is true, you could just follow the text with this judgment in your mind. In Para. 11, you read the sentence: "To make room for it, I see some first steps." This is when you are assured that the solution is finally going to be offered.

Using a graphic organizer to illustrate the structure is another important way to help you better understand a text. Let's take Text A as an example.



1 As you read Text B for the first time, try to figure out its text structure after reading the first several paragraphs with the help of the signal words that you have spotted. Then read the whole text and draw a graphic organizer of it. Compare your graphic organizer with your partner's to see if both of you understand the author's writing purpose in the same way.

Text B



Living in the digital

1 The technological advances that arrived in a swift fashion in the mid-1990s have reshaped the very fabric of society, and modern technologies have attracted various population groups in different areas. It is no exaggeration to say that technology has impacted upon the lives of everybody, in one way or another. However, this is often quite **subliminal** and somewhat **ironic** given the bold nature of the **imposition** of digital technology on our lives. It's true that the digital world has changed our lives in almost every way possible.

2 To start with, do you still remember the days when teachers used chalk, **dusters**, and blackboards? They are almost never used today. Black has turned white, in the form of **interactive** whiteboards. To go one step further, the days of children having to carry a bag with printed books will probably be a distant memory in the future. With the **advent** of the age of the tablet, they are starting to use the impressive electronic devices to read e-books. More importantly, schools now come equipped with Wi-Fi or **broadband** to ensure instant Internet access for study and research purposes.

3 Likewise, how often do you see children playing games on a smartphone, laptop, or mobile game device of one kind or another? Probably more often than you see them playing outside with their friends. Children of the modern age are incredibly tech **savvy**, my goodness, almost from the time they learn to talk. They don't have to learn how to use technology but are able to be informed, keeping **abreast** of the latest technological developments, because technology is simply a part of who they are. They grow up with it, they know it, and they cannot survive without it.

4 Dramatic changes can also be felt at home. As the modern family is busier than in the past, **hectic** family life seems dominated by all-things-convenient. Luckily, cooking is now made easy and a lot quicker thanks to hundreds upon hundreds of cooking apps, online **recipes**, how-to-cook videos, etc. Quite **literally**, technology has made cooking accessible and enjoyable to all. Furthermore, the days of battling other **siblings** for rights of the sole TV in the living room have gone and become a thing of the past. Now, children have their own laptop on which to watch their choice of TV shows, movies, videos, etc.

5 Then how about our workplace? Nearly a decade ago, one had to sit in the office all day long. Not so now though! Many companies, whether **headquarters** or **affiliates**, actively encourage working from home, and this is becoming more and more common as employers realize that employees do not require round-the-clock **monitoring** in the completion of their daily tasks. In addition, technology has led to the widespread use of online video

world

conferences; as a result, colleagues are no longer obliged to even meet in a face-to-face environment, removing yet another element of the business **arena** of old.

6 **Aligned** with this fashion of convenience is our leisure. In the past, holidays were **invariably** booked through **travel agents** or a **dedicated** provider, based upon their sales skills and packages together with **brochures**. Sometimes, the most unappealing destination could be made to look like a **luxurious** five-star resort. Now, people are a lot more **discerning**, thanks to the abundance of online booking **sites** and online reviews of every leisure facility the world over. We search the Web to find the cheapest flights and avoid extra charges. We also book **accommodations** based upon our requirements and check out exactly what we will do before we even arrive!

7 In the everyday **practicality**, digital technology has also established its **credibility** in changing our old-fashioned personal life. While we used to stand in line at the bank during our lunch break, now we perform most of our banking online, mainly **via** our smartphones. While we formerly walked to the shop to buy the daily newspaper, now we can access news sites worldwide and download news apps at the touch of a screen. While we used to head to the video store to choose the latest release, now we can download movies online at the click of a mouse. While we used to play simple, yet wonderful, **console** games, now we can play them through the Internet against people from all around the world.

8 When it comes to social life, there are now so many social platforms cropping up that it's difficult to keep up with them. It's somewhat funny, though, that our social life is kind of **akin** to "emotional **blackmail**". Even those who have desperately tried to **evade** all things social have found it's simply impossible to avoid. Today people are more engaged in connection than conversation. Social media has become an essential part of life and a place for people to catch up with existing friends, rekindle friendships from the past, or meet new people from **overseas** …, because they can.



9 As we can see, the digital revolution has changed our lives to such an extent that the way we exist as a civilization has almost completely altered with no point in history for comparison. We **concede** that advanced technology is probably **erasing** rich human relationships, but it shows no signs of slowing down. It'll continue to **flourish** and bring a lot of potential to transform the way we live in the **foreseeable** future. Are you ready for that?

(*897 words*)

New words

subliminal /sʌbˈlɪmɪnəl/ *a.* affecting your mind in a way that you are not conscious of 潜意识的；下意识的；潜在的

▲ **ironic** /aɪˈrɒnɪk/ *a.*

1 an ironic situation is one that is unusual or amusing because sth. strange happens, or the opposite of what is expected happens or is true（情况）有讽刺意味的，出乎意料的，令人啼笑皆非的

2 using words that are the opposite of what you really mean, often in a joking way（遣词用字）讽刺的，用反语的（常以开玩笑方式）

▲ **imposition** /ˌɪmpəˈzɪʃən/ *n.* [U] the introduction of sth. such as a rule, punishment, and tax（规章、惩罚、税种等的）实施

duster /ˈdʌstə/ *n.* [C] a cloth for removing dust from furniture 抹布；掸子

▲ **interactive** /ˌɪntərˈæktɪv/ *a.*

1 an interactive computer program, television system, etc. allows you to communicate directly with it, and does things in reaction to your actions（计算机程序、电视系统等）交互的，互动的

2 involving talking and working together 合作的；相互交流的

advent /ˈædvent/ *n.* [sing.] (*written*) **(the ~ of sth.)** the time when sth. first begins to be widely used 某事物的出现（或到来）

broadband /ˈbrɔːdbænd/ *n.* [U] a system of connecting computers to the Internet and moving information, such as messages or pictures, at a very high speed 宽带（连接计算机和因特网，用于高速传输信息的系统）

savvy /ˈsævi/ *a.* (*AmE*) (*infml.*) having practical knowledge and understanding of sth; having common sense 有见识的；懂实际知识的；通情达理的

abreast /əˈbrest/ *ad.* **(keep / stay ~ of sth.)** make sure that you know all the most recent facts or information about a particular subject or situation 了解某事物的最新情况

hectic /ˈhektɪk/ *a.* very busy or full of activity 繁忙的；忙乱的

recipe /ˈresəpi/ *n.* [C] a set of instructions for cooking a particular type of food 烹饪法；食谱

▲ **literally** /ˈlɪtərəli/ *ad.*

1 used to emphasize the truth of sth. that may seem surprising（强调事实可能令人惊讶）真正，确实

2 according to the most basic or original meaning of a word or expression 按照原义；根据字面意思

sibling /ˈsɪblɪŋ/ *n.* [C] (*fml.*) a brother or sister 兄；弟；姐；妹

▲ **headquarters** /ˌhedˈkwɔːtəz/ *n.* [C] (*pl.* **headquarters**) the main building or offices used by a large company or organization 总部；总公司；总办事处

affiliate

n. /əˈfɪliət/ [C] a company, organization, etc. that is connected with or controlled by a larger one 支会；分社；子公司；附属机构

v. /əˈfɪlieɪt/ become part of or form a close relationship with a group or organization（使）附属；（使）隶属

▲ **monitor** /ˈmɒnɪtə/ *vt.* carefully watch and check a situation in order to see how it changes over a period of time 监视；监测；检测；监督

arena /əˈriːnə/ *n.* [C]

1 **(the business / political / public, etc. ~)** all the activities and people connected with business, politics, public life, etc. 商业 / 政治 / 公众等舞台

2 a building with a large flat central area surrounded by seats, where sports or

entertainments take place（四周设有座位、供比赛或表演的）场地

align /əˈlaɪn/ *vt.*
1 organize or change sth. so that it has the right relationship to sth. else 使一致
2 publicly support a political group, country, or person that you agree with 公开支持；与…结盟

▲ **invariably** /ɪnˈveəriəbli/ *ad.* always 始终如一地；一贯地

▲ **agent** /ˈeɪdʒənt/ *n.* [C] a person or company that represents another person or company, esp. in business 代理人；代理商；经纪人

travel agent *n.* [C] a person or business whose job is to make arrangements for people wanting to travel, e.g. buying tickets or arranging hotel rooms 旅行代办人；旅行代理商

dedicate /ˈdedɪkeɪt/ *vt.*
1 use a place, time, money, etc. only for a particular purpose 把…专用于
2 give all your attention and effort to one particular thing 致力于；献身于

dedicated /ˈdedɪkeɪtɪd/ *a.*
1 (*only before noun*) made for or used for only one particular purpose 专用的
2 sb. who is dedicated works very hard at what they do because they care a lot about it 满腔热忱的；有奉献精神的

▲ **brochure** /ˈbrəʊʃə/ *n.* [C] a thin book giving information or advertising sth. 手册；小册子

▲ **luxurious** /lʌgˈzjʊəriəs / *a.* very expensive, beautiful, and comfortable 豪华的；华丽舒适的

discern /dɪˈsɜːn/ *vt.* (*not in progressive*) (*fml.*) notice or understand sth. by thinking about it carefully（仔细思考之后）觉察出，弄清楚，辨明

discerning /dɪˈsɜːnɪŋ/ *a.* showing the ability to make good judgments, esp. about art, music, style, etc.（尤指对艺术、音乐、时尚等）有鉴赏力的，有眼光的，鉴别力强的

▲ **site** /saɪt/ *n.* [C]
1 a website 网站
2 a place where sth. important or interesting happened（发生过重要或有意思的事件的）场所，地方，地点

▲ **accommodation** /əˌkɒməˈdeɪʃən/ *n.* [U] (**~s**) (*BrE* **accommodation**) a place for sb. to stay, live, or work 住处；工作场所

▲ **practicality** /ˌpræktɪˈkæləti/ *n.*
1 [U] how suitable sth. is, or whether it will work 可行性；实用（性）
2 **practicalities** [pl.] the real facts of a situation rather than ideas about how it might be 实际的事情；实际情况

credibility /ˌkredəˈbɪləti/ *n.* [U] the quality of deserving to be believed and trusted 可信度；可靠性

▲ **via** /ˈvaɪə/ *prep.*
1 using a particular person, machine, etc. to send sth. 通过（某人、某机器等）传送（某物）；借助于
2 traveling through a place on the way to another place 经过；取道

console
n. /ˈkɒnsəʊl/ [C] a small piece of electronic equipment that you connect to a screen, used for playing video games（游戏的）操作板，操控器
vt. /kənˈsəʊl/ try to make sb. feel better when they are unhappy or disappointed 安慰

akin /əˈkɪn/ *a.* (*fml.*) (**~ to sth.**) very similar to sth. 与某事物相似的；与某事物类似的

blackmail /ˈblækmeɪl/ *n.* [U]
1 when sb. tries to make you do what they want by making threats or by making you feel guilty if you do not do it 胁迫；感情勒索

2 when sb. tries to get money from you or make you do what they want by threatening to tell other people your secrets 勒索；敲诈；讹诈

evade /ɪˈveɪd/ *vt.*

1 find a way of not doing sth., esp. sth. that legally or morally you should do 逃避，规避（尤指法律或道德责任）

2 avoid talking about sth., esp. because you are trying to hide sth. 回避谈论（某事物，尤因试图隐瞒）

▲ **overseas**

ad. /ˌəʊvəˈsiːz/ to or in a foreign country that is across the sea 向国外；在海外；在外国

a. /ˈəʊvəsiːz/ happening or existing in a country across the sea from your country（在）海外的；（在）国外的

concede /kənˈsiːd/ *v.* admit that sth. is true or correct, although you wish it were not true（不得不）承认

▲ **erase** /ɪˈreɪz/ *vt.* remove sth. completely 清除；消除；消灭

▲ **flourish** /ˈflʌrɪʃ/ *vi.* develop well and be successful 繁荣；兴旺；成功

▲ **foreseeable** /fɔːˈsiːəbəl/ *a.*

1 **(in / for the ~ future)** for as long as it is possible to know what is likely to happen 在可预见的将来

2 **(in the ~ future)** fairly soon 不久；很快

Phrases and expressions

(in) one way or another / one way or the other used for saying that sth. will definitely happen, even though you do not know what method will make it happen 不管怎样，不管以何方式（某事都会发生）

check sb. / sth. out establish the truth or inform oneself about sb. or sth. 查实；了解

stand in line (*AmE*) wait in a line of people until it is your turn to do sth. 排队

crop up appear or happen, esp. when it is not expected（尤指意外地）出现，发生

catch up with sb. talk to sb. whom you have not seen for some time in order to find out what they have been doing in the interim 通过交谈了解彼此的近况

Reading comprehension

Understanding the text

2 Choose the best answer to each of the following questions.

1 What is ironic about digital technology as mentioned in Para. 1?
- A It develops very fast but people can keep up with it easily.
- B Some population groups get addicted to it while others are fed up with it.
- C It has invaded everything in our lives but we are not always aware of its impact.
- D Many people cannot live without it but deny that it has reshaped their lives.

2 Why may children not have to carry printed books in the future?
- A Children may use tablets to read e-books.
- B Children may become used to studying at home.
- C Children may be provided with interactive whiteboards in the classroom.
- D Children may leave their books in the classroom rather than bring them home.

3 Which of the following is not true about children in the digital world?
- A They cannot survive without technology.
- B They are incredibly good at using electronic devices.
- C They can keep up with the latest technological developments.
- D They play games on electronic devices as often as they play outside with their friends.

4 What changes does digital technology bring to the modern family?
- A The modern family is much busier.
- B People enjoy the convenience of ready-made food.
- C Cooking becomes easy and enjoyable to many people.
- D Siblings often battle for their choices of TV programs.

5 Why do more companies encourage working from home?
- A It is an effective way to cut costs.
- B Employees don't need constant monitoring.
- C Employees can work more efficiently at home.
- D More companies are located far from the city center.

6 What changes does digital technology bring to the leisure domain?
- A People prefer going to Internet-famous places.
- B People prefer watching shows online to traveling.
- C People become more discerning when booking their holidays.
- D People search the Web for what to do once they arrive at their destination.

7 What changes does technology bring to our social life?
- A People are more willing to make new friends.
- B People value face-to-face conversation more.
- C People have learned to keep up with so many social platforms.
- D People find it simply impossible to avoid social interactions.

8 According to the author, what will happen as a result of the digital revolution?
- A The pace of life will be much faster.
- B Human relationships will be enriched.
- C Our civilization will be changed little by little.
- D Our lives will continue to change in the future.

Critical thinking

3 Work in pairs and discuss the following questions.

1 Do you prefer reading an e-book or a printed book? Why?

2 Apart from what has been mentioned in the text, can you provide other evidence that digital technology has changed our lives in almost every way possible?

3 How can we prepare ourselves for living in the digital world?

Collocation



Today, few of us can ***resist the lure*** (B3U1A) of new technology. We are digitally connected to one another. Compared to face-to-face conversation that ***unfolds slowly*** (B3U1A), online connection enables us to ***share viewpoints*** (B3U1A) more conveniently and is suitable for people living a ***hectic life*** (B3U1B). Furthermore, social media can easily ***rekindle friendships*** (B3U1B) from the past. It seems that high technology now plays an ***essential part*** (B3U1B) in every aspect of our lives. It has ***established its credibility*** (B3U1B) in ***altering habits*** (B3U1A) and bringing about ***dramatic changes*** (B3U1B) in our society. And, its ***widespread use*** (B3U1B) has ***raised our expectations*** (B3U1A) of a good life. Some people, however, think that a better world is only a ***deceptive illusion*** (B3U1A). Because of online connection, people have ***diminished opportunities*** (B3U1A) and ***little motivation*** (B3U1A) for real conversations, and rich human relationships may become a ***distant memory*** (B3U1B). Anyway, like it or not, our world has been almost ***completely altered*** (B3U1B) and will continue to be changed by technology in the ***foreseeable future*** (B3U1B).

4 Complete the following passage by filling in the blanks with appropriate collocations from the texts. You are provided with the first letter(s) for each of the collocations. Change the form where necessary.

How often have you seen a couple at a restaurant absorbed in their phones instead of talking with each other? Most of us may agree that this occurs all too frequently. It seems that in-person connection has become less valuable than the digital one, which has 1) ***es***_____ its ***cred***_____ in the eyes of young people. Ironically, it is precisely our need for constant in-person interaction that plays an 2) ***es***_____ ***p***_____ in fueling digital interaction. However, digital and in-person interactions are definitely not interchangeable. On the one hand, we love technology – most of us could never be without our smartphones. On the other hand, we are wired to love real and physical interaction, for the joy of 3) ***sh***_____ ***v***_____ with someone face-to-face is not a 4) ***de***_____ ***il***_____ in any sense.

However, nowadays we seem to prefer digital interaction to face-to-face conversation. We would like to have better relationships with our colleagues, but when faced with a choice between dropping by their office and shooting them an email, many of us may have 5) ***lit***_____ ***mo***_____ for the former. As a consequence, we have 6) ***di***_____ ***op***_____ for deeper communication. We are sacrificing in-person conversation for digital interaction. Indeed, the 7) ***wide***_____ ***u***_____ of digital technology in recent years has brought about 8) ***dra***_____ ***ch***_____ to what we do and who we are, and 9) ***com***_____ ***al***_____ our ways of interaction.

How can we break the spell? If the march of digital interaction is inevitable in today's 10) ***hec***_____ ***l***_____, breaking the spell means not simply avoiding digital interaction but knowing when digital or in-person interaction is the right way to communicate, and how to 11) ***re***_____ the ***l***_____ of digital communication when face-to-face conversation would be better, although it often 12) ***un***_____ ***sl***_____.

We believe this can help deal with the problem in the 13) ***fore***_____ ***fu***_____. Without a doubt, some types of communication are better on our mobile devices. For example, we can discuss where to meet and how to get there. But when we use the same technology for more complex matters, it fails us. Deep communication through conversation in person may work better in this case.

Stories of China

A Smartphone is all you need



No cash? Your smartphone will do nicely. Chinese consumers who are used to spending their cash on technology are increasingly relying on a tech solution to pay for just about anything, from breakfast to booking a vacation.

To see how far I could go in Beijing without a wallet, I spent a day armed only with my smartphone.

A beautiful day started with a great breakfast. I paid for a local delicacy called *jianbing* at a food stall (摊位) with my smartphone. By scanning a QR code (二维码), I transferred six *yuan* to the stall owner.

I then passed a small supermarket – each checkout counter carried a sign that proclaimed: "Welcome to use mobile payment!"

When it comes to transportation around the capital, you can order a cab or a private car through ride-hailing services (叫车服务). Mobile payment is accepted. If you don't fancy waiting in traffic, there are also bikes for rent. You can unlock these bikes by scanning a QR code and pay a very cheap rent for the ride.

Many shops have incentives to use mobile payment services because this way they can engage customers better. After I paid for a sandwich and a cup of coffee at a restaurant

with my smartphone, the waitress asked me to "follow" their public account so they could send me coupons (优惠券) and a virtual membership card. On the door of a nearby fashion boutique (时装店), there was another sign: "Welcome to use mobile payment!" Shops also accept credit cards, but not using mobile payment may be considered backward.

Mobile payment goes beyond daily purchases. You can also pay utility bills and credit card bills, or invest in money market funds.

From food stalls to shopping malls, almost every place I stopped by in this corner of Beijing accepted mobile payment. When making a purchase, all I needed to do is tap on the phone, scan the QR code, and make the payment in a second or two. Mobile payment has really changed the way of life in China. Chinese shoppers nowadays do not have to carry cash around; they just need to carry their phones around. Cash really is becoming a thing of the past.

Exercises

Translation

Translate the following paragraph into English.

近年来，随着互联网技术的迅猛发展，互联网经济已成为一个热门话题。以电子商务为代表的互联网经济已成为中国经济发展的重要引擎（driving force）。我国政府提出了"互联网 +"的概念，以推动互联网与医疗、交通、教育、金融、公共服务等领域的结合。这将为互联网经济的发展提供更多发展机遇和更广阔的发展空间。

Unit project

Conducting the experiment "No smartphone for a day"

As can be seen in this unit, technology nowadays affects people's lives and work enormously. In this unit project, you are going to carry out an experiment in which the participants are asked to turn off their smartphones for a full day. The purpose is to find out whether the absence of a smartphone might have different effects on different people.



Step 1 **Work in groups of three or four and choose several participants for the project. The participants should vary in age, sex, profession, education level, personality, or anything that you think might make them perform differently if they are not allowed to use their smartphones.**

Step 2 **Carry out the experiment. Ask the participants to turn off their smartphones and cut access to the Internet for an entire day.**

Step 3 **When the experiment is finished, interview the participants. Use the following questions as references to get their responses.**

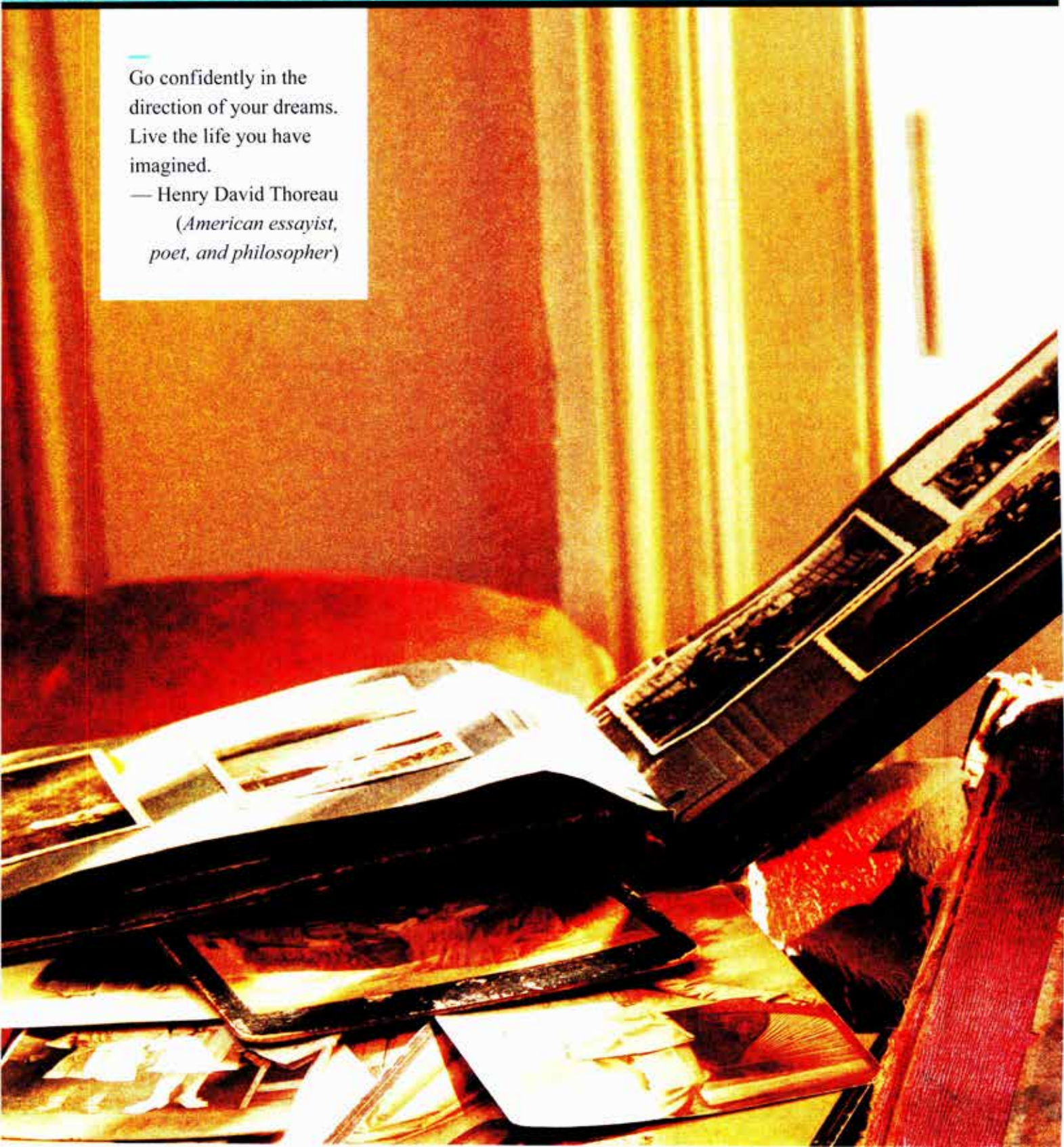
1 Did you feel anxious after you had turned off your smartphone?
2 How did you spend your time that day?
3 Did you feel more capable of concentrating without your smartphone?
4 What have you learned from the experience of staying away from your smartphone?

Step 4 **Work in groups again and compare and analyze the participants' responses and summarize your findings.**

Step 5 **Present your findings to the class.**

Unit 2

Life stories



Go confidently in the direction of your dreams. Live the life you have imagined.

— Henry David Thoreau
(*American essayist, poet, and philosopher*)

Preview

Life stories can be inspiring because they help people discover **the true meaning of life**. When you look at famous people, especially those who left a mark in history, their glamorous lives seem highly varied, and their careers brilliant in different ways. Yet, a constant exploration of the meaning and purpose of life is a common thread that runs through each of their stories. Another common thread is the contributions they have made to their people, their country, and the world. Indeed, they often exhibit, in different ways, personality traits that deserve our admiration and applause.

To live a meaningful life, you need to have your own dreams – big dreams. It's the **deep passion for and commitment to your dreams** that gets you closer to the true meaning of life. So, what do you think is the meaning of life? What have you done and will you do to realize your dreams? How are you going to shoulder the social responsibilities while pursuing your own dreams?



Section A

Pre-reading activities

1 Match the names and descriptions of the people with the pictures below.

1 Confucius (philosopher and educator in the Spring and Autumn Period)



2 Zhang Qian (diplomat and explorer in the Western Han Dynasty)



3 Zheng He (diplomat and explorer in the Ming Dynasty)



4 Li Shizhen (physician and medical scholar in the Ming Dynasty)



2 Work in pairs and discuss which of the above people you admire most and what you can learn from him.

Text A

1 In 1999, an American journalist reported a surprising encounter on a tiny African island called Pate, just off the coast of Kenya. There, in a village of stone huts set amongst dense trees, the journalist met a number of elderly men who told him that they were descendants of Chinese sailors, shipwrecked on Pate several centuries ago. Their ancestors had traded with the local Africans, who had given them giraffes to take back to China; then their boat was driven onto the nearby reef. He noted many clues that seemed to confirm the islanders' tale, including their vaguely Asian appearance, the antique porcelain heirlooms in their homes, and the porcelain shards on the beaches. Evidently, this remote African village retains an echo of one of history's most astonishing episodes of maritime exploration.

2 About six centuries ago, a mighty fleet of Chinese ships ventured west to the India Ocean, reaching Ceylon, Arabia, and East Africa. The fleet included giant nine-masted junks escorted by dozens of supply ships, water tankers, transports for cavalry horses, and patrol boats. The fleet's crew totaled more than 27,000 sailors and soldiers. As a comparison, Columbus' largest crew was of only about 1,500 people and the *Santa Maria*, the largest ship for his first voyage, was much smaller than Zheng He's largest junk.

3 Seven times, from 1405 to 1433, the Chinese fleet set off for the unknown. These great expeditions took place about half a century before the first Europeans, rounding the tip of Africa in frail Portuguese caravels,

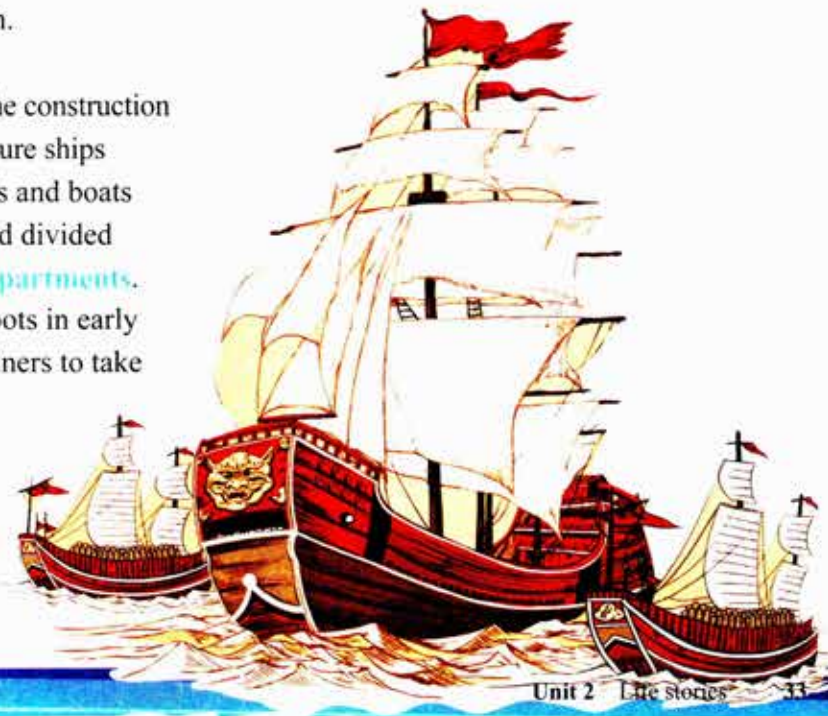
Zheng He, the great ancient Chinese explorer

"discovered" the Indian Ocean. The seven expeditions were all led by one man, Zheng He, one of the greatest explorers in Chinese history.

4 Zheng He was born around 1371 in Yunnan, southwestern China. As a child, he was very curious about the world. He often asked his father and grandfather, who had been to distant places, questions about their journey, along with the people and places they encountered. From a young age, he started reading books by great scholars, such as Confucius and Mencius. Later when he served in the royal court, he received military training and became a trusted assistant and adviser to the emperor. He was also in charge of palace construction and repairs, learned more about weapons, and became more knowledgeable in ship construction.

5 In 1403, the emperor commanded the construction of the Treasure Fleet. Both the treasure ships and the support vessels – battleships and boats carrying grain and horses – featured divided hulls with several watertight compartments. This engineering innovation had roots in early Chinese seafaring. It allowed mariners to take unprecedented amounts of drinking water on long voyages, while also adding much-needed ballast, balance, and stability.

6 In 1405, the emperor appointed Zheng He to head a massive fleet of more than 200 junks with a royal order to establish ties with rulers all around the Indian Ocean. It was the start of the seven great voyages of the Treasure Fleet. The junks, loaded with Chinese silk, porcelain, and lacquerware, visited ports around the Indian Ocean, where Zheng He exchanged the goods for spices, ivory, medicines, rare wood, pearls, and exotic animals, sought by the Ming court.



7 During his career as a naval commander, Zheng He negotiated trade pacts, fought pirates, and brought back gifts to China. He and his crew traveled and traded not only with the cities in what are now Indonesia, Malaysia, Thailand, and India, but also with the Arabian ports of modern-day Yemen and Saudi Arabia. The rulers he encountered there were impressed by his diplomatic skills and the elaborate gifts he brought them. They agreed to send ambassadors to the Ming court.

8 In 1431, Zheng He set out with his fleet for the seventh expedition around the Indian Ocean, sailing all the way to Malindi on Kenya's east coast and stopping at trading ports along the way. Toward the end of this voyage in 1433, Zheng He died of disease.

9 Zheng He had helped spread the culture and influence of China over a vast realm. But the war in the north then drew military investment away from the maintenance of the fleet and the royal court turned its focus to the construction and expansion of the Great Wall. Inevitably, the navy shrank and all the larger classes of ships were destroyed. This contributed to the end of the epic time of the Ming Dynasty sea voyages.

10 Zheng He spent years at sea sailing between China and the east coast of Africa, setting up diplomatic relationships that would reshape Asian life. His seven expeditions challenged what humans could do at sea, pushing the limits of their boats' size, complexity, and capacity for long-distance travel. They were also essential to the spread of two Chinese technologies that helped build our modern world: gunpowder and the compass.

11 Today, whether people view Zheng He as an emblem of Chinese diplomacy or as a symbol of the country's spirit of adventure and bravery, one thing is for certain: Zheng He remains one of the greatest explorers in world history, and the voyages he led stand among the great wonders in the history of ocean navigation, contributing significantly to the progress of human civilization.

(*865 words*)

Culture notes

Columbus: Italian explorer and navigator. Between 1492 and 1504, he made a total of four voyages to the Caribbean and South America, which opened the way for European exploration and colonization of the Americas.



Treasure Fleet: The Treasure Fleet under Admiral Zheng He comprised an array of ships, such as treasure ships, horse ships, and supply ships, each of which fulfilled specialized functions. The treasure ships were the largest vessels in the fleet and so named because of the vast quantities of "treasure" that could be carried in their holds.

New words

▲ **dense** /dens/ *a.* made of or containing a lot of things or people that are very close together 茂密的；密集的；稠密的

▲ **descendant** /dɪ'sendənt/ *n.* [C] sb. who is related to a person who lived a long time ago, or to a family, group of people, etc. that existed in the past 后代；后裔

giraffe /dʒə'rɑ:f/ *n.* [C] 长颈鹿

reef /ri:f/ *n.* [C] a long line of rocks or sand near the surface of the sea 礁；礁脉

▲ **vague** /veɪg/ *a.* of uncertain, indefinite, or unclear character or meaning 含糊的；不明确的；不清楚的

vaguely /'veɪgli/ *ad.*
1 slightly 稍微
2 not clearly or exactly 含糊地；不明确地；不清楚地

porcelain /'pɔ:slɪn/ *n.* [C, U] a hard white shiny substance made by baking clay and used for making delicate cups, plates and decorative objects; objects that are made of this 瓷；瓷器

heirloom /'eəlu:m/ *n.* [C] a valuable object that has been owned by a family for many years and that is passed from the older members to the younger members 传家宝；祖传之宝

shard /ʃɑ:d/ *n.* [C] (*also* **sherd**) a sharp piece of broken glass, metal, etc.（玻璃、金属等的）锋利碎片

maritime /'mærətaɪm/ *a.* (*only before noun*) relating to the sea or ships 海上的；海事的；与船舶有关的

▲ **mighty** /'maɪti/ *a.* (*literary*) very strong and powerful, or very big and impressive 强有力的；强大的；巨大的；雄伟的

▲ **fleet** /fli:t/ *n.* [C] a group of ships, or all the ships in a navy 船队；舰队

masted /'mɑ:stɪd/ *a.* (*in combination*) having a mast or masts of a specified kind or number 有…船桅的；装有…桅杆的

▲ **junk** /dʒʌŋk/ *n.* [C] a Chinese boat with a square sail and a flat bottom 中国式帆船

escort /ɪ'skɔ:t/ *vt.*
1 go somewhere with a person, vehicle, ship, etc. in order to protect them or to prevent them from escaping 护送；护卫；押送
2 go somewhere with sb. in order to be certain that they arrive at the right place 护送（某人至某处）

tanker /'tæŋkə/ *n.* [C] a very large ship used for transporting large quantities of gas or liquid, esp. oil（运输大量气体或液体的）巨轮（尤指油轮）

cavalry /'kævəlri/ *n.* [pl., U] the part of an army that fights on horses, esp. in the past（尤指旧时的）骑兵（部队）

patrol /pə'trəʊl/
n. [C] a group of police, soldiers, vehicles, planes, etc. sent out to search a particular area 巡警队；巡逻车队；巡逻机队
v. go around the different parts of an area or building at regular times to check that there is no trouble or danger 巡逻；巡查

frail /freɪl/ *a.*
1 weak; easily damaged or broken 弱的；易损的；易碎的
2 (esp. of an old person) physically weak and thin（尤指老人）瘦弱的

Portuguese /ˌpɔ:tʃə'gi:z/ *a.* relating to Portugal, its people, or its language 葡萄牙的；葡萄牙人的；葡萄牙语的

caravel /ˈkærəvel/ *n.* [C] (*also* **carvel**) (*historical*) a small, fast Spanish or Portuguese ship of the 15th-17th centuries（15 至 17 世纪西班牙或葡萄牙的）轻快帆船

▲ royal /ˈrɔɪəl/ *a.* (*only before noun*)
1 relating to or belonging to a king or queen 国王的；女王的；王室的；皇家的
2 used in the names of organizations that serve or are supported by a king or queen 皇家的（用于为国王、女王服务，或受其支持的组织名称）

hull /hʌl/ *n.* [C] the main part of a ship that goes in the water 船体；船身

▲ watertight /ˈwɔːtətaɪt/ *a.* that does not allow water to get in or out 不透水的；防水的；水密的

compartment /kəmˈpɑːtmənt/ *n.* [C] one of the separate areas into which a plane, ship, or train is divided（飞机、轮船或火车上的）隔间，舱

seafaring /ˈsiːˌfeərɪŋ/
n. [U] work or travel on ships and the sea 海上劳作；航海
a. (*only before noun*) working or traveling on ships and the sea 海上劳作的；航海的

unprecedented /ʌnˈpresɪdentɪd/ *a.* never having happened before, or never having happened so much 空前的；前所未有的

ballast /ˈbæləst/ *n.* [U] heavy material that is carried by a ship to make it more steady in the water（使船只保持平稳的）压舱物，压载

▲ appoint /əˈpɔɪnt/ *vt.*
1 choose sb. to do a particular job or have a particular position 任命；委派；指派
2 (*fml.*) choose a time or place for sth. to happen 确定，指定，约定（时间或地点）

lacquerware /ˈlækəweə/ *n.* [U] 漆器

spice /spaɪs/ *n.* [C, U] a substance made from plants and added to food to give it a particular flavor 香料；调味品

ivory /ˈaɪvəri/ *n.* [U] the hard smooth yellowish-white substance from the tusks of an elephant 象牙

▲ pearl /pɜːl/ *n.* [C] a small round white object that forms inside an oyster, and is a valuable jewel 珍珠

exotic /ɪgˈzɒtɪk/ *a.* originating in or characteristic of a distant foreign country 外（国）来的；（从外国）引进的；具有异国情调的

▲ naval /ˈneɪvəl/ *a.*
1 of or relating to ships or sailing 船舶的；航海的
2 (*only before noun*) relating to the navy or used by the navy 海军（使用）的

pact /pækt/ *n.* [C] a formal agreement between two groups, countries, or people, esp. to help each other or to stop fighting 条约；协定；协议

▲ pirate /ˈpaɪərət/ *n.* [C] sb. who sails on the seas, attacking other boats and stealing things from them 海盗

Arabian /əˈreɪbiən/ *a.* relating to Arabia or its people 阿拉伯的；阿拉伯人的

▲ diplomatic /ˌdɪpləˈmætɪk/ *a.* connected with managing relations between countries 外交的；从事外交的

▲ ambassador /æmˈbæsədə/ *n.* [C]
1 an important official who represents his or her government in a foreign country 大使
2 sb. who is considered to represent an activity, organization, company, etc.（活动、机构、公司等的）代表

▲ realm /relm/ *n.* [C]
1 (*literary*) a country ruled by a king or queen 王国
2 (*written*) a general area of knowledge, activity, or thought（知识、活动、思想的）领域，范围

▲ maintenance /ˈmeɪntənəns/ *n.* [U]
1 the repairs, painting, etc. that are necessary to

keep sth. in good condition 维护；养护；保养

2 the act of making a state or situation continue 保持；维持

▲ **expansion** /ɪkˈspænʃən/ *n.* [C, U] an act of increasing or making sth. increase in size, amount, or importance 扩张；扩展；扩大；膨胀

epic /ˈepɪk/

a. heroic and impressive in quality 英勇的；给人深刻印象的

n. [C] a book, poem, or film that tells a long story about brave actions and exciting events 长篇叙事性小说（或诗歌、电影）；史诗般的作品

▲ **complexity** /kəmˈpleksəti/ *n.* [U] the state of being complicated 复杂性；错综复杂

▲ **compass** /ˈkʌmpəs/ *n.* [C] an instrument that shows directions and has a needle that always points north 指南针；罗盘

emblem /ˈembləm/ *n.* [C]

1 sth. that represents a perfect example or a principle 象征；标志

2 a design or picture that represents a country or an organization（代表国家或组织的）徽章，标记，图案

▲ **symbol** /ˈsɪmbəl/ *n.* [C]

1 a person, an object, an event, etc. that represents a more general quality or situation 象征

2 a sign, number, letter, etc. that has a fixed meaning, esp. in science, mathematics, and music 符号；代号；记号

navigation /ˌnævəˈgeɪʃən/ *n.* [U]

1 when sb. sails a ship along a rive or other area of water（水上的）航行

2 the science or job of planning which way you need to go when you are traveling from one place to another 航行学；航海术；航空术；领航（术）

Phrases and expressions

set off start to go somewhere 出发；启程；动身

take place happen, esp. after being planned or arranged（尤指经过计划或安排后）发生，进行

in charge (of sth.) in control or with overall responsibility 掌管；负全责

loaded with sth. carrying a load of sth.; heavy with sth. 装载…的；满载…而沉重的

Proper names

Zheng He 郑和（1371?—1433，明代航海家、外交家）

Pate /peɪt/ 帕泰岛（肯尼亚岛屿）

Kenya /ˈkenjə/ 肯尼亚（非洲国家）

Ceylon /sɪˈlɒn/ 锡兰（亚洲国家斯里兰卡旧称）

Arabia /əˈreɪbiə/ 阿拉伯半岛

Columbus /kəˈlʌmbəs/ 哥伦布（1451—1506，意大利航海家）

Santa Maria /ˌsæntə məˈriːə/ 圣玛丽亚号（哥伦布首航美洲舰队的旗舰）

Confucius /kənˈfjuːʃɪəs/ 孔子（公元前 551—公元前 479，春秋末期思想家、政治家、教育家，儒家学派创始人）

Mencius /ˈmenʃəs/ 孟子（公元前 372?—公元前 289，战国时期思想家、政治家、教育家）

Indonesia /ˌɪndəˈniːʒə/ 印度尼西亚（亚洲国家）

Malaysia /məˈleɪziə/ 马来西亚（亚洲国家）

Thailand /ˈtaɪlænd/ 泰国（亚洲国家）

Yemen /ˈjemən/ 也门（亚洲国家）

Saudi Arabia /ˌsaʊdi əˈreɪbiə/ 沙特阿拉伯（亚洲国家）

Malindi /məˈlɪndi/ 马林迪（肯尼亚港口）

Reading comprehension

Understanding the text

1 Answer the following questions.

1 What did the elderly men on Pate tell the American journalist?
2 What can be inferred from the comparison between the scale of Zheng He's fleet and that of Columbus'?
3 Why does the author use quotation marks around the word *discovered* (Para. 3)?
4 What kind of books did Zheng He start reading from a young age?
5 What order did Zheng He receive when he was appointed to head the massive fleet in 1405?
6 How did Zheng He impress the rulers he encountered?
7 Why did the royal court draw military investment away from the maintenance of the Treasure Fleet?
8 What is the influence of Zheng He's seven expeditions on maritime exploration according to Para. 10?

Critical thinking

2 Work in pairs and discuss the following questions.

1 What do you think are the profound impacts of Zheng He's expeditions on international communication?
2 What can you do as a college student to prepare yourself for the cultural communication between China and the world?
3 What implications does the story of Zheng He have for your understanding of the meaning of life?

Language focus

Words in use

3 Fill in the blanks with the words given below. Change the form where necessary. Each word can be used only once.

appoint complexity dense
escort expansion frail maintenance
patrol realm vague

1 The eastern area is three times bigger than the western area, featuring _____ tropical rainforests and giant waterfalls.
2 In the meeting, a new manager was _____ to take charge of the project which was in financial difficulties.
3 Services such as cooking, cleaning, and _____ the elderly to hospitals are in high demand.
4 A high-tech police car capable of immediately detecting stolen cars, disqualified drivers, and other offenses is _____ the roads.
5 Around 300 workers and engineers are working hard for the timely delivery of the project despite its _____.
6 A researcher said China's fast economic _____ in recent years has made great contributions to world economic growth.
7 That visit was hard work because he spoke no Chinese and had only a(n) _____ plan of action.
8 China's first domestically built polar icebreaker *Xuelong 2* has completed its _____ period and will soon set out on a mission again.
9 A number of people believe that genuine friendships can develop in both the digital and physical _____, with the boundaries between the two continuing to blur.
10 She had to take care of the whole family, two children and two _____ elderly people, all by herself.

Word building

-ize

与某些形容词或名词结合构成动词，表示“以……方式说（或想、行动、对待）”或“使……化”。

civil		civilize
legal		legalize
material		materialize
familiar		**familiarize**
normal	>	**normalize**
private		**privatize**
public		**publicize**
standard		**standardize**
summary		**summarize**

-or

与某些动词结合构成名词，表示做该动作的人或执行该动作的物体。

conduct		conductor
create		creator
inherit		inheritor
sail	>	sailor
dictate		**dictator**
investigate		**investigator**

4 Fill in the blanks with the words given below. Change the form where necessary. Each word can be used only once.

dictator　familiarize　investigator
normalize　privatize　publicize
standardize　summarize

1 I think it'll be worthwhile to see what she did to overcome those problems and _____ the relations between the two countries, ending years of hostility.
2 We are constantly acquiring new skills as we engage in activities or _____ ourselves with new devices.
3 He described his boss as a(n) _____ who did not want to listen to other people's advice.
4 In their opinion, the production of things fundamental to life and human survival should not be _____.
5 The insurance company sent a(n) _____ to look into the cause of the fire to see if it really was an accident.
6 One of the keys to the success of that company is its ability to _____ its services, which reduces the quality variance.
7 His accomplishments as a composer have been recognized and widely _____ in the media.
8 Now we will _____ what we have learned and make a plan to improve our learning in the next semester or two.



Banked cloze

5 Fill in the blanks by selecting suitable words from the word bank. You may not use any of the words more than once.

A ambassadors	F epic	K frail
B appealed	G exotic	L innovation
C appointed	H expansion	M navigation
D dense	I foresaw	N pacts
E diplomacy	J forged	O realms

Zheng He was a Chinese explorer who led seven great voyages on behalf of the emperor of the Ming Dynasty. His voyages, which aimed to promote trade and 1) _____ with other states, lasted from 1405 to 1433.

Zheng He was born around 1371 in Yunnan, southwestern China. He was talented in many 2) _____, especially in ship construction. In 1403, the emperor ordered the construction of the Treasure Fleet and 3) _____ Zheng He as the commander of this fleet. This began Zheng He's 4) _____ voyages, some of the most impressive exploration journeys in history.

Zheng He's first voyage began in July 1405. His fleet traveled to present-day Vietnam, Indonesia, Malaysia, and then crossed the Indian Ocean and sailed west to today's India. They traded with the local people for spices, ivory, 5) _____ animals, and other goods.

During the next six expeditions, Zheng He made trade 6) _____ with the rulers of different states, brought back gifts, and established friendly relationships with them. He even brought back with him 7) _____ of various states to meet with the emperor of the Ming Dynasty.

Zheng He's seven great voyages promoted the 8) _____ of China's cultural and economic influence in the world. He 9) _____ new, friendly ties with many states on the Asian and African continents, while developing the trade relations with them. Zheng He's feat (壮举) was unprecedented in the history of ocean 10) _____. He is still remembered today as one of the world's greatest navigators and is a source of pride for the whole Chinese nation.

Expressions in use

6 Fill in the blanks with the expressions given below. Change the form where necessary. Each expression can be used only once.

along with curious about
in charge of loaded with set off
take place trade with view … as

1 We can enable our students to be _____ their own learning by creating interesting, open-ended tasks which they can finish by themselves.
2 The festival, which falls on the ninth day of the ninth month on the lunar calendar, is _____ an occasion to pay respect to the elderly.
3 The Belt and Road Initiative raises the level of connectivity and cooperation among dozens of nations that have _____ China for years.
4 From the smallest birthday party to the largest concert, special events _____ every day in these parks.
5 The train was fully _____ 50 containers of goods including glass bottles, canned food, and medical supplies.
6 Last month, the polar icebreaker _____ from the port for its new scientific expedition to the Antarctic.
7 We have long been _____ what really goes on inside the space station and the video satisfied our curiosity.
8 This is a double room and you can stay here _____ your friend.

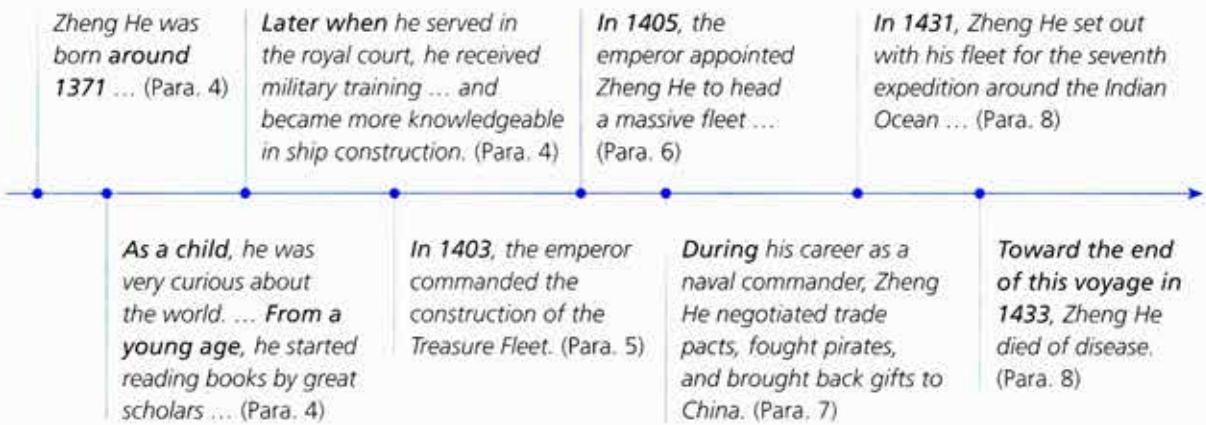
Structure analysis and writing

Structure analysis

Developing a biographical narrative essay

A biographical narrative essay describes the life of a person. It narrates, analyzes, and interprets the most important facts of someone's life, ranging from the person's childhood, educational background, adolescence, professional career, to the person's most outstanding achievements. Generally, most biographical narrative essays are written in chronological order. Different life periods in time sequence, usually grouped around a major theme (such as overcoming adversity, noteworthy achievements, or adventurous experiences), are narrated with the purpose of inspiring or encouraging the reader.

From Para. 4 to Para. 8 in Text A, the life story of Zheng He is presented in chronological order, describing his life path, experiences, and the achievements he made in his seven expeditions. The author uses various time order signals to connect information about Zheng He's life. Now look at the following sentences taken from Text A, and pay attention to the time order signals employed.



The following steps can help you develop a biographical narrative essay in chronological order.

1 Choose a person you would like to write about.
2 Search for important details about the person.
3 Make an outline, make up a list of all the details, and then arrange these details according to the order in which they occurred. Select only those that can best portray the person you are describing and ignore the unimportant ones.
4 Write a rough draft based on the details you have chosen. Use time order signals like *when*, *during*, and *later* to connect details as you move from the beginning to the end of your narrative.
5 Revise and proofread the draft until you think the narrative is coherent and well developed.

Structured writing

Read the sample essay and see how it develops in chronological order.

Topic
O. Henry: A great writer of short stories

Introduction
Thesis statement: O. Henry's life was full of twists and turns.

Body
- When he was born
- How he started writing short stories
- What he had achieved
- When he died

Conclusion
The frustration, irony, and humor reflected in O. Henry's stories were very much inspired by his own life.

O. Henry, whose real name was William Sydney Porter, was a gifted American short story writer who left us a rich legacy of great stories to enjoy. His life, however, just like the stories he wrote, was full of twists and turns.

He was born on September 11, 1862 in North Carolina, where he spent his childhood.

He went to Texas in 1882 and worked at various jobs, and later as a teller at an Austin bank. He got married in 1887 and at about the same time he began writing sketches. In 1894 he even started a humorous weekly, *The Rolling Stone*, which featured satire on life, people, and politics. When that venture failed, he started writing for *The Houston Post*.

In 1896 an unexplained shortage of money at the Austin bank was blamed on him. He served three years and three months in prison. There, he wrote to earn money to support his daughter. The stories he wrote were immediately popular with magazine readers, and he became best known as "O. Henry".

Upon his release he settled in New York City in 1902 and became a highly successful and prolific (作品丰富的) contributor to various magazines. Although his stories were criticized as shallow by some critics, O. Henry did catch the color and movement of the city and had a genuine sympathy for ordinary people. His hundreds of stories are collected in *Cabbages and Kings* (1904), *The Four Million* (1906), *The Voice of the City* (1908), *Options* (1909), and others.

O. Henry died on June 5, 1910 in New York City, at the age of 47. Despite his popularity, he ended up an alcoholic and virtually penniless.

O. Henry's life had a major impact on his point of view. The frustration, irony, and humor reflected in his stories were very much inspired by his own life.

7 Write an essay of no less than 140 words on one of the following topics. One topic has an outline that you can follow.

Topic

An influential Chinese explorer

Body

- When and where the explorer was born
- How the explorer started his / her career
- What the explorer has achieved
- What contribution he / she has made to China and the world

Conclusion

The significance of the explorer to China and the world

More topics

- A man / woman who changed the world
- A great sportsman / sportswoman

Section B

Reading skills

Distinguishing between facts and opinions

When you read an article, very often you need to distinguish between facts and opinions. The ability to recognize the difference between facts and opinions can help you better follow the writer's thinking and reasoning process, and thus gain a deeper understanding of what you read. So, what are facts and what are opinions?

Facts are statements that tell what really happened or what really is the case, while opinions are statements of belief, judgment, or feeling. Let's take a look at some examples from Text A.

Both the treasure ships and the support vessels – battleships and boats carrying grain and horses – featured divided hulls with several watertight compartments. (Para. 5)

The above sentence is simply a description of the features of those ships, without any subjective judgment, and is therefore a fact.

Today, whether people view Zheng He as an emblem of Chinese diplomacy or as a symbol of the country's spirit of adventure and bravery, one thing is for certain: Zheng He remains one of the greatest explorers in world history, and the voyages he led stand among the great wonders in the history of ocean navigation, contributing significantly to the progress of human civilization. (Para. 11)

The above sentence involves a subjective assessment of Zheng He's achievements, as evidenced by words such as *greatest* and *significantly*, and is definitely an opinion.

As you can see, the key difference between facts and opinions lies in the difference between knowing and believing. Opinions may be based on facts, but they are still what people think, not what people know. Opinions are debatable; facts are not.

It is not always easy to tell an opinion from a fact. A writer often combines the two in such a way that we do not always notice where a fact ends and an opinion begins. Mixing facts and opinions, sometimes in the same sentence, can win over the reader to a particular point of view. When facts and opinions are mixed in a single statement, you must decide whether the

main point of the statement is essentially a fact or an opinion, which can help you understand the statement, even the whole article, better. The following example is from Text A:

Zheng He spent years at sea sailing between China and the east coast of Africa, setting up diplomatic relationships that would reshape Asian life. His seven expeditions challenged what humans could do at sea, pushing the limits of their boats' size, complexity, and capacity for long-distance travel. (Para. 10)

The above statement combines facts and opinions. You may notice that the statement includes comments by the writer such as "that would reshape Asian life" and "challenged what humans could do at sea". It may seem like an opinion. But the main point is still based on facts like "Zheng He spent years at sea sailing between China and the east coast of Africa, setting up diplomatic relationships", and "pushing the limits of their boats' size, complexity, and capacity for long-distance travel". Therefore, the statement is essentially a statement of fact.

I Look at the following statements from Text B and decide which are facts (F) and which are opinions (O).

___ 1 One day, Audrey was grabbed off the street by the Nazis and placed in line to be sent to a work camp.

___ 2 After the war, Audrey and her mother left the Netherlands and arrived in the U.K.

___ 3 Audrey walked beautifully; she spoke beautifully.

___ 4 Becoming famous never changed Audrey's generous and compassionate character.

___ 5 Friends said Audrey had a complete lack of ego and accepted and appreciated others as they were.

___ 6 In 1988, Audrey was appointed a Goodwill Ambassador for UNICEF designed to provide emergency food and health care to children suffering as a result of war or other catastrophes.

___ 7 She, Robby, and her two sons returned to their home in Switzerland for their last Christmas together.

___ 8 Even as her life ended at 63 years of age, she remained a gracious woman who perpetually signified simplicity, charity, charm, and kindness.

Text B

Audrey Hepburn — a true angel in this world

1 Audrey Hepburn thrilled audiences with starring roles in **noteworthy** films like *Breakfast at Tiffany's*, *Sabrina*, *Roman Holiday*, *My Fair Lady*, *War and Peace*, and *Always*.

2 Despite her success in the film **domain**, the roles she most preferred **portraying** were not in movies. She was an **exemplary** mother to her two sons and a UNICEF (the United Nations International Children's Emergency Fund) Goodwill Ambassador serving victims in war-torn countries.

3 As a young girl during the **Nazi** occupation of the Netherlands, Audrey Hepburn was aware of the **brutality**, death, and destruction of war. She was malnourished, as her family was bankrupted as a result of the **invasion**. One day, Audrey was grabbed off the street by the Nazis and placed in line to be sent to a work camp. When the guards glanced away she **darted** off, barely escaping, and **huddled** in a cold, **foul** basement full of rats.



4 The little girl who would become one of the world's most magical actresses began as an **anonymous refugee confronting** life's horrors and **fragility** firsthand. She refused to allow her spirit to be **afflicted** by the desperate reality of her childhood. Instead, she **transcended** those challenges but never forgot what it felt like to suffer, to be hungry, alone, and helpless.

5 After the war, Audrey and her mother left the Netherlands and arrived in the U.K. Her dream of becoming a prime dancer drove her into a **rigorous** schedule at a famous ballet school. Later, she was spotted by a producer and eventually landed a role in the film *Roman Holiday* starring Gregory Peck, one of Hollywood's top **leading men**.

6 Soon, Audrey was transformed from a malnourished girl into an internationally famous movie star. Director Billy Wilder complimented her, saying, "Audrey walked beautifully; she spoke beautifully." Although she won many awards for acting, Audrey felt that her most significant work was **humanitarian** work for those in need, and as the mother to her two sons.

She suffered through two **divorces** and from her memories of the war. Yet, Audrey never let her sadness overcome her or **jeopardize** her hope for a brighter future. Audrey finally met her soul mate, Robert Wolders, and spent the last 12 years of her life with him.

7 Becoming famous never changed Audrey's generous and **compassionate** character. She felt a deep sense of responsibility to **alleviate** the suffering of those in need, especially children. Friends said Audrey had a complete lack of ego and accepted and appreciated others as they were.

8 Although she became very wealthy, she owned only one home in Switzerland. For Audrey it was a **paradise** where she could hide from the world with her beloved family, work in her garden, and take long walks in nature.

9 In 1988, Audrey was appointed a Goodwill Ambassador for UNICEF designed to provide emergency food and health care to children suffering as a result of war or other **catastrophes**. In that role, her lifelong passion for helping those in need found its greatest calling.

10 She turned down three million dollars to write her autobiography and instead accepted one dollar a year for the more conscientious role as an ambassador for UNICEF. For seven months out of each of her last five years, she and Robby left the peace and beauty in their **cozy** home to **embark** on **outreach** trips into some of the most difficult places on earth. From Bangladesh, Sudan, Vietnam, Kenya, Ethiopia, Central and South America, to Somalia, Audrey Hepburn traveled representing UNICEF, making over 50 emotionally draining and physically dangerous missions into **bleak** destinations to raise world awareness of wars and **droughts**. Having been a victim of war, she understood the blessing of being the **beneficiary** of food, clothing, and, most of all, hope.

11 Audrey felt it was **wicked** that billions of children were **deprived** of simple joys and drowned in overwhelming **misery**. She believed deeply in the **ideology** that all people share in the duty to care for those in need. Audrey was always ready to lead by example. She said, "When you deny childhood, you deny life." She saw UNICEF's work as an **integral**, sacred force in people's lives and said of UNICEF's results, "Anyone who doesn't believe in miracles is not a realist."

12 In 1992, Audrey was **stricken** by cancer. She, Robby, and her two sons returned to their home in Switzerland for their last Christmas together.

13 Audrey's **cherished** friend, a world-famous fashion designer, spoke to her for the last time just before she died. He said she was "... **serene** at the end because she knew she had achieved everything with perfection".

14 Audrey Hepburn's passion for service was enduring. Even as her life ended at 63 years of age, she remained a **gracious** woman who **perpetually signified** simplicity, charity, charm, and kindness.

15 The **majesty** of Audrey Hepburn's spirit of social responsibility and dedication lives on in her words: "Remember, if you ever need a helping hand, it's at the end of your arm. As you get older, remember you have another hand: The first is to help yourself, the second is to help others." And "For beautiful eyes, look for the good in others; for beautiful lips, speak only words of kindness; and for **poise**, walk with the knowledge that you are never alone."

(*879 words*)

New words

noteworthy /ˈnəʊtˌwɜːðɪ/ *a.* important or interesting enough to deserve your attention 值得注意的；显著的

domain /dəˈmeɪn/ *n.* [C] (*fml.*) an area of activity, interest, or knowledge, esp. one that a particular person, organization, etc. deals with （活动、兴趣或知识的）领域，范围，范畴

portray /pɔːˈtreɪ/ *vt.*

1 act the part of a character in a play, film, or television program 扮演（角色）

2 (**~ sb. / sth. as sth.**) describe or show sb. or sth. in a particular way, according to your opinion of them 把某人 / 某物描写（或表现）成某种样子

▲ **exemplary** /ɪgˈzempləri/ *a.* excellent and providing a good example for people to follow 模范的；可作楷模的

Nazi /ˈnɑːtsi/

a. 纳粹党的；纳粹主义的；纳粹分子的

n. [C] 纳粹分子

▲ **brutality** /bruːˈtæləti/ *n.* [C, U] cruel and violent behavior, or an event involving cruel and violent treatment 残暴行为；残暴事件

▲ **invasion** /ɪnˈveɪʒən/ *n.* [C, U] when the army of one country enters another country by force, in order to take control of it 侵犯；入侵；侵略

dart /dɑːt/ *vi.* (always + *ad.* / *prep.*) move suddenly and quickly in a particular direction 猛冲；飞跑

huddle /ˈhʌdl/ *vi.* (always + *ad.* / *prep.*) lie or sit with your arms and legs close to your body because you are cold or frightened （因寒冷或恐惧而）蜷缩着身体

foul /faʊl/ *a.* very dirty, or smelling or tasting unpleasant 肮脏的；难闻的；难吃的

anonymous /əˈnɒnɪməs/ *a.* unknown by name 无名的；不署名的

refugee /ˌrefjʊˈdʒiː/ *n.* [C] a person who has been forced to leave their country or home, because there is a war or for political, religious, or social reasons 避难者；逃亡者；难民

▲ **confront** /kənˈfrʌnt/ *vt.*

1 deal with sth. very difficult or unpleasant in a brave and determined way 勇敢地面对；正视

2 (of problems or a difficult situation) appear and need to be dealt with by sb. （问题或困境）使…无法回避；降临于

fragility/frəˈdʒɪləti/ *n.* [U] the state of being easily damaged, broken, or harmed 脆弱；不稳定

afflict /əˈflɪkt/ *vt.* (*fml.*) affect sb. or sth. in an unpleasant way, and make them suffer 使受痛苦；折磨

transcend/trænˈsend/ *vt.* (*fml.*) go beyond the usual limits of sth. 超越；超过；超出

rigorous /ˈrɪgərəs/ *a.*

1 very severe or strict 严酷的；严厉的

2 careful, thorough, and exact 严格的；缜密的；精确的

leading man *n.* [C] the main male actor in a play, film, or television program 饰主角的男演员

humanitarian /hjuːˌmænəˈteərɪən/ *a.* (*only before noun*) concerned with improving bad living conditions and preventing unfair treatment of people 博爱的；人道主义的

▲ **divorce** /dəˈvɔːs/

n. [C, U] the legal ending of a marriage 离婚

v. end your marriage to sb. legally （与…）离婚

jeopardize /ˈdʒepədaɪz/ *vt.* risk losing or spoiling sth. important 危及；危害；损害

compassionate /kəmˈpæʃənət/ *a.* feeling sympathy for people who are suffering 充满同情心的；怜悯的

alleviate /əˈliːvieɪt/ *vt.* make (suffering, deficiency, or a problem) less severe 减轻，缓和（痛苦、不足或问题）

paradise /ˈpærədaɪs/ *n.* [C, U] a perfect place or situation 乐土；完美的境界；天堂

catastrophe /kəˈtæstrəfi/ *n.*
1 [C, U] a terrible event in which there is a lot of destruction, suffering, or death 灾难；大祸；重大不幸
2 [C] an event which is very bad for the people involved 麻烦；困境；不利局面

cozy /ˈkəʊzi/ *a.* (*BrE* **cosy**) warm and comfortable, and making you feel relaxed 温暖舒适的；温馨的

embark /ɪmˈbɑːk/ *v.* go onto a ship or a plane, or put or take sth. onto a ship or plane（使）上船（或飞机）；（把…）装船（或飞机）

outreach /ˈaʊtriːtʃ/ *n.* [U] the practice of providing help or advice to people who would not otherwise get it easily 外展服务；扩大范围的服务

bleak /bliːk/ *a.*
1 (of a place) exposed, empty, or with no pleasant features（地方）无遮掩的，荒凉的，索然无味的
2 (of a situation) without anything to make you feel happy or hopeful（状况）没有希望的，令人沮丧的

▲ **drought** /draʊt/ *n.* [C, U] a long period of dry weather when there is not enough water for plants and animals to live 旱灾；干旱

▲ **beneficiary** /ˌbenəˈfɪʃəri/ *n.* [C] sb. who gets advantages from an action or change 受益者；受惠者

wicked /ˈwɪkɪd/ *a.* morally wrong and deliberately intending to hurt people 缺德的；邪恶的

▲ **deprive** /dɪˈpraɪv/ *vt.* (~ **sb. of sth.**) prevent sb. from having sth., esp. sth. that they need or should have 剥夺

▲ **misery** /ˈmɪzəri/ *n.* [C, U] great suffering that is caused e.g. by being very poor or very sick 痛苦；困苦；苦难

ideology /ˌaɪdiˈɒlədʒi/ *n.* [C, U] a set of beliefs on which a political or economic system is based, or which strongly influence the way people behave（作为政治或经济制度基础的）思想体系；（强烈影响人们行为的）观念

integral /ˈɪntəgrəl/ *a.* forming a necessary part of sth.（用于构成整体）必需的，不可缺少的

stricken /ˈstrɪkən/ *a.* (*fml.*) seriously affected by an unpleasant feeling or disease or by a difficult situation 受煎熬的；患病的；遭受挫折的

▲ **cherish** /ˈtʃerɪʃ/ *vt.*
1 love sb. or sth. very much and take care of them well 钟爱；珍爱
2 think that sth. is very important and wish to keep it 珍爱；珍视

serene /səˈriːn/ *a.* very calm or peaceful 宁静的；安宁的；平静的

▲ **gracious** /ˈgreɪʃəs/ *a.* behaving in a polite, kind, and generous way, esp. to people of a lower rank 有礼貌的，仁慈的，和蔼的，亲切的（尤指对较低阶层的人们）

perpetual /pəˈpetʃuəl/ *a.* (*usu. before noun*) continuing all the time without changing or stopping 连续不断的；无休止的

perpetually /pəˈpetʃuəli/ *ad.* 连续不断地；无休止地

signify /ˈsɪgnɪfaɪ/ *vt.* (*not in progressive*) represent, mean, or be a sign of sth. 代表；表示；象征；意味着

majesty /ˈmædʒəsti/ *n.*
1 [U] the impressive and attractive quality that

sth. has 雄伟壮观；庄严；威严；崇高

2 [C] **(Your / Her / His Majesty)** used when talking to or about a king or queen 陛下（对国王或女王的称呼）

poise /pɔɪz/ *n.* [U]

1 a graceful way of moving or standing, so that your body seems balanced and not awkward 优雅的举止（或体态、姿态）

2 a controlled and relaxed way of behaving, even in difficult situations 从容；镇静

Phrases and expressions

embark on / upon sth. start sth., esp. sth. new, difficult, or exciting 开始，着手（尤指新的、困难的或令人激动的事）

share in sth. be equally involved in sth. or responsible for sth. 共同承担；分担

lead by example show the people you are in charge of what you want them to do by doing it yourself 以身作则

live on continue to live or exist 继续活着；继续存在

Proper names

Audrey Hepburn /ˌɔːdri ˈhepbɜːn/ 奥黛丽·赫本（1929—1993，英国演员）

Breakfast at Tiffany's /ˈtɪfəniz/《蒂凡尼的早餐》（1961）

Sabrina /səˈbriːnə/《龙凤配》（1954）

Roman Holiday《罗马假日》（1953）

My Fair Lady《窈窕淑女》（1964）

War and Peace《战争与和平》（1956）

Always《直到永远》（1989）

UNICEF /ˈjuːnɪsef/ 联合国儿童基金会（现全称为 United Nations Children's Fund）

UNICEF Goodwill Ambassador 联合国儿童基金会亲善大使

the Netherlands /ˈneðələndz/ 荷兰（欧洲国家）

Gregory /ˈgregəri/ Peck 格利高里·派克（1916—2003，美国演员）

Billy Wilder /ˈwaɪldə/ 比利·怀尔德（1906—2002，美国电影导演、编剧、制片人）

Robert Wolders /ˈwəʊldəz/ 罗伯特·沃尔德斯（1936—2018，荷兰演员）

Switzerland /ˈswɪtsələnd/ 瑞士（欧洲国家）

Robby 罗比（Robert 的昵称）

Bangladesh /ˌbæŋgləˈdeʃ/ 孟加拉国（亚洲国家）

Sudan /suˈdæn / 苏丹（非洲国家）

Vietnam /ˌvjetˈnæm/ 越南（亚洲国家）

Ethiopia /ˌiːθiˈəʊpiə/ 埃塞俄比亚（非洲国家）

Somalia /səʊˈmɑːliə/ 索马里（非洲国家）

Reading comprehension

Understanding the text

2 Choose the best answer to each of the following questions.

1 Which of the following did Audrey Hepburn prefer most?
- A Becoming a prime dancer.
- B Carrying out humanitarian work.
- C Starring in as many films as possible.
- D Thrilling audiences with starring roles.

2 Which of the following is true regarding Audrey Hepburn's life during the Nazi occupation of the Netherlands?
- A Her family was bankrupted.
- B Her mom managed to get her enough food.
- C She lived in a basement full of rats.
- D She failed to escape from the guards.

3 What do we learn about Audrey Hepburn who experienced life's horrors and fragility as a child?
- A She tried to forget the terrible experiences.
- B She was determined to overcome the challenges.
- C She lost hope at first but soon pulled herself together.
- D She did not admit that the desperate reality had an effect on her.

4 What happened to Audrey Hepburn after she moved to the U.K.?
- A She enrolled in a famous film school.
- B She met her soul mate Gregory Peck.
- C She wrote a biography of Billy Wilder.
- D She got a role in the film *Roman Holiday*.

5 What do we learn about Audrey Hepburn's home in Switzerland?
- A It was one of the several homes she owned.
- B It was very modern and life was comfortable there.
- C It was the place where she wrote her autobiography.
- D It was a place where she could stay with her family undisturbed.

6 Why does the author say Audrey's missions were "physically dangerous"?
- A She went to remote places alone.
- B She visited places which were at war.
- C She had little time to rest during her missions.
- D She often encountered people hostile to foreigners.

7 What is the ideology Audrey Hepburn deeply believed in?
- A When you deny childhood, you deny life.
- B All people share in the duty to care for those in need.
- C Anyone who doesn't believe in miracles is not a realist.
- D If you ever need a helping hand, it's at the end of your arm.

8 According to the text, which of the following words could best describe Audrey Hepburn?
- A Frank.
- B Creative.
- C Energetic.
- D Kind-hearted.

Critical thinking

3 Work in pairs and discuss the following questions.

1 What do you think is the most important thing for a person to succeed in the film industry?

2 Why do you think successful people have a passion for serving those in need?

3 In your opinion, who can represent the spirit of charity in Chinese history? Why?

Collocation

More language exercises

Many legendary explorers in ancient China, after experiencing unprecedented hardships, have made great accomplishments and contributed to some of the most ***astonishing episodes*** (B3U2A) in Chinese history.

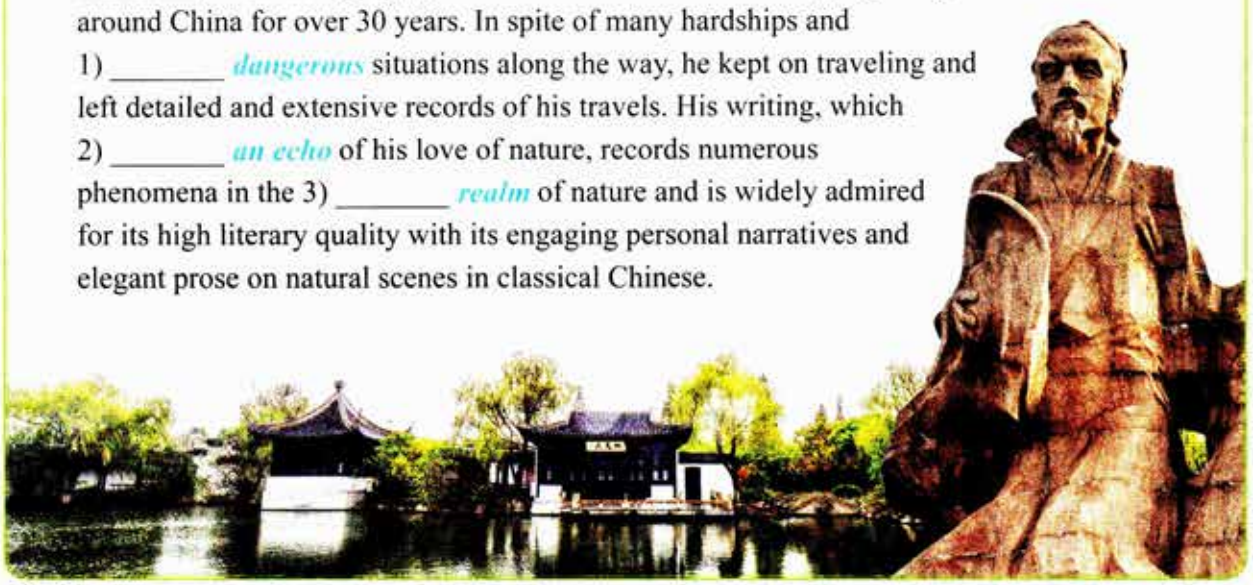
Zhang Qian, who was sent by the emperor of the Western Han Dynasty to ***establish ties*** (B3U2A) with the Greater Yuezhi in the Western Regions, managed to get there and finally returned to his homeland after an absence of 13 years. During this period, he was captured twice and spent a total of 11 years controlled by the enemy. The ***desperate reality*** (B3U2B), whether it was ***emotionally draining*** (B3U2B) or ***physically dangerous*** (B3U2B), and the ***overwhelming misery*** (B3U2B) could never defeat him or ***jeopardize his hope*** (B3U2B). Today, if you travel in China, you might have ***surprising encounters*** (B3U2A) with places and cultures which ***retain an echo*** (B3U2A) of his expeditions.

Zheng He, another great explorer in human history, immersed himself in the ***vast realm*** (B3U2A) of ship construction and navigation when he was young. Later, he became the commander of the Treasure Fleet, which required expensive maintenance only the Ming Dynasty could afford at that time. He set out with his fleet loaded with ***elaborate gifts*** (B3U2A) and ***negotiated trade pacts*** (B3U2A) with many rulers during the ***long voyages*** (B3U2A) around the Indian Ocean. His seven expeditions during the ***epic time*** (B3U2A) of the Ming Dynasty sea voyages helped ***spread the culture*** (B3U2A) and influence of China, ***perpetually signifying*** (B3U2B) the adventurous spirit of the Chinese people.

4 Complete the following paragraphs by choosing appropriate words from the boxes. Change the form where necessary. Each word can be used only once.

physically retain vast

Xu Xiake, a Chinese geographer and travel writer of the Ming Dynasty, traveled around China for over 30 years. In spite of many hardships and 1) _____ *dangerous* situations along the way, he kept on traveling and left detailed and extensive records of his travels. His writing, which 2) _____ *an echo* of his love of nature, records numerous phenomena in the 3) _____ *realm* of nature and is widely admired for its high literary quality with its engaging personal narratives and elegant prose on natural scenes in classical Chinese.



elaborate spread surprising

The vast trade network of the Silk Road carried more than just precious commodities. In fact, the constant movement and mixing of populations 4) _____ *different cultures* and beliefs, which had a profound impact on the history and civilizations of the Eurasian peoples. Today travelers along the Silk Road are attracted not only by 5) _____ *gifts* or local specialties, but also by 6) _____ *encounters* with places with a mysterious past.



desperate jeopardize overwhelming

Charlie Chaplin may be one of the world's most famous rags-to-riches actors. He lived in 7) _____ *misery* when he was little. Because of the 8) _____ *reality* of poverty, he started to work when he was still a child. However, no hardship could 9) _____ *his hope*, and he managed to overcome the obstacles and made a career out of making people laugh.





emotionally long perpetually

Life does not discriminate among people when it comes to personal setbacks and obstacles. Struggles and hardships happen to everyone in the 10) _____ *voyage* of life, ordinary people and celebrities alike. It is most important to get through the 11) _____ *draining* periods in life by looking forward, drawing courage to face the odds, and hoping for the best. As a result, fears can never destroy your hope and determination. Finally you will achieve success which 12) _____ *signifies* your devotion, efforts, and perseverance.

Section C

Stories of China

Mei Lanfang – a Peking Opera legend

Mei Lanfang, a Chinese theatrical performer, is recognized as one of the greatest Peking Opera artists in Chinese history. Actually, Mei Lanfang is his stage name and his real name is Mei Lan.

The son and grandson of noted opera singers, Mei began studying Peking Opera at the age of 8 and made his stage debut at 10, playing a weaving girl. Thereafter he played mostly female roles, becoming especially well-known for his portrayal in *The Heavenly Maid Scatters Blossoms* (《天女散花》). At the age of 13 he joined the Xiliancheng Theatrical Company and, through performances in Shanghai and elsewhere, acquired a national reputation. His style of dance, singing, etc. won such acclaim (赞誉) over the years that it came to be known as the "Mei School".

The early 1900s are widely considered the golden age of Peking Opera in China. Competition was fierce as opera troupes (剧团) led by renowned stars toured all over China. Meanwhile, critics were ever ready to fire off their assessments of the quality of each troupe's performance.

In a survey in 1927, the public voted for their favorite new play of the most famous Peking Opera performers of female roles. Such a role is known as *dan* (旦). Among the performers



were Mei Lanfang, Cheng Yanqiu, Shang Xiaoyun, and Xun Huisheng. Later, the four artists became widely known as the Four Great *Dans* of Peking Opera, and each went on to develop their own disciplines which have been studied and followed by generations of Peking Opera singers.

Mei was renowned for his efforts in modernizing Peking Opera in terms of plays, stage design, lighting, makeup, and costume design. Mei also made great contributions to the spread of Peking Opera to foreign countries by participating in cultural exchanges with Japan, the United States, and other countries. He toured the world, forming friendships with his Western contemporaries, including Charlie Chaplin.

During the War of Resistance Against Japanese Aggression, Mei kept a moustache as a reply to the Japanese who asked him to perform. This bold act of patriotism earned him great respect and bolstered (巩固) his fame as an artist.

Exercises

Translation

Translate the following paragraph into English.

中央电视台春节联欢晚会（Spring Festival Gala）自 1983 年举办以来，已成为中国人生活中不可缺少的文化消费品和一个重要的文化符号。虽然众口难调，但必须承认的是，“春晚”已成为一项“新民俗”。它不仅是一台晚会，更是一种仪式与象征，一种文化与标签，一种情感与寄托。随着新媒体的出现，“春晚”也在与时俱进，以满足大众日渐多样化的需求。

Unit project

Writing a profile article

A profile article is a feature article about a person. It focuses on a specific trait, characteristic, or noteworthy accomplishment of that individual. In this unit project, you are going to write a profile article of a famous Chinese person who has made special contributions to society.



Step 1 **Read the following information to better understand a profile article.**

A profile article explores the background and character of a particular person. Its focus should be on a single aspect of the personal or professional life of the person and this should be the center that pulls the article together. You can include the background information, but focus on something interesting.

Generally, a profile article has a lead, body, and closure. The lead is the introduction to your article and your subject, i.e., the person you are going to write about. It can be an anecdote, a description, a quote, a question, a comparison, or anything that draws your reader to the article. The body of a profile article, which weaves background material with details and quotes, could be organized thematically or chronologically. To wrap up a profile article, there are a number of easy ways. One is to have a circular ending by referring back to your lead. Another way is to describe a scene or give a summary statement. Certainly, it is also a good idea to end your article with an interesting quote from your subject which will leave a deep impression on your reader.

Remember, it is of vital importance to select eye-catching details about the person and organize them in a creative and interesting way. To achieve this, what takes place before the writing process is crucial since careful preparation is the basis for any good article.



Step 2 **Discuss in groups of three or four and decide on the Chinese person you want to write about. Look for relevant information and take notes on the following.**

- The theme to portray
- Background stories
- Setbacks
- Achievements
- Social influence

...

Step 3 **Sort out the notes and make an outline for your profile article.**

Step 4 **Write the article based on the notes and outline.**

Unit 3 Let's go

Traveling ten thousand miles beats reading ten thousand books.

— A Chinese saying

读万卷书不如行万里路。

——中国谚语



Preview

Since ancient times, people have longed to see other parts of the world, overcoming the difficulties and enduring the discomforts of travel. **Every journey is filled with new experiences**. Some are pleasant, even amazing; others are challenging, even dangerous, especially when we are traveling alone. So, why not just stay safely at home, reading travel books or watching travel videos?

Mark Twain, the famous writer, once said, "Travel is fatal to prejudice … and narrow-mindedness …" And scientists studying the brain have come to agree with his statement. They believe that travel to foreign places not only provides great memories but amazingly, causes changes in our brains and our perceptions. Consequently, people are **more curious and open to the new**, which is the key to creativity and innovation.

Have you traveled? Why do you travel? What interesting places or people have impressed you most? Has travel eliminated any of your prejudices? If so, what prejudices have been eradicated?



Section A

Pre-reading activities

1 Listen to a talk about travel and fill in the blanks with what you hear.

Audio clip

1 Reading and traveling are two _____ _____ for young people to better understand the world.

2 Reading gives us off-the-shelf knowledge that our _____ gathered from their practices; traveling makes us experience the diversity of the real world and multiple cultures _____.

3 Traveling teaches me how other people live and thus _____ my tolerance of different cultures as I _____ myself in their ways of life.

4 And when I travel, I feel my _____ _____ is the accumulation of many _____.

2 Talk about a memorable travel experience and its effect on you.



Text A

1 It's 4:15 in the morning, and my alarm clock has just stolen away a lovely dream. I almost go back to sleep before my eye catches my packed suitcase and I **groan**, remembering that I'm going to the airport. The taxi is late and then lost, and I'm getting increasingly nervous that I'll miss my flight. I run in when we arrive, stagger through security, and finally get to my gate. After all the trouble of this morning, my flight is canceled and I'm stuck in this **terminal** for the next 218 minutes, and my only consolation is a cup of complimentary airport coffee. This is traveling, a **burdensome** series of running and waiting, and after countless hours, finally getting there.

2 Why do we travel? I don't mind the actual flying, the wonder of being **airborne** in a dense metal bird. The rest of the journey, however, can feel like a tedious lesson in the ills of modernity, from the predawn x-ray screening to the sad airport malls selling **clusters** of **keepsakes**. It's the result of a **globalized** world, and it sucks.

3 Sometimes, of course, we travel because we need to. Because in this digital age, there is still something important about the handshake at a business luncheon. Or eating Mom's special food on Thanksgiving. Or seeing your girlfriend on your two-year anniversary.

4 But most travel is **decidedly** optional. Only **corporate** travel, about 30 percent of trips over 50 miles, is truly **compulsory**. In most cases, we travel because we want to, because the annoyances of the airport are **offset** by the thrill of being someplace new. Because work

The surprising purpose of travel



is stressful and our blood pressure is too high and we need a vacation somewhere **tropical**. Because home is boring. Because the flights are on sale. Because Paris is Paris.

5 Travel, in other words, is a basic human desire. But do we travel just for fun? I'm afraid not. Actually, getting away is an essential habit of effective thinking. Thanks to modern **aviation**, we can now move through space at an inhuman speed. For the first time in human history, we can outrun the sun and move from one **hemisphere** to another in a single day. Of course, it's not enough to simply get on a plane. If we want to realize the creative benefits of travel, then we have to rethink its overall purpose. Most people, after all, escape to Paris so they don't have to think about those troubles they left behind. But here's the irony: Our mind is most likely to **solve** our most **stubborn** problems while we are sitting in a Left Bank café. So, instead of **contemplating** that buttery dessert, we should be conscious of those domestic issues we just can't solve.

6 The larger lesson, though, is that our thoughts are **saturated** with the familiar. The brain is a space of near-**infinite** possibility, which means that it spends a lot of time and energy choosing what not to notice. As a result, creativity is traded away for efficiency; we think in **finite**, literal **prose**, not symbolic **verse**. A bit of distance, however, helps **loosen** the **cognitive** chains that **imprison** us, making it easier to **mingle** the new with the old; the **mundane** is grasped from a slightly more abstract perspective. According to research, the experience of an exotic culture **endows** us with a valuable open-mindedness, making it easier to realize that even a **trivial** thing can have multiple

meanings. Take head movement, which is commonly used to communicate positive versus negative response, as an example. In most cultures, nodding one's head denotes positivity, meaning "yes", and shaking the head is associated with negativity, meaning "no". In Bulgaria, however, this response pattern is reversed – that is, head shaking means "yes" and head nodding means "no".

7 Such cultural contrasts mean that seasoned travelers are open to ambiguity, willing to realize that there are decidedly different (and equally valid) ways of interpreting the world. This, in turn, allows them to expand the circumference of their "cognitive inputs" as they refuse to settle for their first answers and initial guesses.

8 Of course, this mental flexibility doesn't come from mere distance, a simple change in latitude and longitude. Instead, this renaissance of creativity appears to be a side effect of difference: We need to change cultures, to experience the disorienting diversity of human traditions. The same facets of foreign travel that are so confusing (Do I tip the waiter? Where is this train taking me?) turn out to have a lasting impact, making us more creative because we're less insular. We're reminded of all that we don't know, which is nearly everything; we're surprised by the constant stream of surprises. Even in this globalized age, we can still be amazed at all the earthly things that weren't included in the guidebooks and that certainly don't exist back home.

9 So, let's not pretend that travel doesn't have its drawbacks, or that we endure jet lag for pleasure. We don't spend 10 hours lost in the Louvre because we like it, and the view from the top of Machu Picchu probably doesn't make up for the trouble of lost luggage. (More often than not, I need a vacation after my vacation.) We travel because we need to, because distance and difference are the secret cornerstones of creativity. When we get home, home is still the same. But something in our mind has been changed, and that changes everything.

(*910 words*)

Culture notes

Left Bank café: The Left Bank, or the south bank, of the River Seine in Paris is traditionally the Latin Quarter (university district), filled with students, professors, bookshops, and restaurants. The Left Bank cafés were favorite meeting places for great artists, writers, and famous intellectuals in the early 20th century.

Machu Picchu: an ancient ruined South American city high up in the Andes Mountains in Peru. It was built and occupied by the Incas, a Native American people of South America, probably from the mid-15th century to the early or mid-16th century. It is a popular place for tourists to visit, with a temple of the Sun and many other buildings.

New words

groan /grəʊn/

vi. make a long low sound, e.g. because you are in pain or unhappy（因疼痛或烦恼等）呻吟，发出哼哼声

v. speak about sth. in a way that shows you are unhappy 抱怨

n. [C] a long low sound that a person makes, esp. when they are in pain or unhappy（尤指疼痛或烦恼时的）呻吟，哼哼声

▲ terminal /'tɜːmɪnəl/ *n.* [C] a big building where people wait to get onto planes, buses, or ships, or where goods are loaded（飞机、公共汽车、轮船客运或货物运输的）集散站，终点站

burdensome /'bɜːdnsəm/ *a.* (*fml.*) creating problems for sb. 令人烦恼的；成为负担的

airborne /'eəbɔːn/ *a.*

1 (of a plane or passengers) in the air（飞机或乘客）在空中的，飞行中的

2 carried in the air 空气传播的

cluster /'klʌstə/

n. [C] a small group of people or things that are very close to each other 群；组；束；串；簇

v. form a small close group 群集；聚集

keepsake /'kiːpseɪk/ *n.* [C] a small object that you keep to remind you of sb. or sth. 小纪念品

▲ globalize /'gləʊbəlaɪz/ *v.* develop or be developed so as to make possible international influence or operation（使）全球化

decidedly /dɪ'saɪdɪdli/ *ad.*

1 (+ *a.* / *ad.*) in a way that is impossible to doubt and easy to see 确实无疑地；显然

2 (*BrE*) in a way that shows you are very certain about sth. 坚决地；果断地

▲ corporate /'kɔːpərət/ *a.* (*only before noun*)

1 relating to large companies, or to a particular large company 大公司的

2 (*fml.*) shared by or including all the members of a group 全体的；集体的

▲ compulsory /kəm'pʌlsəri/ *a.* sth. that is compulsory must be done because of a rule or law 必须做的；义务的；强制的

offset /'ɒfset/ *vt.* (**offset, offset**) balance the effect of sth., with the result that there is no advantage or disadvantage 抵消；补偿

tropical /'trɒpɪkəl/ *a.* in or from the hottest parts of the world 热带的；来自热带的

▲ aviation /ˌeɪvi'eɪʃən/ *n.* [U] the practice of flying planes 航空；飞行（术）

hemisphere /'heməsfɪə/ *n.* [C]

1 one half of the earth, divided between north and south by the equator（地球的）半球

2 one half of the brain, divided between left and right（大脑的）半球

▲ solve /sɒlv/ *vt.*

1 find or provide a way of dealing with a problem 解决（问题）

2 find the correct answer to a problem or the explanation for sth. that is difficult to understand 解答（问题）；破解（难题）

stubborn /'stʌbən/ *a.*

1 difficult to remove, deal with, or use 难以去除（或对付、使用）的；顽固的

2 determined not to change your mind, even when people think you are being unreasonable 固执的；顽固的；执拗的；倔强的

contemplate /'kɒntəmpleɪt/ *vt.*

1 look at sb. or sth. for a period of time in a way that shows you are thinking 凝视；注视

2 consider doing sth. in the future 盘算；打算

saturate /'sætʃəreɪt/ *vt.*

1 fill sth. completely with a large number of things or a large amount of sth. 使充满

2 make sth. completely wet 使湿透

▲ **infinite** /ˈɪnfənət/ *a.*

1 very great in amount or degree（数量或程度上）极大的

2 without limits in space or time（空间或时间）无限的，无穷无尽的

finite /ˈfaɪnaɪt/ *a.* (*fml.*) existing only in limited numbers or amounts or continuing only for a limited time or distance 有限的；有限制的

▲ **prose** /prəʊz/ *n.* [U] written language in its ordinary form, as opposed to poetry 散文（相对诗歌而言）

verse /vɜːs/ *n.*

1 [U] (*fml.*) poetry, esp. poetry with a regular pattern（尤指遵循一定诗律的）诗（歌）

2 [C] a group of words or sentences that form one section of a poem or song 诗句；诗节；（歌词的）节

▲ **loosen** /ˈluːsən/

v. make sth. less tight or firmly fixed; become less tight or firmly fixed（使）放松；（使）变松

vt. make sth. less strict or controlled 放宽，放松（限制或控制）

cognitive /ˈkɒgnətɪv/ *a.* (*fml.*) related to the process of knowing, understanding, and learning sth. 认知的；认知过程的

imprison /ɪmˈprɪzən/ *vt.* (*usu. passive*)

1 make sb. feel that they are being kept in a place or situation that they cannot escape from 限制；束缚

2 put sb. in a prison 关押；监禁

mingle /ˈmɪŋgəl/ *v.* combine or make one thing combine with another（使）与…结合，混合，联结

mundane /mʌnˈdeɪn/ *a.*

1 ordinary and not interesting or exciting, esp. because of happening too regularly 普通的；平凡的；平淡无奇的

2 (*fml.*) relating to the world and practical matters instead of religious or spiritual ones 世俗的；尘世的

endow /ɪnˈdaʊ/ *vt.* give a large amount of money to a school, hospital, or other institution 向（学校、医院等）捐钱；资助

trivial /ˈtrɪvɪəl/ *a.* not very interesting, serious, or valuable 没意思的；不严重的；没价值的；琐碎的

▲ **versus** /ˈvɜːsəs/ *prep.* (*abbr. BrE* **v.**, *AmE* **vs.**)

1 used to compare two different ideas, choices, etc.（比较两种不同想法、选择等）与…相对，与…相比

2 (*sport or law*) used to show that two teams or sides are against each other（表示两队或双方对阵）对，诉，对抗

denote /dɪˈnəʊt/ *vt.* (*fml.*)

1 represent or be a sign of sth. 是表示…的标志；代表

2 mean sth. 意指；表示

ambiguity /ˌæmbɪˈgjuːəti/ *n.* [C, U] the state of being unclear, confusing, or not certain, or things that produce this effect 模棱两可，不明确（的事物）

circumference /səˈkʌmfərəns/ *n.* [C, usu. sing., U] the distance or measurement around the outside of a circle or any round shape 圆周；周长

latitude /ˈlætɪtjuːd/ *n.* [C, U] 纬度

longitude /ˈlɒndʒɪtjuːd/ *n.* [C, U] 经度

renaissance /rɪˈneɪsəns/ *n.* [sing.] a rebirth or renewed interest in sth. 再生；复兴

▲ **diversity** /daɪˈvɜːsəti/ *n.*

1 [sing.] a range of different people, things, or ideas 各种各样的人（或事物、思想）

2 [U] the fact of including many different types of people or things（人或事物的）多样性，多元化

facet /ˈfæsɪt/ *n.* [C] an aspect of sth. such as a situation or sb.'s character（情形或某人性格的）某一方面

insular /ˈɪnsjələ/ *a.* not interested in meeting anyone outside your own group or country, or not interested in learning new ideas or ways of doing things 与世隔绝的；思想狭隘的；故步自封的

drawback /ˈdrɔːbæk/ *n.* [C] a disadvantage of a situation, plan, product, etc. 不利因素；缺点；毛病

▲ jet lag /læg/ *n.* [U] the feeling of being very tired and sometimes confused because you have traveled quickly on a plane across parts of the world where the time is different 飞行时差综合征；时差反应

Phrases and expressions

on sale (*esp. AmE*) available to be bought at a lower price than usual 廉价出售

trade (sb.) sth. for sth. exchange sth., or stop using or doing sth. and start using or doing sth. else instead 用…交换…；用…更换…

endow sb. / sth. with sth. (*fml.*) give sth. to sb. or sth. 给予；赋予

be open to sth. be willing to consider or accept sth. 愿意考虑；愿意接受

more often than not usually 往往；通常；一贯

Proper names

Left Bank（巴黎的）左岸地区（位于塞纳河南岸）

Bulgaria /bʌlˈgeəriə/ 保加利亚（欧洲国家）

Louvre /ˈluːvrə/ 卢浮宫（博物馆，位于法国巴黎）

Machu Picchu /ˌmɑːtʃuː ˈpiːktʃuː/ 马丘比丘（秘鲁印加古城遗址）

Reading comprehension

Understanding the text

1 Answer the following questions.

1 What does the author mean by "The rest of the journey, however, can feel like a tedious lesson in the ills of modernity" (Para. 2)?
2 Why do we sometimes still need to travel in this digital age?
3 How do you understand the sentence "Because Paris is Paris" (Para. 4)?
4 What is the irony when people travel to Paris trying to leave all those problems behind?
5 How does a bit of distance help enhance creativity according to Para. 6?
6 What are the characteristics of seasoned travelers?
7 What do we need to do to trigger our creativity?
8 Why do we travel according to Para. 9?

Critical thinking

2 Work in pairs and discuss the following questions.

1 What other benefits can travel offer in addition to those mentioned in the text?
2 Do you agree that cultural differences are a big barrier to travel? Why or why not?
3 Do you think travel has an effect on our personalities? Why or why not?

Language focus

Words in use

3 Fill in the blanks with the words given below. Change the form where necessary. Each word can be used only once.

ambiguity cluster compulsory
contemplate drawback globalize
groan loosen offset stubborn

1 Thanks to its nine-year _____ education, China has one of the highest literacy rates in the world, which is a great achievement.
2 He has been _____ leaving the studio for some time and will be moving on to "new adventures".
3 Standards should be _____ to include more people in more types of jobs to increase diversity.
4 In the 1970s, the firm was restructured to _____ the business and pursue new areas of growth.
5 However, your current losses should soon be _____ by gains – the fund will produce a positive return of 11.6 percent over a nine-month period.
6 She pushed herself up into a sitting position to look around but immediately _____ in pain and fell back onto the blanket.
7 My mom was very _____ and unwilling to accept advice, but she became softer and nicer after reading this book.
8 On weekends, the school parking lot is almost empty except that a few cars _____ near the entrance.
9 In the photographer's finest pictures there is also a degree of _____, which allows them to be interpreted in a variety of ways.
10 The chief _____ to farming in these districts is the considerable proportion of stony ground.

Word building

-ize

与某些形容词或名词结合构成动词。具体说明请参阅 Unit 2 Word building 部分。

critic		criticize
emphasis		emphasize
hybrid		hybridize
memory	➔	**memorize**
stable		**stabilize**
victim		**victimize**
visual		**visualize**

-able

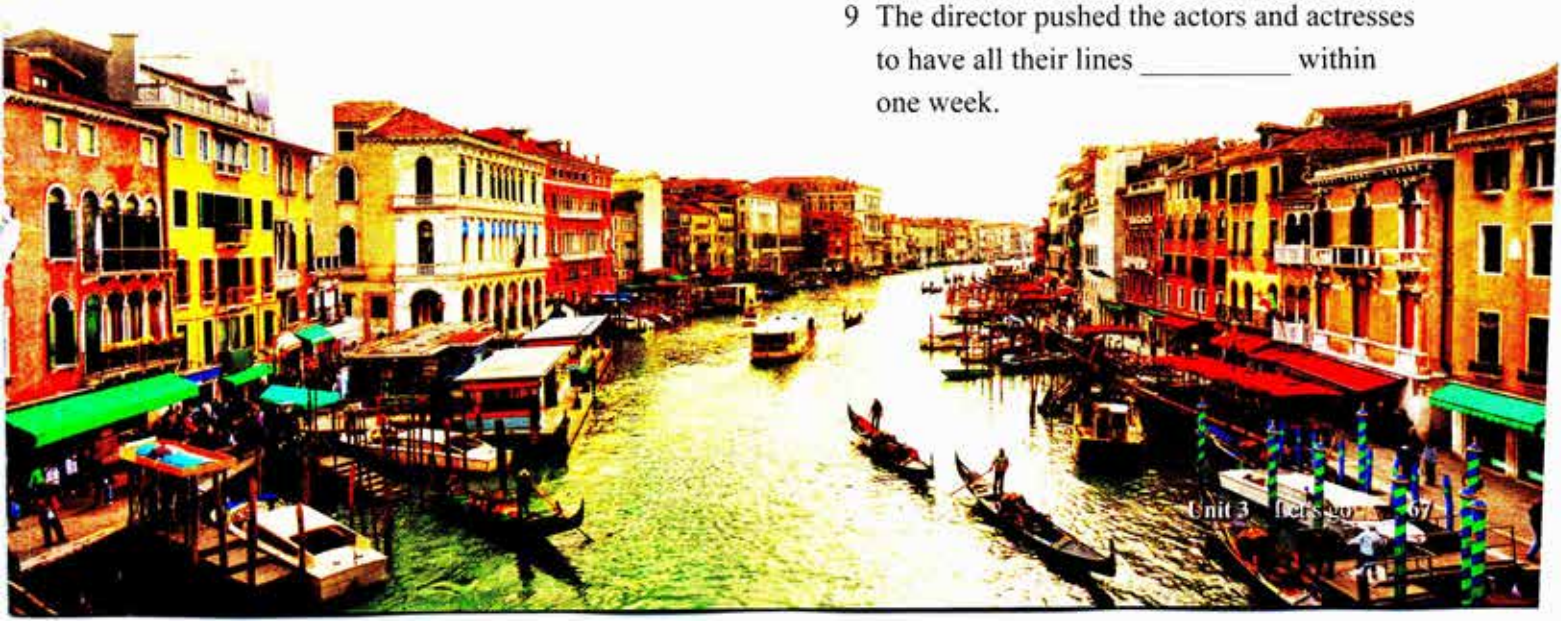
与某些动词结合构成形容词，表示“可……的”、“能……的”。

accept		acceptable
advise		advisable
foresee		foreseeable
attribute	➔	**attributable**
distinguish		**distinguishable**
negotiate		**negotiable**
profit		**profitable**
respect		**respectable**

4 Fill in the blanks with the words given below. Change the form where necessary. Each word can be used only once.

attributable distinguishable memorize
negotiable profitable respectable
stabilize victimize visualize

1 Despite the tougher trading conditions I am pleased to report that our company has yet again had a(n) _____ year.
2 We must take a deeper look at life and never _____ ourselves by undeserving guilt.
3 The company may be reluctant to deviate too far from the basic terms of this agreement, but there are a number of things which are _____.
4 Close your eyes and try to _____ that object in your mind, seeing it in precisely the same detail as before.
5 It is not possible to determine from raw data just how many accidents were directly _____ to excessive speed.
6 If you continue to be hard-working and honest in word and deed, you will become _____ members of society.
7 China will take more active measures to _____ the country's economic and social development.
8 These towns will hang up _____ new welcome signs in the hope of capturing the attention of visitors, giving them a reason to stop and explore the district.
9 The director pushed the actors and actresses to have all their lines _____ within one week.



Banked cloze

5 Fill in the blanks by selecting suitable words from the word bank. You may not use any of the words more than once.

A annoyances	**F** endows	**K** offsets
B cognitive	**G** immerse	**L** positivity
C console	**H** loosen	**M** recipe
D denoting	**I** luncheon	**N** trivial
E embracing	**J** nuances	**O** tropical

The benefits of travel go beyond making memories and meeting new people. Staying away from the 1) _____ things of daily life and exploring a new place can have a remarkably positive impact on your emotional well-being and your 2) _____ powers.

Travel can improve your emotional well-being in two aspects. First, changing your daily routine, for example, taking a trip to a nearby town on a weekend day, can help 3) _____ your mind and deal with the daily 4) _____. Second, physical exercise is known to improve emotional well-being and travel offers plenty of opportunities to get active. Getting to know a new destination by 5) _____ the great outdoors can boost energy levels and improve your mood.

Travel can also improve your cognitive powers due to the exposure to different cultures. Whether you venture abroad or simply to the next town over, a trip away from home can help enhance your 6) _____ and reveal a world of possibilities beyond your daily perspective. Something as simple as learning a new 7) _____ or changing the way you spend your downtime can have a dramatic effect on your well-being. It's been proven that new experiences – particularly ones that allow you to 8) _____ yourself in a different culture – improve the performance of your brain, 9) _____ the restrictions, and increase creativity.

Evidently, travel itself 10) _____ you with the freedom to do what you love, to rest, and to try something new. For many people, travel is not simply an enjoyable recreation, but an essential part of maintaining a positive mentality and improving cognitive abilities.

Expressions in use

6 Fill in the blanks with the expressions given below. Change the form where necessary. Each expression can be used only once.

be open to endow … with make up for
mingle with more often than not on sale
settle for trade … for

1 They should be more patient, and willing to _____ something less than their dream job at first.
2 The situations these explorers face are various, sometimes unpredictable, and _____, challenging.
3 As the voyage progressed, the soft, sweet tropical air _____ the fresh smell of the sea and gave the crew a delightful experience of ocean travel.
4 I bought too much milk so I _____ her my extra gallons _____ her bread.
5 You should learn to time your purchases so that you can buy the products when they're _____ and save money.
6 You need to let them know that you _____ their ideas and that you will do what it takes to get things done.
7 Herbs have been used for centuries to _____ a whole range of foods _____ subtle flavors.
8 The new research indicates that doing enough exercise could _____ some of the unhealthy impacts of bad sleep.

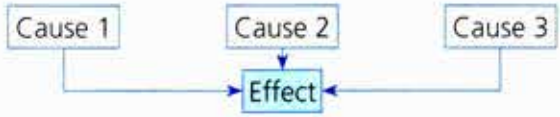
Structure analysis and writing

Structure analysis

Developing a cause-and-effect essay

Every day we ask questions and look for answers. We realize that an event does not occur without causes, and that it can have a series of effects. By examining the causes or effects of an event, we seek to understand and explain things that happen in our lives. The purpose of cause-and-effect essays is to explain to the reader: 1) the causes of an event; 2) the effects of an event; or 3) both causes and effects. In B2U6, you have gained some basic knowledge of cause-and-effect essays. In this unit, the focus will be on the causes of an event.

The usual logical pattern of a causal analysis essay is like this:



Text A of this unit is a typical causal analysis essay. Para. 1 is an interesting opening, attracting the reader's attention. In Para. 2, the author puts forward the thesis question: Why do we travel? Then from Para. 3 to Para. 8, the author provides an analysis of the reasons why we travel: First, we need to travel; second, we want to travel; and third, we can become more creative. However, the three causes are not of equal importance. The first two are direct causes and we can think of them easily while the last reason seems a little beyond our reach. The author apparently takes the third cause as something more important, and revealing this cause to the reader is the main purpose of Text A. The main body of the text is dedicated to the explanation of it. The last paragraph reaches a conclusion, restating the thesis in different words.

An interesting opening (Para. 1)	How the author struggles to get up in the early morning and gets to the flight gate after all the trouble; how he finally gets stuck at the airport.
Thesis question (Para. 2)	Why do we travel?
Three causes (Paras. 3-8)	We need to travel. (Para. 3) We want to travel. (Para. 4) We can improve our creativity. (Paras. 5-8)
Conclusion (Para. 9)	We travel because we need to and traveling helps change us.

As can be seen from the analysis above, a causal analysis essay begins with an introduction which briefly describes the effect, and then the entire body of the essay analyzes the causes.

When writing a causal analysis essay, try to remember the following requirements.

- Do not oversimplify causes.
- Beware especially of making a mistake in logic known as the fallacy of *post hoc, ergo propter hoc* – a Latin phrase meaning "after this, therefore because of this". Remember sequence does not always indicate causation.
- Distinguish between direct and indirect causes and between major and minor causes.
- Do not omit links in a chain of causes.
- Be objective and support the analysis with solid, factual evidence.

Structured writing

Read the sample essay and see how the causes are developed.

Topic
Why learn the Chinese language?

Introduction
Thesis statement: There are mainly three reasons for the widespread interest in Chinese.

Body
Cause 1: China's ancient culture has attracted many people in the world to learn Chinese.
Cause 2: China's rapid economic growth has attracted many people to learn Chinese.
Cause 3: The Chinese language itself has charm in its characters and pronunciation.

Conclusion
The Chinese language is sure to spread more widely in the world.

According to a survey, over 180 countries have conducted Chinese-language teaching programs and more than 4,000 foreign universities have established Chinese-language departments, majors, and courses. Why are more and more foreigners beginning to learn the Chinese language? I think there are mainly three reasons for the widespread interest in Chinese.

One of the reasons is that China's ancient culture has attracted many people from all over the world to learn Chinese. For example, many people are interested in Chinese poetry. To appreciate its rhythm and content, one needs to learn the Chinese language. Another reason is that China's rapid economic growth has attracted many people to learn Chinese. China is enjoying a fast economic growth which provides a lot of opportunities to people around the world. To do business conveniently with Chinese people, they want to learn the Chinese language. However, perhaps the primary reason to learn Chinese is that the Chinese language itself has charm. The Chinese characters can arouse a sense of beauty and are considered attractive. The pronunciation of Mandarin (普通话) is so beautiful and musical that it has attracted many foreigners to learn Chinese.

Many people believe that the Chinese language is sure to spread more widely as China opens up further to the outside world.

7 **Write an essay of no less than 140 words on one of the following topics. One topic has an outline that you can follow.**

Topic

Why reading books is important?

Introduction

Thesis statement: Reading books is important mainly due to three reasons.

Body

Cause 1: Reading books can broaden our knowledge and provide the experience that we can hardly have in our own life.

Cause 2: Reading books can exercise our brains and improve our mental health.

Cause 3: Reading books can increase empathy and make communication more efficient.

Conclusion

Reading books is an indispensable part of our lives and we should all form the habit of reading.

More topics

- The growing popularity of *hanfu* (traditional Chinese costumes)
- Why do we need to preserve local dialects?

Section B

Reading skills

Reading with background knowledge

Good readers draw on prior knowledge and experience to make connections which can help them understand better what they are reading. Their background knowledge enables them to read quickly through the text without stopping to consider whether what is recounted in the text makes sense. You can comprehend better when you make a text-to-self connection between a piece of reading material and your own life experiences. An example of a text-to-self connection might be, "This story reminds me of a vacation I took to my grandfather's hometown." Let's go further through reading Para. 1 of Text A.

It's 4:15 in the morning, and my alarm clock has just stolen away a lovely dream. I almost go back to sleep before my eye catches my packed suitcase and I groan, remembering that I'm going to the airport. The taxi is late and then lost, and I'm getting increasingly nervous that I'll miss my flight. I run in when we arrive, stagger through security, and finally get to my gate. After all the trouble of this morning, my flight is canceled and I'm stuck in this terminal for the next 218 minutes, and my only consolation is a cup of complimentary airport coffee. This is traveling, a burdensome series of running and waiting, and after countless hours, finally getting there.

While reading this paragraph, you probably get a picture of the scenario depicted by the author because what is described in the paragraph may remind you of some similar anecdotes you have personally experienced. Once you are able to connect what you are reading with what you have experienced, you can surely comprehend the paragraph better. More importantly, you can also well sense the underlying tone of the author. Why is it 4:15 in the morning? What is the relation between the alarm clock and the lovely dream? Why does the author "groan"? All these details will help evoke your memories and in-depth responses.

The text-to-self connection helps generate empathy with the author. Although the experiences of the reader may differ, the feeling recalled may be the same as that of the author and thus the reader can understand the author better. Please take a look at the following experiences that readers are reminded of.

- The situation described at the beginning of the paragraph reminds me of a time when I was going on a summer trip to France. I was supposed to leave for the airport at 6 a.m., but I just couldn't wake up naturally at this early hour. Without the alarm clock, I would have stayed in bed for the whole morning. Even though a summer trip to France can be beautiful and romantic, it could be painful to get up early in the morning. So, traveling is not always enjoyable and exciting.

- I know about this experience of being late for a flight because I personally had a very similar experience two years ago, when I almost missed the plane to China. As soon as I got to the airport and rushed to the check-in area, I was informed that the check-in counter was about to close. Tips for traveling – early birds get their worms. Leaving enough time to catch your plane, ship, train, or bus is always good advice for travelers.
- What's going on in this anecdote is just like what happened during my trip to the States. Due to a severe thunderstorm, my flight was delayed for several hours in Japan and then I was informed the flight had to be canceled. I was stuck in the terminal for the next 10 hours, cold and sleepy, and the only consolation was a box of complimentary vegetarian combo. The real torture of travel begins when you are stuck at the airport due to nasty weather or flight delays.

From the above examples of the text-to-self connection, you can see how this reading skill contributes to the reader's understanding of Para. 1 of the text. Remember that reading with your background knowledge not only connects you with the text, it also helps you think critically since your understanding of the text is continuously checked, confirmed, modified, or corrected during the reading process until you eventually come to understand the real purpose of the author. For example, in spite of the downside of travel mentioned at the beginning of the text, the author gradually leads the reader to its upside: our broadened perspective of the world.

1 Read Paras. 1, 2, and 8 of Text B and answer the following questions with your background knowledge.

1 Have you ever had an experience similar to that described in Para. 1? What do you think the author is driving at?

_____

_____

2 What does the description in Para. 2 remind you of concerning your own experience when you prepared for a journey to an unfamiliar place? What do you think the author really wants to tell us?

_____

_____

3 Has anything like what is depicted in Para. 8 ever happened to you when you traveled around? What do you think the author intends to express in this paragraph?

_____

_____

Text B

Traveling solo

1 So you're ready to travel. Pick a place, any place. Let's say you've always wanted to go to China. You've seen pictures of the Great Wall, the Forbidden City, and Tiananmen Square. You've always been fascinated by Chinese **aesthetics** and culture, by red, fragrant temples and **venerable statues**. You have a **chunk** of money saved and extra vacation time earned. Now is the time to go!

2 But maybe you haven't traveled much. You've never been to an exotic place where you can't speak the language or read the signs. A place where you'll have to do all the research for yourself, find hotels, get yourself around, buy train or bus tickets, and order your own food. You must figure all of this out while looking at the unfamiliar signs which you will see wherever you look or go.

3 So now you're ready to realize your dream to explore China, and find, for yourself, the soul of the country. Unfortunately, right from the **onset**, none of your friends share that dream. Your sister is **pregnant** and can't travel. Your best friend just got a new job and can't take time off. So what do you do? You could ask everyone you know – friends, acquaintances, co-workers. You could join a tour. Or, you could go alone.

4 To travel alone is a difficult decision for anyone, but for me, it came naturally. I made that trip to China, and then **zigzagged** on a multinational tour through South Korea, Japan, Indonesia, Thailand, India, and Italy.

5 But the reactions I've gotten, from people I know, fellow travelers, and especially, from the natives of the countries I've visited, showed me that solo traveling is strange, and even considered **inconceivable** or **reckless**. People ask me if the **isolation** makes me sad or even if I'm more **susceptible** to violent or dangerous situations.

6 Traveling solo has been sometimes a blessing, sometimes a curse. I remember searching desperately for accommodations in China. The university listed in my **booklet** no longer had dormitories for travelers, and I was lucky when the desk clerk called a young woman out of a nearby office. As it turned out, she was offering to let me stay at her flat and even had a friend come and show me around the next day.



a blessing overall!



7 Also in China, I met two girls who accompanied me to my booked hotel when I had been lost for several hours, and then invited me to a **feast** with their friends. When they heard my next stop was their hometown, they arranged for a **bilingual** friend to pick me up at the train station.

8 But there has also been the **downside** because of those not-so-pleasant experiences. In Indonesia, a boy **menaced** me, assuming I was willing to pay for his company. In Japan, I was picked up by a young man who refused to drop me at my **youth hostel**; he insisted I stay with his friends. The friends turned out to be four girls. I was safe, but one **snored** like a **lawnmower**, and it took me two days to escape.

9 I've been **irritated** and **perplexed** many times – not speaking a language, not understanding or being understood. Once, in Italy, a hotel clerk tried to overcharge me and only gave up after 10 minutes of arguing. Another time in India, a taxi driver insisted I pay more, and I was rescued by the doorman of a fancy hotel.

10 Having a companion might have helped **safeguard** me from some of those problems. But it would have **suppressed** other opportunities – a long afternoon in Thailand all alone in the back of a **hay wagon** and then seven days in the back of a truck with a **Brit**, two **Aussies**, and two **Norwegians**! Eating **ethnic** food on my way through eastern South Korea with four youthful Japanese salarymen. Getting sick in Italy, and being nursed with chocolate bars and **tissues** by a couple from the U.S.

11 The few times I have traveled with a companion, I haven't had the same **ample** opportunity to meet people. Other travelers can **swap** stories with you about the local **folklore** of the places they've been to and often have credible insights into the place you're visiting. Locals are also more likely to see you as approachable and be **upfront** with you when you're on your own.

12 Of course you have to be careful not to endanger yourself by throwing **caution** to the wind. Watch your back, but don't **presume** the worst and be overly fearful. Be friendly with people, but watch out for those who are too friendly with you. Don't **disregard** your instincts. If you hear stories about criminals on a road, you may take the road, but don't take much cash, and don't accept drinks from strangers.

13 The key to solo travel is to open your mind, close your eyes, and **leap** in! Everything that happens to you is an experience, and good, bad, or **neutral**, it will benefit you in some way. Take those little annoyances, those inefficiencies, and those boring **bureaucrats** with a laugh. If you **despise** something, just remember: You don't live there, you can leave anytime, and you'll never have to deal with this again!

14 Don't ever let a lack of companionship **constrain** you from doing what you really want to do. Once you go solo, you'll be amazed at how **sensational** your travel experiences will be.

(902 words)

New words

solo /ˈsəʊləʊ/
ad. alone 单独地；独自地
a. (*only before noun*) done by one person alone, without any help 单独的；独自的
n. [C] a piece of music or a part of a piece of music that is performed by one person 独奏（曲）；独唱（曲）

aesthetics /iːsˈθetɪks/ *n.* [U] the study of the nature of beauty, esp. in arts such as painting and architecture（审）美学

venerable /ˈvenərəbəl/ *a.* (*fml.*) deserving respect because of age, high position, or historical importance 德高望重的；令人尊敬的；崇高神圣的

▲ **statue** /ˈstætʃuː/ *n.* [C] an image of a person or animal that is made in solid material such as stone or metal and is usu. large 雕像；塑像

chunk /tʃʌŋk/ *n.* [C]
1 a large amount or part of sth. 大量；大部分
2 a large thick piece of sth. 厚块；大块

onset /ˈɒnset/ *n.* [sing.] **(the ~ of sth.)** the beginning of sth., esp. sth. bad（尤指某种坏事情的）开始，发作

▲ **pregnant** /ˈpregnənt/ *a.* if a woman or female animal is pregnant, she has an unborn baby growing inside her body 怀孕的；妊娠的

zigzag /ˈzɪgzæg/
vi. move forward in a line that makes very sharp angles, going suddenly from one direction to another 曲折地行进
n. [C] a pattern that looks like a line of z's joined together Z 字形；之字形；锯齿纹

conceive /kənˈsiːv/ *vt.*
1 (*usu. in negatives or questions*) imagine sth. or think of doing sth. 想象；想出
2 (*often passive*) think of sth. such as a new idea, plan, or design 构想；设想

inconceivable /ˌɪnkənˈsiːvəbəl/ *a.* too strange or unusual to be thought real or possible 难以置信的；不可思议的

reckless /ˈrekləs/ *a.* not thinking about the possible bad effects of your actions 轻率的；鲁莽的

▲ **isolation** /ˌaɪsəˈleɪʃən/ *n.* [U] the state of being separated from other people, or a situation in which you do not have the support of other people 隔离；孤立；分离

susceptible /səˈseptəbəl/ *a.* easily influenced or affected by sth. 易受影响的

booklet /ˈbʊklɪt/ *n.* [C] a small thin book that gives you information about sth. 小册子

feast /fiːst/
n. [C] a large meal 盛宴
vi. eat and drink a lot on a special occasion 大吃大喝

bilingual /baɪˈlɪŋgwəl/ *a.*
1 able to speak two languages equally well 会说两种语言的
2 involving or written in two languages 两种语言的；用两种语言写成的；双语的

downside /ˈdaʊnsaɪd/ *n.* [sing.] **(the ~)** the disadvantage or negative aspect of sth.（事物的）不利方面，消极面

menace /ˈmenɪs/
vt. threaten sb. or sth. 威胁；恐吓
n. 1 [C] sb. or sth. that is dangerous and likely to cause harm 危险人物；危险事物；威胁
2 [U] a threatening quality, feeling , or way of behaving 威胁；恐吓

youth hostel /ˈhɒstl/ *n.* [C] a place where people, esp. young people who are traveling, can stay very cheaply for a short time 青年旅社

snore /snɔː/

vi. breathe noisily while you sleep 打鼾

n. [C] a sound you make when you breathe noisily while you sleep 鼾声；呼噜声

lawnmower /ˈlɔːnməʊə/ *n.* [C] a machine that you use to cut grass 割草机；刈草机

irritate /ˈɪrɪteɪt/ *vt.*

1 make you feel annoyed or impatient 使烦躁；使不耐烦

2 hurt a part of your body, making it painful, red, or swollen 使疼痛；使发红；使肿胀

irritated /ˈɪrɪteɪtɪd/ *a.*

1 annoyed or impatient about sth. 被激怒的；不耐烦的

2 painful, red, or swollen 疼痛的；发红的；肿胀的

perplex /pəˈpleks/ *vt.* make you feel confused and worried because it is difficult to understand 使困惑；使茫然；使费解

perplexed /pəˈplekst/ *a.* confused and worried by sth. that you do not understand 困惑的；茫然的

safeguard /ˈseɪfgɑːd/

vt. protect sb. or sth. from being harmed or having problems 保卫；保护

n. [C] a law, rule, plan, etc. that protects sb. or sth. from harm or problems 保障条款；预防措施

suppress /səˈpres/ *vt.*

1 prevent sth. from growing or developing, or from working effectively 抑制（生长、发展、起作用等）

2 stop people from opposing the government, esp. by using force（尤指用武力）镇压，制止，压制

3 stop yourself from showing your feelings 抑制，克制（感情）

▲ **hay** /heɪ/ *n.* [U] grass that has been cut and dried and is used as food for animals（作饲料用的）干草，草料

▲ **wagon** /ˈwægən/ *n.* [C] a strong vehicle with four wheels, used for carrying heavy loads and usu. pulled by horses（一般由马拉的）四轮运货车

Brit /brɪt/ *n.* [C] (*infml.*) 英国人

Aussie /ˈɒzi/ *n.* [C] (*infml.*) 澳大利亚人

Norwegian /nɔːˈwiːdʒən/ *n.* [C] 挪威人

▲ **ethnic** /ˈeθnɪk/ *a.*

1 **(~ cooking / fashion / design, etc.)** cooking, fashion, design, etc. from countries that are far away, which seems very different and unusual 具有异国风情的烹调 / 时尚 / 设计等

2 relating to a particular race, nation, or tribe and their customs and traditions 种族（或民族、部落）的；具有种族（或民族、部落）特色的

▲ **tissue** /ˈtɪʃuː/ *n.*

1 [C] a piece of soft thin paper used esp. for wiping your nose（尤指擤鼻子用的）纸巾，面巾纸

2 [U] the substance that animal and plant cells are made of（动植物细胞的）组织

▲ **ample** /ˈæmpəl/ *a.* (*usu. before noun*) enough, and often more than you need 足够的；充裕的；丰富的

swap /swɒp/ *v.* give sth. to sb. in exchange for sth. else 交换

folklore /ˈfəʊklɔː/ *n.* [U] the traditional stories, customs, etc. of a particular area or country 民间传说；民俗

upfront /ˌʌpˈfrʌnt/ *a.* (*infml.*) completely honest and not trying to hide anything 坦率的；无保留的

▲ **caution** /ˈkɔːʃən/ *n.* [U] careful thought and lack of hurry in order to try to avoid risks or danger 小心；谨慎；慎重

presume /prɪˈzjuːm/ *vt.* think sth. is true because it is likely, although you cannot be certain 假设；认为

disregard /ˌdɪsrɪˈgɑːd/

vt. not consider sth. important or pay any attention to it 漠视；轻视

n. [sing., U] the attitude of sb. who does not respect sth. or consider it important 漠视；轻视

▲ **leap** /liːp/ *vi.* (**leapt**, **leapt** *or* **leaped**, **leaped**) (always + *ad.* / *prep.*)

1 jump or spring a long way, to a great height, or with great force 跳；跳跃

2 move quickly and suddenly 飞快移动

▲ **neutral** /ˈnjuːtrəl/ *a.*

1 of no distinctive quality, characteristics, or type; indifferent 无倾向性的

2 not supporting or helping either side in a disagreement, competition, etc. 中立的；不偏不倚的

bureaucrat /ˈbjʊərəkræt/ *n.* [C] an official working in an organization or a government department, esp. one who follows the rules of the department too strictly 官僚主义者；官僚

despise /dɪˈspaɪz/ *vt.* hate sb. or sth. and have no respect for them 鄙视；藐视；看不起

constrain /kənˈstreɪn/ *vt.* (*fml.*)

1 limit sb.'s freedom to do what they want 限制；约束

2 (*usu. passive*) force sb. to do sth. that they do not want to do 强迫；迫使

sensational /senˈseɪʃənəl/ *a.*

1 very exciting and surprising 轰动的；激动人心的

2 intended to interest, excite, or shock people – used to show disapproval 大肆渲染的，耸人听闻的（含贬义）

Phrases and expressions

take time off have a particular amount of time away from work 从工作时间抽出（时间）；休假

show sb. around / round (sth.) lead sb. around a place for the first time, so that they can see all parts of it 带…参观；给…做向导

pick sb. up let sb. get into your car, boat, etc. and take them somewhere 搭载；接载

safeguard sb. / sth. from / against sth. protect sb. or sth. against sth. 保护…免遭…

swap sth. with sb. exchange sth. with sb. 跟…交换…

throw / cast caution to the wind(s) stop being careful and do sth. you know has risks 不顾一切；鲁莽行事

watch one's back make sure that no one does anything to harm or trick you 警惕；提防

watch (out) for sth. pay close attention in a particular situation because you are expecting sth. to happen or you want to avoid sth. bad 密切注意；留意

open one's mind (to sth.) be ready to consider or accept new ideas 乐于考虑（或接受）（新观念）

constrain sb. from (doing) sth. restrict or hinder sb. from doing sth. 限制…做…

Reading comprehension

Understanding the text

2 Choose the best answer to each of the following questions.

1 What was people's reaction to the author's traveling alone?
- A They thought it boring.
- B They thought it rewarding.
- C They thought it came naturally.
- D They thought it hard to believe.

2 What did the author experience in China?
- A A desk clerk offered to lend her a flat.
- B Two girls invited her to their hotel room.
- C A bilingual person picked her up at the train station.
- D The university listed in her booklet supplied a nice dormitory to her.

3 What do we know about the author's experience in Japan?
- A She was picked up by a girl at the airport.
- B It took her two hours to find her youth hostel.
- C A girl who stayed with her snored like a lawnmower.
- D A boy menaced her and refused to drop her at the right place.

4 Which of the following is not true during the author's solo travels?
- A A couple from the U.S. nursed her with chocolate bars and tissues in Italy.
- B She spent a long afternoon in Thailand all alone in the back of a hay wagon.
- C For seven days she traveled in a truck with a Brit, two Aussies, and two Norwegians.
- D She ate ethnic food with four Chinese students on her way through eastern South Korea.

5 Which of the following is not a strategy suggested by the author to protect yourself from danger in solo travel?
- A Presume the worst and be careful.
- B Watch out for those who are too friendly with you.
- C Be careful not to endanger yourself by throwing caution to the wind.
- D Carry less cash if you hear stories about criminals on the road.

6 What is the key to solo travel according to the author?
- A To open your mind.
- B To stay away from danger.
- C Not to take much cash.
- D Not to be overly fearful.

7 What do we know about the author and her solo travels?
- A She wasn't susceptible to dangerous situations.
- B Only a few of her friends shared her dream of exploring China.
- C It was very hard for the author to make the decision to travel alone.
- D Her travel proved to be worthwhile despite unpleasant experiences.

8 What idea does the author intend to convey?
- A Traveling solo is difficult.
- B Traveling solo in general is a blessing.
- C Traveling solo usually makes one irritated and perplexed.
- D Traveling solo is more exciting than traveling with a companion.

Critical thinking

3 Work in pairs and discuss the following questions.

1 What are the differences between traveling solo and traveling with a companion?
2 Apart from what is mentioned in the text, can you think of any other strategies to protect yourself from danger in solo travel?
3 Will you constrain yourself from doing what you really want to do because of a lack of companionship? Why or why not?

Collocation

More language exercises

You might have the ***lovely dream*** (B3U3A) to go to places you have dreamed of seeing, because you are not satisfied with merely ***swapping stories*** (B3U3B) about them with friends. Once you have some ***pleasant experiences*** (B3U3B) in ***multinational tours*** (B3U3B), you'll realize the need to always have a ***valuable open-mindedness*** (B3U3A) and ***mental flexibility*** (B3U3A) when exposed to the ***disorienting diversity*** (B3U3A) of human traditions in ***foreign travel*** (B3U3A). You might also be aware of the need to have a more focused goal or travel purpose, whether it is to learn a new language or a new skill important in the ***digital age*** (B3U3A) and the ***globalized world*** (B3U3A). Sometimes the goals are serious, like learning the technology of ***modern aviation*** (B3U3A) or collecting ideas for your course project. Sometimes they are less formal, like learning the ***local folklore*** (B3U3B) or mingling with ***bilingual friends*** (B3U3B). No matter what, they'll keep you feeling like you're leaving the ***exotic place*** (B3U3B) with a bit more ***credible insights*** (B3U3B). Having such a focus also creates a stronger connection between you and the places you visit, which naturally leads to ***ample opportunity*** (B3U3B) that you might have missed otherwise.

4 Complete the following passage by filling in the blanks with appropriate collocations from the texts. You are provided with the first letter(s) for each of the collocations. Change the form where necessary.

I recall my first few years of wandering, a period of time that saw me in a constant vacation mode as I hopped between countries. At that time, I was excited to find myself in 1) *ex*_____ *pl*_____ even if I just stayed in a guesthouse for a few days. And I thought I had the most wonderful life – my 2) *lo*_____ *dr*_____.

Then one day, just over three years into my adventure, I realized that my 3) *mul*_____ *t*_____ were really leading me nowhere. Apart from having quite a few "cool" and 4) *pl*_____ *ex*_____, I was barely learning and barely improving myself. To make sure I still had some money left for a few more weeks of 5) *for*_____ *tr*_____, I had to constantly check my bank account.

So, I decided to change the way I traveled. For example, I would go to India to seek opportunities for volunteer work, to South America to practice my Spanish, to Eastern Europe to experience the 6) *dis*_____ *di*_____ of the region, and to Australia to create my first source of online income while learning the 7) *lo*_____ *fo*_____ in a city I love. More recently, I lived in Mexico in order to learn how to ride waves. Now, I'm in Thailand in order to 8) *s*_____ *st*_____ with other travelers.

Everything has a purpose. No more aimlessness for me. I really believe that for anyone interested in travel made possible by 9) *m*_____ *a*_____, having goals is vital. Traveling with a sense of purpose can help you gain 10) *cr*_____ *in*_____, maximize personal growth, endow you with a 11) *val*_____ *op*_____ toward cultural diversity, and develop your 12) *m*_____ *flex*_____ to prepare you for new challenges in this increasingly 13) *glo*_____ *w*_____. This will prove useful at some point in your life.

Stories of China

Touring the world after 60

Zhang Guangzhu and his wife Wang Zhongjin have set foot on every continent, even Antarctica. In their global escapades (冒险) they've filled many passports with travel visas and customs stamps from dozens of countries. Travels of this sort, daunting (令人畏惧的) for even the most experienced travelers, require a young heart and youthful vigor – and yet Zhang and Wang are in their 60s, retired, and making the most of their free time in their post-career life.

Like other Chinese senior citizens, Zhang and Wang were committed to their families and work, and traveling was not a priority option when they were younger. After retiring, Zhang decided to capitalize on this new-found opportunity to travel. The couple used their life savings to fund their expedition around the world.

The husband and wife began their experience as backpackers (背包客) by hitting the trails of the Tiger Leaping Gorge, a deep and beautiful scenic valley in southwest China's Yunnan Province. In a village at the foot of a mountain, they bumped into a foreign tourist who was traveling in China but spoke little Chinese. They were inspired by their foreign friend's attitude to life and were bitten by the travel bug (迷上旅行). "If the language barrier does not matter when people travel," Zhang recalled saying to his wife, "why don't we go abroad?" His wife agreed.



Tiger Leaping Gorge, China

The two then took an 88-day journey to 16 European countries. Despite careful travel preparation, the couple still got lost at the airport in Athens, Greece, upon arriving at their first destination. Even so, their enthusiasm was high and they were off to travel as strangers in a strange land.

Since their European escapade, the couple has taken up traveling abroad as a hobby. Each year, they spend six months with family in Beijing and the next six traveling. "My wife and I have been to many astonishing places, from the Arctic Circle to Antarctica. We have crossed the equator six times. We also climbed to the base camp of Mount Qomolangma at an altitude of 5,200 meters," said Zhang. "A person may have a lot of dreams. But putting them into practice is the key. Even if you retire at 60, you can still expect to live another 20 to 30 years. Therefore, retired people should make a good plan to spend the rest of their lives."

The past decades have witnessed great miracles in China, and people's living standards have improved dramatically with economic and social prosperity. As most families have become better off, older people, like Zhang and Wang, are enjoying their carefree lives traveling home and abroad.

Exercises

Translation

Translate the following paragraph into English.

丽江古城坐落在玉龙雪山（Yulong Snow Mountain）脚下，是一座风景秀丽的历史文化名城，也是我国保存完好的少数民族古城之一。随着丽江旅游业的发展，到丽江古城观光游览的中外游客日益增多。1997 年 12 月，丽江古城申报世界文化遗产（World Cultural Heritage Site）获得成功，成为中国第一批被列入世界文化遗产名录的历史文化名城。

Unit project

Planning a three-day trip

Traveling can be a fun way to gain life experience. In this unit project, you will be required to plan a three-day trip. While planning such a trip might seem like an easy task, it is actually a bit more difficult than you might think initially and involves a lot of important work. You should take all of the basics into consideration, and thinking about them in advance will make a huge difference in your overall enjoyment of the journey!

Step 1 **Work in groups of three or four and decide on a destination.**

Step 2 **Search for information and discuss with your group members your travel plan. Make sure that your plan is realistic and manageable. Here are the things you could take into account in your discussion.**

- Budget
- Places you'd like to visit
- Things you'd like to take
- Transportation and accommodations
- Detailed schedule

Step 3 **Draw up the plan for your three-day trip. Present the information in a clear way, for example, by using bullet points to make it easier to read.**

Step 4 **Present your plan to the class.**

Unit

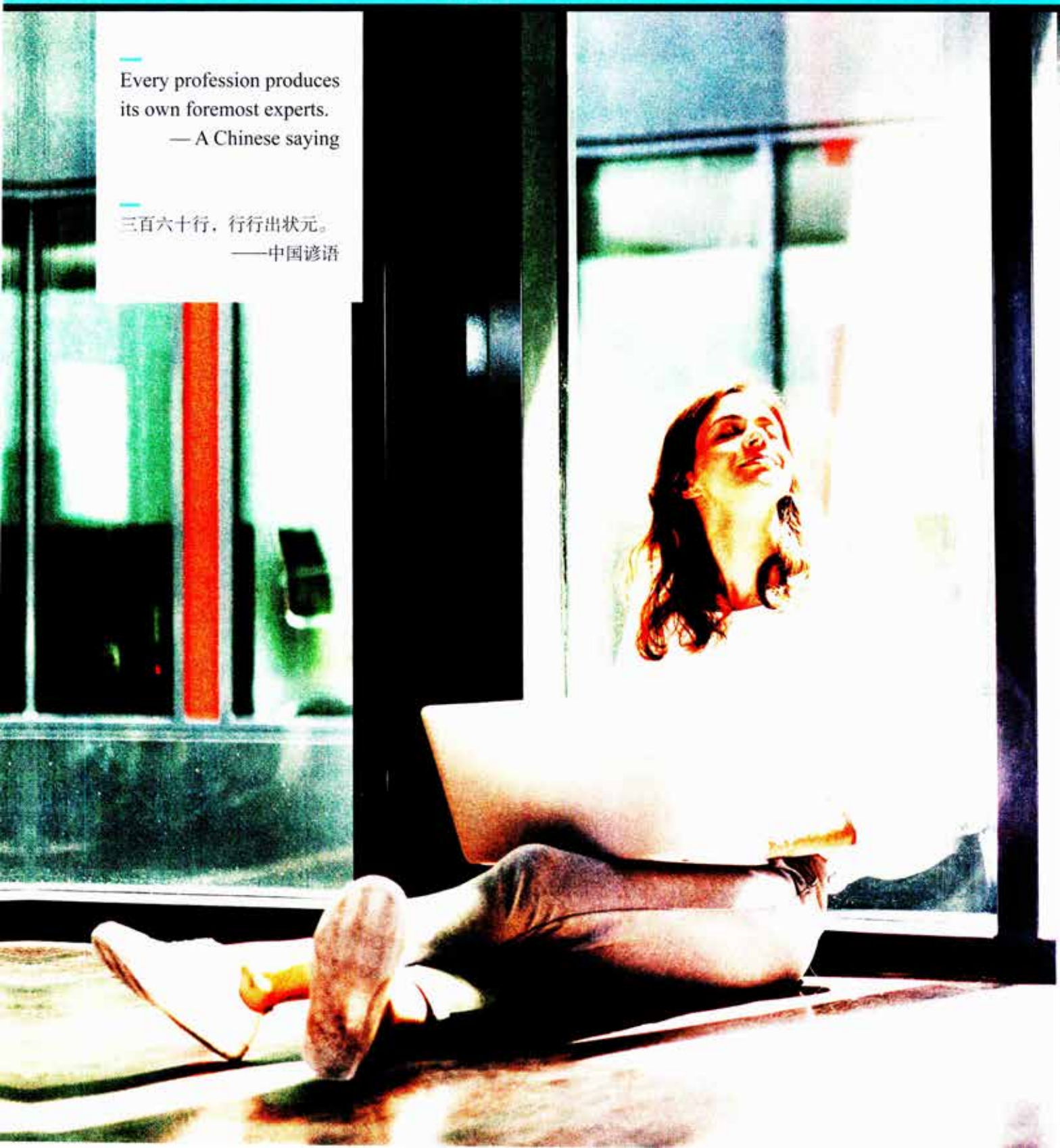
4 When work is a pleasure

Every profession produces its own foremost experts.

— A Chinese saying

三百六十行，行行出状元。

——中国谚语



Preview

As you grow up and become adults you learn to work. It may be a simple job helping your parents, your teachers, the neighbor next door, or a job you take up as a career. Whatever job you do, just as "building a high-rise begins with mounds of soil", you have to take one step at a time and **approach your work with a firm footing**.

Nowadays, most people work hard, but some may enjoy their work while others may find the work difficult and tiring. There are also differences in the way people deal with their work. While some just work for the sake of money, others, always keeping people's needs in mind, may try to **build their self-esteem, responsibility, and pride into their work**. What do you look for in a job? What attitudes toward work do you think are appropriate? How are you going to dedicate yourself to your work and have pride in it?



Section A

Pre-reading activities

1 How would you choose your job? Rate each statement below and circle the number that represents your opinion.

1 = Not at all important 3 = Moderately important 5 = Extremely important
2 = Slightly important 4 = Very important

When deciding on a job, it is important for me to know ...

1 the chance of advancing to a higher position.
1 2 3 4 5

2 how much the job pays.
1 2 3 4 5

3 how much responsibility the job involves.
1 2 3 4 5

4 the stress level of the job.
1 2 3 4 5

5 the location of the workplace.
1 2 3 4 5

6 the corporate culture.
1 2 3 4 5

7 whether the job aligns with my interest.
1 2 3 4 5

8 whether the job is compatible with my personality.
1 2 3 4 5

9 whether the industry has a promising future.
1 2 3 4 5

10 the work's contribution to society.
1 2 3 4 5

2 Work in pairs and discuss the following questions.

1 Which factor(s) in Activity 1 do you value most in your job? Why?
2 What kind of job would you like to do in the future, which may meet both your personal interest and the needs of our society? Explain your choice to your partner.



Text A

Will you be a worker or a laborer?

1 To be truly happy, a person must feel both free and important. People are never happy if they feel compelled to do work they do not enjoy, or if what they do enjoy is ignored as having no value or importance. In a society where slavery in the strict sense has been **abolished**, the social indications around work, the value of work, and the salary, have **degraded** many laborers into modern slaves – "wage slaves".

2 People are considered laborers if their jobs have an **adverse** effect on them, yet they feel compelled to continue working by the necessity of **conforming** to societal expectations and earning the **revenue** to support themselves and their families. The **polar** opposite of labor is play. When we play a game, we enjoy what we are doing, but it is a purely private **pastime**; society does not care when or whether we play.



3 Between labor and play stands work. People are labeled as workers if their personal interests **coincide** with the jobs society pays them to do; what is necessary labor from the point of view of society is **voluntary** play from the individual's personal point of view. Whether a job is to be **designated** as labor or work depends, not on the job itself, but on the tastes of the individual who undertakes it. The difference does not, for example, **correlate** with the difference between a **manual** and mental job or between jobs with low or high income; a gardener covered in dirt in a greenhouse may be a worker while a well-dressed city **mayor** may prove to be an unhappy laborer!

4 Whether people are workers or laborers can be seen from their attitude toward leisure. To workers, leisure means simply the hours they need to relax and rest in order to work efficiently. Workers are therefore more likely to dedicate more time to working, taking too little leisure rather than too much. To laborers, on the other hand, leisure means **autonomy** from compulsion, so it is natural for them to imagine that the fewer hours they have to spend laboring, and the more hours they have free for play, the better.

5 Besides the hours spent in leisure, workers and laborers differ in the amount of personal satisfaction they derive from their jobs. Workers who enjoy their jobs will be happier, less stressed, and generally more satisfied with their lives. They will also work with more **diligence** and **precision** because they have **fostered** a sense of personal pride in their jobs. On the other hand, laborers, whose sole incentive is earning their **livelihood**, feel that the time they spend on the daily **grind** is wasted and doesn't contribute to their happiness. Instead of valuing all 24 hours of their day as enjoyable and productive hours, they **gauge** only the time spent in leisure and play as meaningful. Laborers are **commonplace** in society, but still many people are in the lucky position of being workers.

6 In recent decades, technological innovation and the division of labor have caused major economic changes by eliminating the need for special strengths or skills in many fields and have turned many paid occupations with enjoyable work into boring labor. Increasing productivity with **automated** machines, such as robots, has reduced the number of necessary laboring hours. It is possible to imagine an **upcoming** society in which the majority of the population will have almost as much leisure time as in earlier times was enjoyed by the **medieval aristocracy**. The medieval aristocrats had an abundance of leisure time but often wasted it in trivial **pursuit** of games and fashion. Likewise, modern day laborers with too much leisure time may find it difficult to **refrain** from the addictive and trivial pursuits of **celebrity gossip**, **extravagant** fashion, and excessive video games and TV – similar bad habits that waste valuable time.

7 However, it's not necessary to take such a **toxic** attitude toward such a positive thing as leisure time. In fact, in many countries, people now use their leisure time to improve their minds and their working conditions to create a happier, more contented life. Lifelong learning can make the difference between being **bored**, unhappy laborers and workers who find meaning and joy in their employment and lives. "Continuing education" or "experiential learning" can offer an **array** of classes from pleasant **diversions** such as sports, art, or music, to leadership development or advanced accounting skills, to name but a few.

8 All in all, people's attitude toward their work determines everything. Whatever the job, people who enjoy their work find time passes quickly. They **hurl** their passion into their work, be it physical like the work of a smith, or more mental like that of a scientist or an artist. Even purely mental work can **suffice** as an **outlet**, as **aptly** expressed by the phrase "sinking one's teeth into a problem".

9 Eventually, everyone has to find a job and earn a living. Laborers are slaving away at a job they don't enjoy for a **monetary** reward, waiting all day until they go home and play. But while laborers are counting down the hours, workers are energized and focused, taking **optimum** pleasure in the task at hand. By choosing a job that is both useful to society and personally fulfilling, workers maintain a simultaneous sense of purpose and enthusiasm that improves their whole lives. So in the end, whatever job you choose, you must **contend** with this essential question: Will you be a laborer or a worker?

(916 words)

New words

▲ **abolish** /əˈbɒlɪʃ/ *vt.* officially end a law, system, etc., esp. one that has existed for a long time 废除，废止（尤指已存在很久的法律、制度等）

degrade /dɪˈgreɪd/ *vt.* show or treat sb. in a way that makes them seem not worth any respect or not worth taking seriously 降低…的身份；侮辱…的人格；使受屈辱

adverse /ˈædvɜːs/ *a.* not good or favorable 不利的；有害的；反面的

▲ **conform** /kənˈfɔːm/ *vi.*

1 (**~ to a pattern / model / ideal, etc.**) be similar to what people expect or think is usual 遵照某种模式 / 范例 / 理想等

2 behave in the way that most other people in your group or society behave 从众；顺应大多数人

▲ **revenue** /ˈrevənjuː/ *n.* [U] income, esp. when of a company or organization and of a substantial nature（尤指公司或组织数额庞大的）收入，收益

▲ **polar** /ˈpəʊlə/ *a.*

1 (**~ opposite / extreme**) sth. that is the complete or exact opposite of sth. else 完全相反；正好相反

2 close to or relating to the North Pole or the South Pole 近地极的；地极的；极地的

▲ **pastime** /ˈpɑːstaɪm/ *n.* [C] sth. that you do because you think it is enjoyable or interesting 消遣；娱乐

coincide /ˌkəʊənˈsaɪd/ *vi.*

1 (of ideas, opinions, etc.) be the same or very similar（想法、意见等）相同，相符，极为类似

2 (of two or more events) take place at the same time（两件或更多的事情）同时发生

▲ **voluntary** /ˈvɒləntəri/ *a.* done willingly and without being forced 自愿的；自动的

designate /ˈdezɪgneɪt/ *vt.* (*often passive*)

1 say officially that sb. or sth. has a particular character or name; describe sb. or sth. in a particular way 命名；指定

2 formally choose sb. or sth. for a particular purpose 任命；选定；选派

correlate /ˈkɒrəleɪt/ *vi.* have a mutual relationship or connection, in which one thing affects or depends on another 相关；关联

▲ **manual** /ˈmænjuəl/ *a.* (of work, etc.) involving using the hands or physical strength（工作等）用手的，手工的，体力的

▲ **mayor** /meə/ *n.* [C] the person who has been elected to lead the government of a town or city 市长

autonomy /ɔːˈtɒnəmi/ *n.* [U]

1 the ability or opportunity to make your own decisions without being controlled by anyone else 自主能力；自主权

2 freedom that a place or an organization has to govern or control itself 自治；自治权

▲ **diligence** /ˈdɪlɪdʒəns/ *n.* [U] (*fml.*) careful work or great effort 勤勉；勤奋；用功

▲ **precision** /prɪˈsɪʒən/ *n.* [U] the quality of being very exact or correct 精确（性）；准确（性）

foster /ˈfɒstə/ *vt.* help a skill, feeling, idea, etc. develop over a period of time 促进；培养；助长

▲ **livelihood** /ˈlaɪvlihʊd/ *n.* [C, U] the way you earn money in order to live 生计

▲ **grind** /graɪnd/

n. [sing.] sth. that is hard work and physically or mentally tiring 苦差事

vt. (**ground, ground**) (*also* **~ up**) break sth. such as corn or coffee beans into small pieces or powder, either in a machine or between two hard surfaces 磨碎；碾碎；把…磨成粉

gauge /geɪdʒ/
vt. make a judgment or guess about a situation, action, or person based on the information that you have（根据所掌握的信息）估计，判断
n. [C] an instrument for measuring the size or amount of sth. 测量仪器；计量器；量规

▲ **commonplace** /ˈkɒmənpleɪs/ *a.* happening or existing in many places, and therefore not special or unusual 常见的；屡见不鲜的

▲ **automate** /ˈɔːtəmeɪt/ *vt.* start using computers and machines to do a job, rather than people 使自动化

automated /ˈɔːtəmeɪtɪd/ *a.* using computers and machines to do a job, rather than people 自动化的

upcoming /ˈʌpˌkʌmɪŋ/ *a.* (*only before noun*) happening soon 即将发生的；即将来临的

medieval /ˌmediˈiːvəl/ *a.* connected with the Middle Ages 中世纪的；中古时期的

aristocracy /ˌærəˈstɒkrəsi/ *n.* [C, usu. sing.] (in some countries) the people in the highest social class, who traditionally have a lot of land, money, and power（某些国家的）贵族

▲ **pursuit** /pəˈsjuːt/ *n.*
1 [U] the act of looking for or trying to find sth. 追求；寻找
2 [C, usu. pl.] (*fml.*) an activity such as a sport or hobby, which you spend a lot of time doing 消遣；嗜好；爱好

▲ **refrain** /rɪˈfreɪn/ *vi.* (*fml.*) (**~ from**) not do sth. that you want to do 克制；抑制；忍住

celebrity /səˈlebrəti/ *n.* [C] a famous living person 名人；明星

▲ **gossip** /ˈgɒsɪp/ *n.* [U] information that is passed from one person to another about other people's behavior and private lives, often including unkind or untrue remarks 流言蜚语；闲言碎语；传闻

extravagant /ɪkˈstrævəgənt/ *a.* spending or costing a lot of money, esp. more than is necessary or more than you can afford 奢侈的；挥霍的

toxic /ˈtɒksɪk/ *a.*
1 extremely harsh, malicious, or harmful 极其使人不快的；造成危害的
2 containing poison, or caused by poisonous substances 有毒的；由有毒物质引起的

bored /bɔːd/ *a.* tired and impatient because you do not think sth. is interesting, or because you have nothing to do 厌烦的；不感兴趣的；烦闷的

array /əˈreɪ/ *n.* [usu. sing.] a group of people or things, esp. one that is large or impressive 大群；大堆；大量

diversion /daɪˈvɜːʃən/ *n.* [C, U]
1 an enjoyable activity that you do to stop yourself from becoming bored 消遣；娱乐
2 a change in the direction or use of sth., or the act of changing it 转向；转移；改变用途

hurl /hɜːl/ *vt.* (always + *ad.* / *prep.*) throw sth. using a lot of force 猛投；用力掷

suffice /səˈfaɪs/ *vi.* (*fml.*) be enough 足够

▲ **outlet** /ˈaʊtlet/ *n.* [C]
1 a way of expressing or making good use of strong feelings, ideas, or energy（感情、思想、精力的）发泄出路，表现机会
2 a pipe or hole through which sth. such as a liquid or gas can flow out（液体或气体的）出口；排水口；通风口

aptly /ˈæptli/ *ad.* (**~ named / described / called, etc.**) named, described, called, etc. in a way that seems very suitable 被恰当地命名 / 描述 / 称呼等的

▲ **monetary** /ˈmʌnətəri/ *a.* (*only before noun*) relating to money, esp. all the money in a particular country 货币的；金融的

optimum /'ɒptəməm/ *a.* (*only before noun*) the best or most suitable for a particular purpose or in a particular situation 最优的；最适宜的

▲ contend /kən'tend/

vi. compete against sb. in order to gain sth. 竞争；争夺

vt. argue or state that sth. is true 声称；断言；主张

Phrases and expressions

to name (but) a few used after a short list of things or people to say that there are many more you could mention 略举几例

sink / get one's teeth into sth. (*infml.*) do or enter into sth. with great enthusiasm, concentration, conviction, etc. 全身心投入；专注于

slave away (at sth.) work very hard 拼命干；苦干

be counting (down) the minutes / hours / days be waiting eagerly for sth. to happen 翘首以待；殷切等待

at hand (*fml.*) needing to be dealt with now 手头的；需要马上处理的

contend with sth. have to deal with a problem or difficult situation（不得不）处理问题，对付困境

Reading comprehension

Understanding the text

1 Answer the following questions.

1 How can a person be truly happy according to the author?
2 How is labor different from play?
3 Why does the author make a comparison between a gardener and a well-dressed city mayor?
4 What does leisure mean to workers and laborers respectively?
5 How do workers and laborers differ in the amount of personal satisfaction they derive from their jobs?
6 How do technological innovation and the division of labor change the nature of work?
7 What kind of attitude should people take toward leisure time?
8 Why does the author mention "sinking one's teeth into a problem" (Para. 8)?

Critical thinking

2 Work in pairs and discuss the following questions.

1 What other characteristics do people who love their jobs have, apart from their dedication to work?
2 What do you think people can do to become a worker instead of a laborer?
3 What might you do if you are not happy with your work?

Language focus

Words in use

3 Fill in the blanks with the words given below. Change the form where necessary. Each word can be used only once.

abolish adverse commonplace
contend diversion foster gauge
revenue suffice upcoming

1 He is measuring the depth of the hole to _____ how much climbing line we'll need to get us down and back up again.
2 He _____ for the lead in the final round, but ultimately finished in second position.
3 Smartphone conversations, which are fairly _____ on commuter trains, can be annoying to fellow commuters.
4 Ask your doctor whether a low-fat diet and a daily walk will _____ to lower your high blood pressure.
5 According to the latest statistics, most of the company's _____ is generated through the sale of smartphones.
6 Scientists have learned more about the _____ effects that human activities have on the environment and climate.
7 I learned a great deal from this guide, and I am feeling very confident about my chances of passing the _____ exam.
8 There are rumors going around that this program will be _____ in November or December and all the work will be stopped.
9 This program has transformed the airport's security screening area into an art gallery and is a pleasant _____ for travelers.
10 We hope that the new series of music festivals will _____ interest in the arts in general and increase the city's international reputation.

Word building

-ism

与某些形容词或名词结合构成新名词，表示相关的制度、主义或行为、状态、特性等。

hero		heroism
individual		individualism
social		socialism
commercial	>	**commercialism**
imperial	>	**imperialism**
material	>	**materialism**
real	>	**realism**
terror	>	**terrorism**

-ment

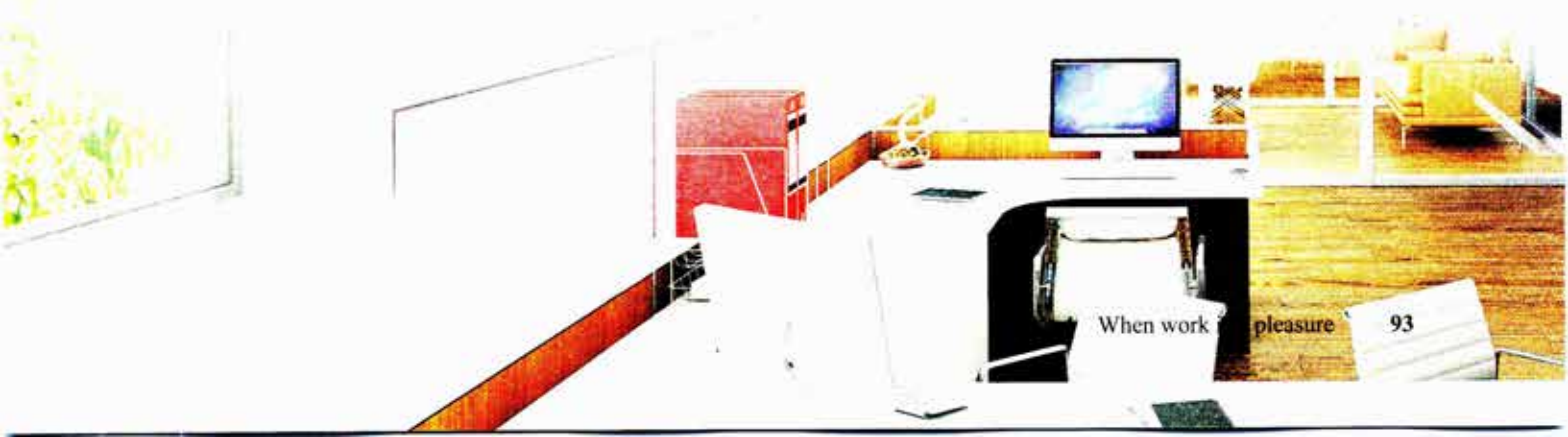
与某些动词结合构成名词，表示相关的行为、过程或结果。

appoint		appointment
improve		improvement
manage		management
enforce	>	**enforcement**
recruit	>	**recruitment**
resent	>	**resentment**
ship	>	**shipment**

4 Fill in the blanks with the words given below. Change the form where necessary. Each word can be used only once.

commercialism　enforcement　imperialism
materialism　realism　recruitment
resentment　shipment　terrorism

1 In the last half-century, women have entered into law _____ in increasing numbers, especially in larger police agencies.
2 It took me two days to get the furniture cleaned, packed, and ready for _____ to my new home.
3 The museum's management had placed a ban on selling more than one duplicate print from the collection to avoid _____.
4 Within a work of magical _____, the world is still grounded in the real world, but fantastical elements are considered normal.
5 This is a well-known online _____ fair connecting job-seekers with leading employers looking for skilled talent.
6 Roman _____ introduced extremes of wealth and poverty that sharpened the social and economic conflicts within the Roman state.
7 What impressed us most was that he did this without _____ or complaint, and had a great work ethic.
8 The book examines the results of terror attacks and analyzes the responses to _____.
9 Here are two ways to avoid _____: discovering the joy of generosity and satisfying your spiritual hunger.



Banked cloze

5 Fill in the blanks by selecting suitable words from the word bank. You may not use any of the words more than once.

A abolish	**F** complaining	**K** monetary
B barrier	**G** exhaustive	**L** motion
C bored	**H** foster	**M** notion
D carrier	**I** incentives	**N** reflecting
E clusters	**J** indebted	**O** refraining

According to a study conducted in the U.K., four out of every five employees are happy at work. Surprisingly, the study revealed that the 1) _____ that people are happy when they have a good salary, isn't true. So, what should people do to keep their spirits up and, at the same time, 2) _____ a sense of joy at work? Here are two suggestions which are believed to be important in achieving happiness at work.

Start with a positive outlook. Happiness is a state of mind, 3) _____ an attitude. Staying happy at work is totally based on your motivation and a positive outlook toward your job, not on 4) _____ rewards or material gain. Always remembering the good aspects of the work and 5) _____ from thinking about what makes you unhappy are important to happiness. Negativity and 6) _____ about bad things are easy; it is looking at the bright side that is the difficult part of a job.

Challenge yourself. Rather than looking for help and 7) _____ from other people, challenge yourself and take charge of your own growth professionally. Getting 8) _____ with work is one of the primary factors that cause people to switch jobs. So find new challenges and deal with them by making 9) _____ plans and following them. It is a good idea to have help from your manager if you hit a(n) 10) _____, but completely relying on someone for your career advancement is unwise.

Facing the problems and challenges at work and tackling them by yourself will give you a sense of accomplishment and help you achieve happiness at work.

Expressions in use

6 Fill in the blanks with the expressions given below. Change the form where necessary. Each expression can be used only once.

be counting down the days conform to
contend with correlate with
designate … as refrain from
sink one's teeth into slave away

1 The rapid rise in unemployment does _____ the increase in young people living at home, according to research.
2 It was a moment of overwhelming excitement when Steve was given the first prize; Tiffany couldn't _____ hugging and kissing him.
3 I guarantee they will _____ to come and spend time with you because you have made them feel welcome.
4 She spent the next 10 years _____ to pay back the money they had borrowed from the bank.
5 This is a rare opportunity and he just can't wait to _____ the interesting new project.
6 The travel agency offers considerate care for its customers when they encounter unplanned circumstances or must _____ an unfamiliar environment.
7 One teacher will be _____ the distance learning teacher for students who choose to start the school year that way.
8 The deepening cooperation between the two countries meets the development needs of both sides and _____ the will of the people of both sides.

Structure analysis and writing

Structure analysis

Developing a comparison / contrast essay

Comparison and contrast are two thought processes you go through constantly in everyday life. When you compare two things, you show how they are similar; when you contrast two things, you show how they are different. The purpose of comparison and contrast is to understand each of the two things more clearly and, at times, to make judgments about them. Text A makes extensive use of contrast in order to highlight the differences between two terms, i.e., *worker* and *laborer*. Have a look at Paras. 4 and 5 to see how contrast is made between workers and laborers.

General statement: *Whether people are workers or laborers can be seen from their attitude toward leisure.* (Para. 4)

To workers, leisure means simply the hours they need to relax and rest in order to work efficiently. Workers are therefore more likely to dedicate more time to working, taking too little leisure rather than too much.	*To laborers, on the other hand, leisure means autonomy from compulsion, so it is natural for them to imagine that the fewer hours they have to spend laboring, and the more hours they have free for play, the better.*

General statement: *Workers and laborers differ in the amount of personal satisfaction they derive from their jobs.* (Para. 5)

Workers who enjoy their jobs will be happier, less stressed, and generally more satisfied with their lives. They will also work with more diligence and precision because they have fostered a sense of personal pride in their jobs.	*On the other hand, laborers, whose sole incentive is earning their livelihood, feel that the time they spend on the daily grind is wasted and doesn't contribute to their happiness. Instead of valuing all 24 hours of their day as enjoyable and productive hours, they gauge only the time spent in leisure and play as meaningful.*

Note that the author uses the point-by-point organizational pattern when contrasting workers and laborers. You can turn to B2U4 and B2U5 for more information about patterns of a comparison / contrast essay.

Besides what has been illustrated above, here are some tips for writing a comparison / contrast essay.

- The thesis should present a significant point. You don't just list the similarities or differences. Your thesis statement should explain the significance of your comparison or contrast.
- The two subjects being compared or contrasted should be equally treated. No matter whether you are using the point-by-point pattern or subject-by-subject pattern, you should explain each subject fully by providing sufficient examples and details.
- Transitional words or phrases should be used wisely when you move from one point to another or from one subject to the other.

Structured writing

Read the sample essay and see how it develops in the point-by-point pattern.

Topic
A beach vacation or a city break

Introduction
Thesis statement: Recognizing the differences between a beach vacation and a city break is helpful when you decide where to go on vacation.

Body
Point 1: The first major difference is the kind of activities you are able to do.
- At a beach
- In a city

Point 2: Another difference is the things you need to take with you.
- At a beach
- In a city

Point 3: The final difference is the pace of life.
- At a beach
- In a city

Conclusion
You have these differences to consider when deciding where to go on vacation.

It is not always easy to decide where to go on vacation. One common dilemma is whether to have a beach vacation or a city break. To make a proper decision, you must recognize the differences between these two types of vacation.

The first major difference is the kind of activities you are able to do. At a beach, you can engage in various water activities, or take advantage of the sun and lie on the sand to get a tan. In a city, you can visit different sites such as museums or theaters, or go downtown. This means that you have many places to explore and you will need much more time and organization when vacationing in a city.

Another difference is the things you need to take with you. If you decide to go to a beach, you will have to take mainly a swimsuit, sandals, sunglasses, and sunblock. However, when going to a city where you have to walk a lot, you will need comfortable clothing such as jeans and sneakers. You may also have to take fancy clothes in case you want to go, for example, to watch a play.

The final difference is the pace of life. If you want a relaxing vacation, the beach will be a better option. When you are at a beach you just let things happen. But in a city you will have to plan all your activities in order to have time to visit the different sites you want to see.

In conclusion, you have these differences to consider when deciding where to go on vacation. Both types of vacation are interesting and exciting, and it all depends on what you are looking for.

7 Write an essay of no less than 140 words on one of the following topics. One topic has an outline that you can follow.

Topic

Continuing to study or going to work

Introduction

Thesis statement: Deciding whether to continue your studies or go to work will have different and profound impacts on your future life and career.

Body

Point 1: Your decision will influence the way you spend your time at college.

- Continuing to study
- Going to work

Point 2: Your decision has financial implications.

- Continuing to study
- Going to work

Point 3: Your decision will have a great impact on your future job opportunities.

- Continuing to study
- Going to work

Conclusion

You should be clear about the possible impacts of your choice before making the final decision.

More topics

- Working for a company or starting one's own business
- Going to a movie or watching a movie at home

Section B

Reading skills

Recognizing signal words

Signal words are words and phrases that show the relations between ideas. Like signposts on the road that guide the traveler, they help the reader follow the author's train of thought. Understanding them is very important to comprehension. Common signal words show emphasis, addition, comparison or contrast, illustration, cause and effect, and sequence or time order. For more detailed information, please refer to Reading skills in B1U4. The following are some examples of signal words taken from Text A.

- *To laborers, on the other hand, leisure means autonomy from compulsion, so it is natural for them to imagine that the fewer hours they have to spend laboring, and the more hours they have free for play, the better.* (Para. 4) (contrast; cause and effect; addition)
- *They will also work with more diligence and precision because they have fostered a sense of personal pride in their jobs.* (Para. 5) (addition; cause and effect)

I Pick out the main signal words in the following sentences from Text B, and decide what kinds of connection they show.

1 I sat there with my shoes off, watching as he got ready to stitch up my shoes I'd entrusted to him. He looked sadly at the leather covering the heel. It was worn through because I had failed to have the shoes patched a month ago. I grew a little impatient, for I was rushing to meet a friend. "Please hurry," I begged. (Para. 4)

_____

2 Thereafter, we waved to each other in a friendly greeting when I passed his shop every day. At first I went in only when I had repair work to be done. Then I found myself lingering in his store or dropping in every few days, just to chat with him for the joy he would impart. (Para. 10)

_____

3 He pondered that for a minute before answering. Then he looked at me seriously. "There is only one way. Every man or woman who hasn't inherited a prideful tradition must start building one. In this country, each of us can make our own contribution to the fabric of society, and we must endeavor to make it a good one. No matter what sort of work a person does, if they give it their best each day, they're starting a tradition for their children to live up to. When a person amends their ways and learns to take pride in their work, a lifetime of happiness will ensue." (Para. 16)

_____

Text B

The joy of a prideful tradition

1 I first met him in 1965, when I rushed into his little shop to have the heels of my shoes repaired. He greeted me with a cheerful smile and instant **hospitality**. "You're new in this neighborhood, aren't you?"

2 Indeed, I had moved into a house at the end of the street only the week before.

3 "This is a fine neighborhood," he said. "You'll be happy here."

4 I sat there with my shoes off, watching as he got ready to **stitch** up my shoes I'd entrusted to him. He looked sadly at the leather covering the heel. It was worn through because I had failed to have the shoes **patched** a month ago. I grew a little impatient, for I was rushing to meet a friend. "Please hurry," I begged.

5 He looked at me over his **spectacles**. "Now, don't worry. I won't be long. This **handicraft** is my **specialty** and I want to do a good job." He was silent a moment. "You see, I have a tradition to live up to."

6 A tradition? In this modest little shop that was no different from so many other shoe-repair shops on the **residential** side streets of Washington? The thought seemed a bit **absurd**.

7 He must have sensed my **bias**, for he smiled with a **gleam** in his eyes as he went on. "Yes, I inherited a tradition. My father always told me, 'Son, do the best job on every shoe that comes into the shop, and be proud of your fine work. If you work with dedication, you'll always have happiness and money.'"

8 As he handed me the finished shoes, he said, "These will last a long time. I've used good leather."

9 I left in a hurry, but I had a warm and grateful feeling. On my way home I passed the little shop again. There he was, sitting amongst his tools, still working. He saw me, and he waved and smiled, as cordial as could be. That was the beginning of our friendship, a **fellowship** that came to mean more and more to me as time passed.

10 Thereafter, we waved to each other in a friendly greeting when I passed his shop every day. At first I went in only when I had repair work to be done. Then I found myself **lingering** in his store or dropping in every few days, just to chat with him for the joy he would **impart**.

11 He was a tall man, bent from long years of work. What little hair he had was gray; his

face was deeply lined. And, I remember best his fine dark eyes, alive with his **charitable**, **carefree**, and humorous spirit.

12 He was the happiest man I've ever known. Often, as he stood in front of his door **overseeing** the street, working at a pair of shoes, he sang a beautiful **melody** in a high, clear voice. Neighbors **nicknamed** him "the singing **cobbler**". The neighborhood children loved him. He'd **periodically** pause his work to **referee** arguments or give out candy. He had no patience for **bullying** and would insist the children play fair in front of his store.

13 One day, I came away from my house filled with **fury** because of a poor job some painters had done on my house. My friend waved to me as I walked by, so I went into his shop to **vent** my frustration. He let me speak angrily about the poor work and carelessness of present-day workmen. "They had no pride in their work," I said. "They just wanted to collect money for doing nothing! The undutiful attitude these days is almost a **sin**."

14 He consoled me, saying, "There's a lot of that kind around, but maybe we should not blame them too **rashly**. Maybe their parents had no pride in their work. That's hard on a child. It keeps a child from learning what's important."

15 "What can be done about it?" I asked.

16 He **pondered** that for a minute before answering. Then he looked at me seriously. "There is only one way. Every man or woman who hasn't inherited a prideful tradition must start building one. In this country, each of us can make our own contribution to the fabric of society, and we must **endeavor** to make it a good one. No matter what sort of work a person does, if they give it their best each day, they're starting a tradition for their children to live up to. When a person **amends** their ways and learns to take pride in their work, a lifetime of happiness will **ensue**."

17 I traveled for a few months on business, and shortly after my return, I walked down the street, looking forward to seeing my friend again. Yet when I arrived, I found the door closed. There was a little sign: "Call for shoes at shop next door."

18 I went into the next shop, and what I heard **pierced** my heart. Yes, the old man had passed away. He was stricken with an **infectious** illness two weeks before and died two days later.

19 I went away with a **wretched void** in my heart. I would miss him, terribly. But he had left me something, an important piece of wisdom I will invariably remember: "If you have inherited a prideful tradition, you must carry it on; if you haven't, then start building one now."

(*895 words*)



New words

▲ **hospitality** /ˌhɒspəˈtæləti/ *n.* [U] friendly and generous behavior toward visitors and guests, intended to make them feel welcome（对客人的）友好款待，好客，殷勤

stitch /stɪtʃ/

vt. sew two pieces of cloth together, or sew a decoration onto a piece of cloth 缝；缝合；缝补；缝缀

n. [C] a short piece of thread that has been sewn into a piece of cloth, or the action of the thread going into and out of the cloth（缝纫中的）一针；缝

▲ **patch** /pætʃ/

vt. repair a hole in sth. by putting a piece of sth. else over it 修补；缝补

n. [C] a small area of sth. that is different from the area around it（与周围部分不同的）小片，小块

spectacle /ˈspektəkəl/ *n.*

1 (**~s**) [pl.] (*fml.*) glasses that help you see 眼镜

2 [C] a very impressive show or scene 精彩的表演；壮观的场面（或景象）

handicraft /ˈhændikrɑːft/ *n.* [C, usu. pl.] (*also* **craft**) an activity such as sewing or making baskets, in which you use your hands in a skillful way to make things 手工艺；手艺

specialty /ˈspeʃəlti/ *n.* [C] (*BrE* **speciality**)

1 a subject or job that you know a lot about or have a lot of experience of 专业；专门研究；专长

2 a type of food that a person, restaurant, or area is well known for（某人、餐馆或地方的）特色食品

▲ **residential** /ˌrezɪˈdenʃəl/ *a.* (of an area of a town) suitable for living in; consisting of houses rather than factories or offices（城镇中的地区）适合居住的，住宅的

absurd /əbˈsɜːd/ *a.* completely stupid or unreasonable 愚蠢的；荒谬的；荒唐的

▲ **bias** /ˈbaɪəs/ *n.* [sing., U] an opinion about whether a person, group, or idea is good or bad that influences how you deal with it 偏见；成见；偏心

gleam /gliːm/

n. [C] 1 an emotion or expression that appears for a moment on sb.'s face（某人脸上）闪现的情绪

2 a small pale light, esp. one that shines for a short time（尤指短暂的）微光，闪光

vi. shine softly 发微光；闪烁

▲ **fellowship** /ˈfeləʊʃɪp/ *n.* [C, U] a feeling of friendship resulting from shared interests or experiences（因共同的兴趣或经历而产生的）友情，友谊

linger /ˈlɪŋgə/ *vi.* (*also* **~ on**)

1 stay somewhere a little longer, esp. because you do not want to leave（尤因不想离开而）逗留，流连

2 continue to exist, be noticeable, etc. for longer than is usual or desirable 继续存留（较惯常或理想的时间长）

impart /ɪmˈpɑːt/ *vt.* (*fml.*) give a particular quality to sth. 赋予，给予（某种品质）

▲ **charitable** /ˈtʃærətəbəl/ *a.*

1 kind and sympathetic in the way you judge people 仁慈的；宽容的；具有同情心的

2 relating to giving help to the poor 慈善的

carefree /ˈkeəfriː/ *a.* having no worries or problems 无忧无虑的；无牵挂的

▲ **oversee** /ˌəʊvəˈsiː/ *vt.* (**oversaw, overseen**)

1 survey or watch, as from a higher position 俯瞰；眺望

2 watch sth. in order to check that it works or happens in the way it should 监督；管理

melody /'melədi/ *n.* [C] a tune or song, esp. a simple one（尤指简单的）曲调，歌曲

nickname /'nɪkneɪm/
vt. give sb. an informal name 给…起绰号；给…起诨名
n. [C] an informal name for sb. or sth., esp. a name that you are called by your friends or family, usu. based on your real name or your character 外号；绰号；诨名

cobbler /'kɒblə/ *n.* [C] (*old-fashioned*) sb. who makes and repairs shoes 鞋匠

▲ periodic /ˌpɪəri'ɒdɪk/ *a.* (*also* **~al**) (*only before noun*) happening repeatedly over a period of time 时而发生的；间歇（性）的

periodically /ˌpɪəri'ɒdɪkli/ *ad.* 时而发生地；间歇（性）地

referee /ˌrefə'ri:/
v. be a referee 仲裁；调停；当裁判；为…担任裁判
n. [C] 1 sb. who makes sure that the rules of a sport such as football, basketball, or boxing, are followed（体育比赛的）裁判（员）
2 sb. who is asked to settle a disagreement 仲裁员；公断者；调解人

▲ bully /'bʊli/
vt. threaten to hurt sb. or frighten them, esp. sb. smaller or weaker 欺侮，霸凌，恐吓（尤指以大欺小、恃强凌弱）
n. [C] sb. who uses their strength or power to frighten or hurt sb. who is weaker 恃强凌弱者；以大欺小者；霸凌者

bullying /'bʊlɪɪŋ/ *n.* [U] behavior that frightens or hurts sb. smaller or weaker 恃强凌弱（行为）

fury /'fjʊəri/ *n.* [U] extreme, often uncontrolled anger 暴怒；狂怒

vent /vent/
vt. express feelings of anger, hatred, etc., esp. by doing sth. violent or harmful 发泄，宣泄（怒火、仇恨等）
n. [C] a hole or pipe through which gases, liquid, etc. can enter or escape from an enclosed space or container（供气体或液体等流通的）孔口；通风孔；排气道

▲ sin /sɪn/ *n.* [sing.] an action or way of behaving that you think is morally wrong（道德上的）罪恶，罪过

rash /ræʃ/ *a.* careless or unwise, without thought for what might happen or result 鲁莽的；轻率的；毛躁的

rashly /'ræʃli/ *ad.* 鲁莽地；轻率地；毛躁地

ponder /'pɒndə/ *v.* (*fml.*) spend time thinking carefully and seriously about a problem, a difficult question, or sth. that has happened 仔细考虑；深思

endeavor /ɪn'devə/ (*fml.*)
vi. (**~ to do sth.**) try very hard to do sth. 努力做（某事）；尽力做（某事）
n. [C, U] an attempt to do sth. new or difficult 尝试；努力

amend /ə'mend/ *vt.* (*fml.*)
1 improve; change for the better 改进；改善
2 change a law, document, statement, etc. slightly in order to correct a mistake or to improve it 修正，修订（法律、文件、声明等）

ensue /ɪn'sju:/ *vi.* (*fml.*) happen after or as a result of sth. 继而发生；因而发生

▲ pierce /pɪəs/ *vt.* make a small hole in or through sth., using an object with a sharp point 刺入；刺穿；刺破

▲ infectious /ɪn'fekʃəs/ *a.* (of a disease) able to be passed from one person, animal, or plant to another（疾病）传染性的

wretched /'retʃɪd/ *a.* characterized by or causing misery 令人苦恼的；使人难受的

void /vɔɪd/ *n.* [sing.]
1 a feeling of great sadness that you have when sb. you love dies or when sth. is taken from

you 空虚感；孤寂感

2 a situation in which sth. important or interesting is needed or wanted, but does not exist 空白

Phrases and expressions

stitch sth. up put stitches in cloth or a wound in order to fasten parts of it together 把…缝合，缝拢

live up to sth. be as good as what was expected or promised 符合（期望）；实践（诺言）

drop in (on sb.) visit sb. you know, usu. without arranging a particular time 顺便造访；临时拜访

give sth. out give sth. to each person in a group 分发

play fair do sth. in a fair and honest way 公平办事；按规则做

come away leave a place with a particular feeling or idea（带着某种感觉或想法）离开

be hard on sb. / sth. have a bad effect on sb. or sth. 对…有害

take pride in sb. / sth. feel very pleased about sb. you are closely connected with, yourself, or sth. 为…骄傲；对…感到自豪

call for sb. / sth. go somewhere and get sb. or sth. in order to take them to another place 去接（某人）；去取（某物）

pierce sb.'s heart affect sb. keenly or deeply 强烈地影响；深深地打动

carry on sth. continue sth. that sb. else started 继续（他人已开始的事）

Reading comprehension

Understanding the text

2 Choose the best answer to each of the following questions.

1 The author went quickly into the shop to _____.
- A buy a pair of shoes
- B have her shoes repaired
- C learn to build a tradition
- D meet one of her old friends

2 Why did the author become a little impatient?
- A She was in a hurry to meet a friend.
- B It took a long time to have her shoes repaired.
- C The shoe repairer was sad and did nothing about her torn shoes.
- D She couldn't put up with the shoe repairer's carelessness.

3 How did the author feel when the shoe repairer first mentioned that he had a tradition to live up to?
- A Upset.
- B Thrilled.
- C Doubtful.
- D Confused.

4 What is the tradition the shoe repairer's father handed down to him?
- A Treating all the clients with hospitality.
- B Finding pleasure in what a person does.
- C Running the shoe-repair shop personally.
- D Being dedicated to work and feeling proud.

5 Why did the author drop into the shoe-repair shop very frequently?
- A Her shoes often needed repairing.
- B The shoe repairer would bring her joy.
- C She wanted to have someone to chat with.
- D She could listen to the shoe repairer's songs.

6 What do we know about the shoe repairer?
- A He earned more money than needed.
- B Children regarded him as a trustworthy man.
- C He often sang songs to the neighborhood children.
- D Neighbors often had their shoes repaired in his shop.

7 The shoe repairer explained that the poor work the painters had done was owing to the painters' lack of _____.
- A enthusiasm
- B responsibility
- C work experience
- D a prideful tradition

8 What wisdom did the shoe repairer impart to the author?
- A It is important to be kind to people around you.
- B It is important to be happy with what you are doing.
- C It is important to be good at your own handicraft.
- D It is important to start, keep, and carry on a prideful tradition.

Critical thinking

3 Work in pairs and discuss the following questions.

1 How do you understand the shoe repairer's view that each of us can make our own contribution to the fabric of society, and that we must endeavor to make it a good one?

2 What do you think are the factors that contribute to a person's pride in their work?

3 Do you think it necessary that we hand down to the next generations the traditions we have inherited from our ancestors? Why or why not?

Collocation



Do people feel ***truly happy*** (B3U4A) with what they are doing at work? Are their feelings about their jobs often ***polar opposites*** (B3U4A)? Do they consider themselves happy workers or ***unhappy laborers*** (B3U4A) who are compelled to work in order to conform to ***societal expectations*** (B3U4A)? If they don't feel happy, does this have an ***adverse effect*** (B3U4A) on their lives? Can people obtain ***personal satisfaction*** (B3U4A) at work if they only receive a ***monetary reward*** (B3U4A) or ***high income*** (B3U4A)? How can they get ***optimum pleasure*** (B3U4A) from their work? What kind of job do people find ***personally fulfilling*** (B3U4A)? Everyone has their own answer. What's yours?

Indeed, being happy at work is critical to your success. If you are a happy worker, you look forward to arriving at the office every day, and you wave to your co-workers in a ***friendly greeting*** (B3U4B) and receive your customers with ***instant hospitality*** (B3U4B). You might also be drawn to the ***prideful tradition*** (B3U4B) of your work. You work hard and use your ***special strengths*** (B3U4A) to resolve problems rather than focus on the ***trivial pursuit*** (B3U4A) of gossip, games, extravagant fashion, etc. By contrast, if you are miserable at work, then what happens at work spills over into your personal life. Your misery has a way of damaging your health and your relationships, and can even undermine your ***charitable spirit*** (B3U4B). This is common among people who are merely concerned with their fame, wealth, and position. If you do not want such desires to be your ***sole incentive*** (B3U4A) to work, you need to feel a sense of accomplishment to awaken your passion for the work and bring a ***cheerful smile*** (B3U4B) to your face as you work long hours.

4 Complete the following passage by filling in the blanks with appropriate collocations from the texts. You are provided with the first letter(s) for each of the collocations. Change the form where necessary.

Do you feel happy at work? Are you a happy worker or an 1) *un*_____ *ha*_____? Let me introduce Valerie, who finds her work – cleaning the ladies' toilets – 2) *per*_____ *ful*_____. You'll see a joyful Valerie at her work. Not only is she happy, but her happiness also seems to infect those using "Valerie's Happy Restroom". My point: You can always find 3) *op*_____ *pl*_____ at work regardless of what you do.

Many companies get it wrong when it comes to making employees 4) *tr*_____ *h*_____. They try to create a happy workplace through things like 5) *mon*_____ *re*_____, free gym membership, or health care, but working with the 6) *s*_____ *in*_____ of earning a living will not make people happy. In my opinion, happiness can be created through three Rs: results, recognition, and relationships.

Results create happiness when you achieve something, make a difference, and create value, which bring you 7) *per*_____ *sat*_____. School teachers find happiness when they see their students learning. Nurses

find happiness when they see their patients improving. It is the seemingly 8) *tr*_____ *pur*_____ that is a key source of happiness at work.

Recognition also creates happiness when we praise each other for results. There are many different ways of praising and recognizing 9) *spe*_____ *str*_____, whether it is a congratulatory email, an announcement in a meeting, or a picture on a bulletin board. It should be known that recognition is earned by your impressive performance at work rather than your 10) *h*_____ *in*_____.

For some people, joy and work might seem like 11) *po*_____ *op*_____, but relationships can bring happiness to your work when you like your co-workers, build connections, and have fun with them. After a 12) *fr*_____ *gr*_____, you drink coffee or have a lunch with your colleagues. With a 13) *ch*_____ *sm*_____, you talk about your personal life and work with them happily to resolve problems. Every day you have countless opportunities to shape and reshape your co-worker relationships, and don't let them have an 14) *ad*_____ *ef*_____ on your work experience.

All in all, happiness at work is a feeling of happiness derived from work and it can be achieved by focusing on results, recognition, and relationships.



Stories of China

Glassware on fire



Xing Lanxiang was hired by a glassware factory in Beijing after graduating from school in 1962. Before that, she had never heard of the art, and even afterward never did she expect to be engaged in it for the rest of her life. Today, together with her two sons, Xing is the heir of a national intangible cultural heritage (非物质文化遗产) and is the only glassware artist who has received the title of master in China.

In line with tradition, Xing followed a teacher, Tian Wenyuan, and after three years' apprenticeship (学徒期), she was already very good at the art thanks to her diligence and passion. She always chose to tackle complicated work and soon became a leading figure in the factory. When the factory established its technology department in 1970, she became a member and studied the technology and designed new glassware products together with her co-workers.

This profession brought Xing a lot of pride, particularly during the heyday (全盛时期) of her factory in the 1970s and 1980s, when the factory received a lot of foreign visitors every year. Glassware making is an art form that requires a product to be finished very quickly. Generally, a product is completed within a dozen minutes, while complicated ones are done within half an hour or one hour. So this is a feat that was often observed by visitors. Foreign visitors tended to favor this kind of traditional task very much.

However, the hardship of learning and grasping this skill makes the preservation of the art a major challenge. Xing once had more than 100 apprentices, but only one of them still remains in the sector, and now she has only her two sons to pass the skill on to. "Of course I hope the art of making glassware can be handed down from one generation to another, as it is really beautiful and represents a high level of art," Xing said.

Xing never misses any opportunity to spread glassware culture. Through various activities, Xing has made more people aware of the art. She once attended the Glass Innovation Design Contest in Hejian of China's Hebei Province, where she exchanged views with masters in the sector. This further strengthened her confidence in the art of making glassware.

Exercises

Translation

Translate the following paragraph into English.

近年来，社会的发展和就业形势的变化对大学生提出了更高的要求。越来越多的大学生不再局限于学习书本知识，而是利用业余时间积极投身于社会实践活动。通过社会实践活动，他们可以提高分析问题和解决问题的能力，更深入地了解社会，增强社会责任感。同时，参加社会实践活动还可以帮助他们认识到自身的不足，明确未来努力的方向。

Unit project

Conducting a survey on happiness at work

Happiness at work is important. It affects people's work performance, job satisfaction, and even happiness outside of work. To deepen your understanding of it, in this unit project, you are expected to prepare a questionnaire and conduct a survey regarding the happiness level of a certain occupation.

Step 1 **Work in groups of four or five and discuss the factors that contribute to happiness at work. You may turn to the Internet for help.**

Step 2 **Design a questionnaire that will measure happiness at work. The following is a mini-sample design for your reference.**

Happiness at work

1	2	3	4	5
Never	Rarely	Sometimes	Often	Always

Rating	Does your job ...
	arouse positive emotions?
	Do you usually experience positive feelings (satisfaction, contentment, pleasure, etc.) rather than negative ones (anger, frustration, irritation, etc.)?
	use your strengths?
	Does your job allow you to bring your skills and abilities into play?
	foster rewarding relationships?
	Do you enjoy working with your colleagues?

Step 3 **Choose one occupation and carry out the survey.**

Step 4 **Write a report based on the results of the survey. Here are some steps you can follow.**

1 Show the general happiness level of the occupation under investigation.
2 Discuss the reasons why this occupation has such a happiness level by analyzing the responses to each question on the questionnaire.
3 Give suggestions on how to achieve greater happiness at work in this occupation.

Step 5 **Present your report to the class.**

Unit

5 China's space dream

Seek to benefit the country rather than personal wealth and position.

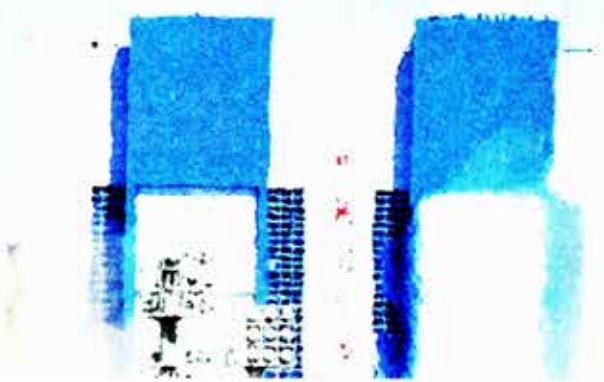
— *The Book of Rites*

苟利国家，不求富贵。

——《礼记》







Preview

Since ancient times, exploring the universe has been a dream of humankind. Humans have always looked at the heavens and wondered about the nature of the objects in the night sky. Their curiosity has fueled interest in exploring and discovering new worlds, and pushing the boundaries of the known.

China is taking bigger steps today in pursuit of its space dream. It has achieved outstanding progress in a short period of time, which has greatly **promoted national pride and patriotism** in all Chinese people and **strengthened their determination to build the country**.

The accomplishments of China's space exploration are the results of the efforts and contributions of generations of people, out of their love for the country, engaging in the aerospace cause through their struggles, sacrifices, and persistence. What inspirations can you gain from their experiences? What expectations do you have about China's space exploration? What can you do for China's space exploration?

Section A

Pre-reading activities

1 Match the descriptions with the pictures below.

1 The first space teacher in China



Nie Haisheng

2 The first person sent into space by the Chinese space program



Zhai Zhigang

3 The commander of the first crew to visit the *Tiangong* space station



Wang Yaping

4 The first Chinese person to perform a spacewalk



Yang Liwei

2 Work in pairs and list what qualifications are needed for astronauts.

Text A

1 China's space exploration had reached a new milestone by 2021, when three astronauts of *Shenzhou-12* crew successfully docked at the *Tiangong* space station, worked there for months, and then safely returned to the earth. The three – Nie Haisheng, Liu Boming, and Tang Hongbo – were selected rigorously from the current active, qualified Chinese astronauts. All these astronauts have been training for one of the most spectacular endeavors of China's space exploration: building and operating China's first space station.

2 It was back in 1992 that China approved a blueprint for her manned space program and began training astronauts. The first batch of astronauts was chosen from veteran pilots in the People's Liberation Army (PLA) Air Force who had at least 600 flight hours in fighter jets or attack aircraft. More than 1,500 pilots applied, and after rounds of most demanding tests, the number reduced sharply to 14. In 1998, they became the founding members of the PLA Astronaut Group.

3 On October 15, 2003, Yang Liwei became the first Chinese person to go into space in the Shenzhou-5 manned mission, making China the third country to send a man into space. During his 600,000 km expedition, Yang simultaneously displayed the Chinese and UN flags to hundreds of millions of Chinese who were witnessing his feat on television, and said, "Make use of outer space peacefully and for the benefit of all humankind."

4 Since Yang's momentous journey, China has made a gigantic progress in space exploration,



No limit for China's astronauts in their space exploration endeavors

and more astronauts have been sent into orbit. The astronauts have performed scientific experiments and technological tests, undertaken **extravehicular** activities, and even delivered a science lecture watched by tens of millions of students.

5 To achieve these accomplishments, though, the astronauts have endured countless rounds of training, tests, and drills, shedding sweat and owing an enormous debt to their families for their thorough understanding and continuous support.

6 Once pilots are admitted to the astronaut team, they must immerse themselves in the study of about 60 subjects, including physics, **astronautics**, and astronomy. **Normally**, each of these subjects requires university students to take four-year courses, but the astronauts have just one year to complete their studies and must pass exams in every subject.

7 During training, to **simulate weightlessness**, astronauts have to wear suits that weigh 160 kg and stay underwater for about four hours. They lose an average of 2 kg during each training session, and after a session they would be too exhausted to hold chopsticks. When conducting **centrifuge** training, astronauts must endure a force as much as eight times their own weight so that they will be able to resist the **g-forces** that severely restrict the ability to breathe during **lift-off**. None of the astronauts has pressed the emergency button to **halt** the program.

8 The astronauts have also overcome hardships and difficulties during missions. Yang Liwei recalled that when *Shenzhou-5* **ascended** toward the sky, a low-frequency **oscillation** made his internal **organs vibrate** violently, **inflicting** almost unbearable pain. He **gritted** his teeth and endured the pain because he was about to realize the nation's long-lasting dream of flying in space. During the Shenzhou-7 mission, Zhai Zhigang and Liu Boming discovered they were unable to open the spaceship's exit hatch. They decided to use a tool to force the hatch open despite the obvious safety risk. "We both knew what the other one was thinking at that very moment: We had to **accomplish** our mission and wave the Chinese flag in space, even though we realized that there would probably be no return trip for us," Zhai said.

9 Looking back at their experiences, the astronauts thought their struggles, sacrifices, and persistence were all worthwhile. It is awe-inspiring and **unforgettable** for the astronauts to observe the earth and the universe from space. "I saw the lights of cities on earth and lightning **ripping** through the night sky. From our orbit, I saw the darkness and emptiness of space, and I wondered where the **boundary** is between the sky and the stars. I will never forget those scenes," said Liu Wang, who took part in the Shenzhou-9 mission.

10 Jing Haipeng, who has taken part in several space missions, was awarded the August 1 Medal, the highest honor given to individual members of the Chinese PLA. Jing was both pleased and modest when he received the medal. For him, the honor and glory belong not only to the astronauts but also to tens of thousands of scientists, engineers, and workers who have played a role in the nation's manned space programs and contributed to sending the astronauts into space.

11 The accomplishments of China's space exploration have become a source of pride and growing confidence in the nation, in addition to sparking **patriotic** sentiments in Chinese communities across the world. Wang Yaping, the female astronaut who delivered the science lecture from space, felt overwhelmed by the number of boys and girls who wrote to her upon her return. She had never imagined that her teaching could **trigger** off so many dreams and aspirations. Yang Liwei recalled that during a visit to New York, a Chinese-American held his hands and **tearfully** told him that the nation's achievements in space reflected the fact that "our motherland has risen", which gave Chinese people living overseas more courage and strength.

12 The bravery, wisdom, and commitment the Chinese astronauts **embody** will definitely inspire numerous young people to join the **lofty** cause and set space as the stage to realize their ambitions and the dream of national **rejuvenation**. There is no limit to the vast universe or to China's space exploration endeavors.

(*931 words*)

Culture notes

***Tiangong* space station:** China's first long-term space station in low earth orbit between 340 and 450 km above the surface. It aims at creating a national space laboratory and platform for international scientific as well as technological cooperation.

August 1 Medal: a medal granted to military personnel who have made outstanding contributions to safeguarding national sovereignty, security, and development interests, and to advancing the modernization of national defense and the armed forces.

New words

milestone /ˈmaɪlstəʊn/ *n.* [C] a very important event in the development of sth. 重大事件；里程碑

▲ dock /dɒk/

v. 1 if a ship docks, or if the captain docks it, it sails into a dock so that it can unload（使）（船）进港；（使）停靠码头

2 if two spacecraft dock, or are docked, they are joined together in space（使宇宙飞船在外层空间）对接

n. [C] a place in a port where ships are loaded, unloaded, or repaired 码头；船坞

▲ blueprint /ˈbluːˌprɪnt/ *n.* [C] a plan for achieving sth. 计划；设想；蓝图

▲ batch /bætʃ/ *n.* [C] a group of people or things that arrive or are dealt with together 一批；一组

feat /fiːt/ *n.* [C] sth. that is an impressive achievement, because it needs a lot of skill, strength, etc. to do 业绩；功绩；壮举

momentous /məʊˈmentəs/ *a.* very important or serious, esp. because there may be important results 关键的；重要的；重大的

▲ gigantic /dʒaɪˈgæntɪk/ *a.* extremely big 巨大的

extravehicular /ˌekstrəviːˈhɪkjʊlə/ *a.* of or relating to work performed in space outside a spacecraft（工作）（与）宇宙飞船（或航天器）外（有关）的，舱外的

astronautics /ˌæstrəˈnɔːtɪks/ *n.* [U] the technology relating to space travel 航天学；宇宙航行学

▲ normally /ˈnɔːməli/ *ad.* usually 通常；平常

simulate /ˈsɪmjəleɪt/ *vt.* make or produce sth. that is not real but has the appearance or feeling of being real 模拟；模仿

weightlessness /ˈweɪtləsnəs/ *n.* [U] the fact of having or appearing to have no weight, e.g. because there is no gravity（似）无重量；（似）失重

centrifuge /ˈsentrəfjuːdʒ/ *n.* [C] 离心机；离心分离机；离心过滤机

g-force *n.* [C] G 力（由速度或方向的改变所作用于人体或物体的力）

lift-off *n.* [C, U] the moment when a vehicle that is about to travel in space leaves the ground（航天器的）升空，发射，起飞

▲ halt /hɔːlt/ *v.* stop; make sb. or sth. stop（使）停止；（使）停下

ascend /əˈsend/

vi. (*fml.*) move up through the air 上升；升高

vt. (*written*) climb sth. or move to a higher position 攀登；登上

oscillation /ˌɒsəˈleɪʃən/ *n.* [sing., U] a regular movement between one position and another or between one amount and another 摆动；摇摆；振动

▲ organ /ˈɔːgən/ *n.* [C] a part of the body, such as the heart or lungs, that has a particular purpose 器官

vibrate /vaɪˈbreɪt/ *v.* move or make sth. move from side to side very quickly and with small movements（使）振动，颤动，摆动

inflict /ɪnˈflɪkt/ *vt.* make sb. suffer sth. unpleasant 使（某人）遭受（不愉快的事）；使承受

grit /grɪt/ *vt.* (**~ one's teeth**)

1 bite one's teeth together, esp. when one is in pain, angry, or under pressure（尤指在疼痛、生气或有压力时）咬紧牙关

2 use all one's determination to continue in spite of difficulties 咬紧牙关；下定决心

▲ accomplish /əˈkʌmplɪʃ/ *vt.* succeed in doing sth., esp. after trying very hard（尤指通过努力）完成，实现

unforgettable /ˌʌnfəˈgetəbəl/ *a.* impossible to forget; very memorable 不会被遗忘的；难忘的

▲ rip /rɪp/
v. tear sth. or be torn quickly and violently （被）撕裂；（被）扯开
vt. (always + *ad.* / *prep.*) remove sth. quickly and violently, using your hands 猛力扯去

▲ boundary /ˈbaʊndəri/ *n.* [C] a real or imagined line that marks the limits or edges of sth. and separates it from other things or places; a dividing line 边界；界限；分界线

patriotic /ˌpætriˈɒtɪk/ *a.* having or expressing a great love of your country 爱国的；有爱国心的

▲ trigger /ˈtrɪgə/
vt. (*also* ~ **off**) make sth. happen very quickly, esp. a series of events 引发，激发（尤指一系列事件）
n. [C] 1 the part of a gun that you press in order to fire it（枪的）扳机
2 sth. that is the cause of a particular reaction or development, esp. a bad one （尤指引发不良反应或发展的）起因，诱因

tearfully /ˈtɪəfəli/ *ad.* done while crying or likely to cry 含泪地；流泪地；可能会哭地

embody /ɪmˈbɒdi/ *vt.* express or represent an idea or a quality 具体表现，体现，代表（思想或品质）

lofty /ˈlɒfti/ *a. (fml.)*
1 (*usu. before noun*) (of a thought, an aim, etc.) deserving praise because of its high moral quality（思想、目标等）崇高的，高尚的
2 (of buildings, mountains, etc.) very high and impressive（建筑物、山等）巍峨的，高耸的

rejuvenation /rɪˌdʒuːvəˈneɪʃən/ *n.* [U] the act or process of making sb. or sth. look or feel younger, more lively, or more modern 恢复青春；恢复活力；复兴

Phrases and expressions

for the benefit of sb. / for sb.'s benefit esp. in order to help or be useful to sb. 为帮助…；为…的利益

owe a debt (of gratitude) to sb. have a reason to thank or feel grateful to another person for sth. good that they have done 欠…的情；感激

rip through sth. move through a place quickly and with violent force 迅猛地冲过

Proper names

Shenzhou-12 神舟十二号（中国载人航天飞船，2021 年 6 月 17 日发射升空）

People's Liberation Army (PLA) Air Force 中国人民解放军空军

PLA Astronaut Group（People's Liberation Army Astronaut Group）中国人民解放军航天员大队

Shenzhou-5 神舟五号（中国载人航天飞船，2003 年 10 月 15 日发射升空）

Shenzhou-7 神舟七号（中国载人航天飞船，2008 年 9 月 25 日发射升空）

Shenzhou-9 神舟九号（中国载人航天飞船，2012 年 6 月 16 日发射升空）

August 1 Medal 八一勋章（中国军队最高荣誉）

Reading comprehension

Understanding the text

1 Answer the following questions.

1 What is one of the most spectacular endeavors of China's space exploration according to Para. 1?
2 When was the PLA Astronaut Group established?
3 What did it mean when Yang Liwei became the first Chinese person to go into space in the Shenzhou-5 manned mission?
4 What have the Chinese astronauts accomplished since Yang Liwei's momentous journey according to Para. 4?
5 What do astronauts have to do to simulate weightlessness during training?
6 What did Zhai Zhigang and Liu Boming decide to do when they discovered they were unable to open the spaceship's exit hatch?
7 What are the impacts that the accomplishments of China's space exploration have on the Chinese at home and abroad?
8 What are the qualities the Chinese astronauts embody?

Critical thinking

2 Work in pairs and discuss the following questions.

1 What is the significance of space exploration?
2 Why could China achieve outstanding progress in space exploration in a short period of time?
3 How do you understand the spirit of the manned space program?

Language focus

Words in use

3 Fill in the blanks with the words given below. Change the form where necessary. Each word can be used only once.

ascend blueprint boundary
embody gigantic halt inflict
milestone simulate vibrate

1 All these industries have _____ the decline and in some cases reversed it by innovations of their own.
2 The city has recently devised a series of strategies mapping out a(n) _____ for the city's development.
3 Research laboratories could _____ environmental conditions surrounding historical sites to help researchers with their cultural heritage protection endeavors.
4 My phone _____ in my pocket while I was walking around the mall.
5 This meeting proved to be a very important _____ for the development of the program.
6 The drought has _____ a direct agricultural economic loss of 952 million dollars in that area.
7 Many men of letters have _____ Lushan Mountain, a mountain of immense cultural significance, and produced more than 16,000 poems and verses.
8 This program is designed to blur the _____ between school and work by pairing traditional technical skills training with real-world work experiences.
9 The _____ waves are awe-inspiring, reaching the height of a 10-story building.
10 The patterns found on folk art and their symbolic meanings _____ values which have evolved over a long time.

Word building

-ary

与某些名词（偶尔同动词）结合构成形容词，用以描述带有原名词或动词所指特征的人或事物，意为“……的”。

compliment	complimentary
revolution	revolutionary
discipline	**disciplinary**
legend	**legendary**
moment	**momentary**
precaution	**precautionary**

-ity

与某些形容词结合构成名词，表示与原形容词相关的状态或特性。

complex	complexity
diverse	diversity
responsible	responsibility
adverse	**adversity**
immense	**immensity**
sincere	**sincerity**

4 Fill in the blanks with the words given below. Change the form where necessary. Each word can be used only once.

adversity　disciplinary　immensity
legendary　momentary
precautionary　sincerity

1 Hua Tuo was a(n) _____ Chinese physician who lived during the late Eastern Han Dynasty.

2 Economic theory suggests that in the presence of rising uncertainty, households can increase their savings for _____ purposes.

3 Nothing has overwhelmed me so much with its _____ as the boundless ocean.

4 Nobody can deny that trust and _____ are important in a relationship.

5 Her fear was only _____; it soon passed when her family came home and told her that everything was all right.

6 Perhaps he would receive _____ punishment because he had disobeyed an order.

7 She had overcome many personal _____, which prepared her to be an awesome motivational speaker.

Banked cloze

5 Fill in the blanks by selecting suitable words from the word bank. You may not use any of the words more than once.

A abolition	**F** endeavor	**K** pushing
B ascended	**G** fingerprint	**L** simulate
C blueprint	**H** hasty	**M** soaring
D designated	**I** lofty	**N** transcended
E docked	**J** milestone	**O** trigger

China's first attempt at independently developing its astronautic industry can be dated back to the 1950s, but it was not until the 1960s that any substantial progress was made.

A major breakthrough in China's astronautic technology came on April 24, 1970, when China succeeded in launching its first satellite. This development marked a(n) 1) _____ in China's research on man-made satellite.

The 1980s was a period of 2) _____ growth for Chinese space technology. The successful launch of the *Long March-3* brought the country into a leading position in carrier rocket technology around the world.

In 1992, the Chinese government created a(n) 3) _____ and decided to implement its manned space program, which laid claim to being the largest and most technically complex 4) _____ of China's space exploration in the late 20th century and early 21st century.

In October 2003, the *Shenzhou-5* manned spaceship 5) _____ into space and sent the first Chinese astronaut into orbit. This momentous space journey marked the realization of China's dream of a manned space flight.

On October 16, 2021, *Shenzhou-13* was launched and entered its 6) _____ orbit successfully. After entering its orbit, the spaceship was 7) _____ with the *Tianhe* core module. The crew completed a six-month stay, the longest one since the beginning of the program, and returned to the earth safely on April 16, 2022.

China now is 8) _____ forward with its deep space exploration, and aims to contribute its wisdom to utilizing (利用) the outer space peacefully. The achievements of China's space exploration will 9) _____ the interest of more young people who are willing to devote themselves to the 10) _____ cause. China's space exploration, of course, will start a new journey.

Expressions in use

6 Fill in the blanks with the expressions given below. Change the form where necessary. Each expression can be used only once.

be overwhelmed by　　for the benefit of
grit one's teeth　　immerse oneself in
make use of　　owe a debt to
rip through　　trigger off

1 To help you better deal with your studies and life abroad, we advise you to _____ the local culture.
2 With the further development of contemporary historians' research, a number of new academic views have been put forth and have _____ a series of controversies among researchers.
3 The government has called on large companies to make comprehensive e-commerce platforms available _____ people in rural areas.
4 We _____ teachers like Willa, who dedicate their lives to helping our children become better – not only at learning but also at living a full and meaningful life.
5 Rescue workers continued their efforts to free the miners trapped underground after an explosion _____ a gold mine near the town.
6 Sometimes in life, you just have to _____ and do what you have to do to protect the ones you love.
7 Almost half of all users surveyed said that they _____ the sheer number of apps currently available.
8 Soil management, rainwater harvesting, and proper storage of water all affect how efficiently farmers _____ water resources.

Structure analysis and writing

Structure analysis

Developing an exemplification essay

In this unit, you will learn how to write an exemplification essay. In an exemplification essay, you support your point by illustrating it with examples. Vivid examples can clarify abstract ideas and make them easier to understand, as well as more interesting, memorable, and convincing.

A successful exemplification essay depends on the following guidelines.

1 A wise selection of sufficient examples which are specific and typical, interesting and relevant. The examples may be either personal experiences or second-hand information from reliable sources. You can use quotations, statistics, interviews, facts, etc., to provide evidence and support your point.
2 An expert arrangement of these examples. Related examples should be grouped together and arranged according to the order of time, space, importance, etc. Also, a wise use of brief examples and extended examples can ensure both the width and depth of the topic you are dealing with.

What are brief examples and extended examples?

A brief example is generally stated in one or two sentences. By using several brief examples together you can demonstrate that your point is a common rather than isolated occurrence. A number of brief examples together can support the thesis strongly because they cover a wide range of possibilities. By contrast, an extended example is usually discussed at greater length and is more detailed than a brief example. Unlike a brief example, an extended example can introduce distinctiveness and specificity. This is why it is especially helpful when dealing with complex ideas.

There is no general rule to help decide what type of examples you should use to support your point. However, using just a single extended example in your essay may give your readers an impression that your support is weak because the example does not cover sufficient possibilities. On the other hand, using only brief examples can hardly explore the topic deeply. Therefore, the most common method of developing an exemplification essay is to combine brief and extended examples and link them together appropriately.

Take Paras. 9-11 of Text A and see how examples are used to support the point.

Topic sentence: Looking back at their experiences, the astronauts thought their struggles, sacrifices, and persistence were all worthwhile. (Para. 9)

- **An extended example:** Liu Wang said he would never forget the scenes he had seen in space: lights of cities on earth, lightning ripping through the night sky, the darkness and emptiness of space, etc. (Para. 9)
- **Another extended example:** Jing Haipeng was awarded the August 1 Medal, but he attributed the honor to all the people working for the nation's manned space programs. (Para. 10)

Topic sentence: The accomplishments of China's space exploration have become a source of pride and growing confidence in the nation, in addition to sparking patriotic sentiments in Chinese communities across the world. (Para. 11)

- **A brief example of Wang Yaping. (Para. 11)**
- **A brief example of Yang Liwei. (Para. 11)**

Para. 9 starts with a topic sentence and then an extended example is used to support it. In the example, a direct quotation from Liu Wang, describing the beautiful scenes he observed in space, is used to add credibility to the point. In Para. 10, another extended example of Jing Haipeng is given to support the topic sentence from a different aspect. Two extended examples are used, by giving detailed illustration of the astronauts' experiences and thinking, to support and explain the topic sentence which is a little bit abstract and may be interpreted in a different way.

In Para. 11, brief examples are provided to demonstrate the topic sentence which itself is straightforward and easy to understand. The two brief examples, each with just one or two sentences, back up the topic sentence by showcasing the broad range of impact that China's space exploration has on the Chinese at home and abroad.

From the analysis above, you can see that quotations make a point more convincing since they are the description by or feelings of the people involved. And the combination of brief and extended examples works well as it provides sufficient illustration of the message the author wants to convey in the text.

Structured writing

Read the sample essay and see how the examples are developed and organized.

Topic
Global warming

Introduction
Thesis statement: Global warming poses a serious threat to human life on earth.

Body
1 **Topic sentence:** Global warming is putting food production at risk.
Examples: impact of the severe flooding in India, effect of swarms of locusts in East Africa and Southwest Asia, and expert opinion
2 **Topic sentence:** Global warming is threatening human well-being and health.
Example: impact of heat weaves
3 **Topic sentence:** Global warming is pushing more people into poverty and displacement.
Examples: effect of flooding, landslides, heat, and water scarcity, and statistics for people displaced by weather-related events

Conclusion
We should work together to tackle global warming.

Global warming refers to the rise in global temperatures mainly due to the increasing concentrations of greenhouse gases in the atmosphere. Scientists warn that global warming poses a serious threat to human life on earth.

To start with, global warming is putting food production at risk. Droughts, floods, and pests which are caused by global warming are doing great harm to food production. For example, the severe flooding in India in 2021 put much pressure on India's food supplies. Swarms of locusts – provoked by unusually heavy rains caused by global warming – destroyed crops across East Africa and Southwest Asia in 2020. According to some experts, "In the next 30 years, food supply and food security will be severely threatened if little or no action is taken to address climate change and the food system's vulnerability to climate change."

In addition, global warming is threatening human well-being and health. For example, exposure to extreme heat can lead to heatstroke (中暑), dehydration (脱水), and many respiratory diseases (呼吸道疾病). According to the World Meteorological Organization, climate change has made heat waves more frequent and intense. In 2022, we had one of the hottest summers on record, which led to the deaths of about 500 people within a week in Spain.

What is more, global warming is pushing more people into poverty and displacement. Climate change and poverty are closely interrelated. Extreme events like flooding and landslides can destroy homes and livelihoods. Heat can make it difficult to work outdoors. Water scarcity may affect crops. Just between 2010 and 2019, an estimated 23.1 million people were displaced on average each year by weather-related events, and thus many are more vulnerable to poverty.

Facing so many serious problems, we should work together to tackle global warming, one of humanity's greatest challenges.

7 Write an essay of no less than 140 words on one of the following topics. One topic has an outline that you can follow.

Topic

Curiosity and scientific breakthroughs

Introduction

Thesis statement: Curiosity is the secret to scientific breakthroughs.

Body

1 **Topic sentence:** Curiosity sparks questions which are important in scientific discoveries.
Example: Li Siguang played a crucial role in formulating (创立) the Quaternary Glacial Theory of China (中国第四纪冰川学说), and it all started when he became interested in a big stone as a child.

2 **Topic sentence:** Curiosity gives people the persistence to look for scientific discoveries.
Example 1: Michael Faraday invented the first electric motor because of his curiosity about electricity and his persistence.
Example 2: Tu Youyou discovered artemisinin (青蒿素) because of her curiosity about traditional Chinese medicine and her persistence.

Conclusion

Curiosity plays a key role in important scientific breakthroughs.

More topics

- Procrastination (拖延) is a bad habit
- Exploring the space for the benefit of all humankind

Section B

Reading skills

Identifying the sequence of events

The sequence of events is the order in which events happen or should happen. Identifying the sequence of events is an essential reading skill that you should develop if you are to fully understand the reading material. It usually involves identifying time expressions used to connect the various parts of the text. The following are some of the most commonly used time expressions.

- **Time and date markers:** at two o'clock in the afternoon; in the 20th century; by / in 1999; in the 1990s; on July 7, 1999
- **Other time order or sequence signal words:** first, before, during, then, when, while, soon, following that, after, now, earlier, since, in the end, finally, last

You can use a timeline, which is a display of a list of events, usually with dates, in chronological order, to help you identify the sequence of events and have a better comprehension of the text. It is especially useful for you to better understand the order or chronology of historical events and trends for a subject. Timelines can come in a wide variety of forms, including vertical, horizontal, and illustrated.

Sometimes the most recent or important events are recounted at the beginning of the narrative to emphasize the main idea of the text or to attract the reader's attention. When making a timeline, you should reorder the sequence of the events and put them in the right places.

Take Paras. 1-4 of Text A, for example. The sequence of events can be illustrated in a timeline as below.

It was ***back in 1992*** *that China approved a blueprint for her manned space program* ... (Para. 2)

In 1998*, they became the founding members of the PLA Astronaut Group.* (Para. 2)

On October 15, 2003*, Yang Liwei became the first Chinese person to go into space in the Shenzhou-5 manned mission* ... (Para. 3)

During *his 600,000 km expedition, Yang simultaneously displayed the Chinese and UN flags* ... (Para. 3)

Since *Yang's momentous journey, China has made a gigantic progress in space exploration* ... (Para. 4)

China's space exploration had reached a new milestone ***by 2021****, when three astronauts of* Shenzhou-12 *crew successfully docked at the* Tiangong *space station* ... (Para.1)

The text begins with the latest event, identified by the time marker *by 2021*. It is thus put last in the timeline. Then, the text continues with events *back in 1992*, *in 1998*, and *on October 15, 2003* in Paras. 2 and 3. Still in Para. 3, the word *during* serves as a time marker and indicates that the event introduced next happened in the time period. The signal word *since* in Para. 4 introduces what happened afterward.

1 **Read Text B and identify the sequence of events displayed in the text. Make a timeline of China's scientific endeavors in lunar exploration.**

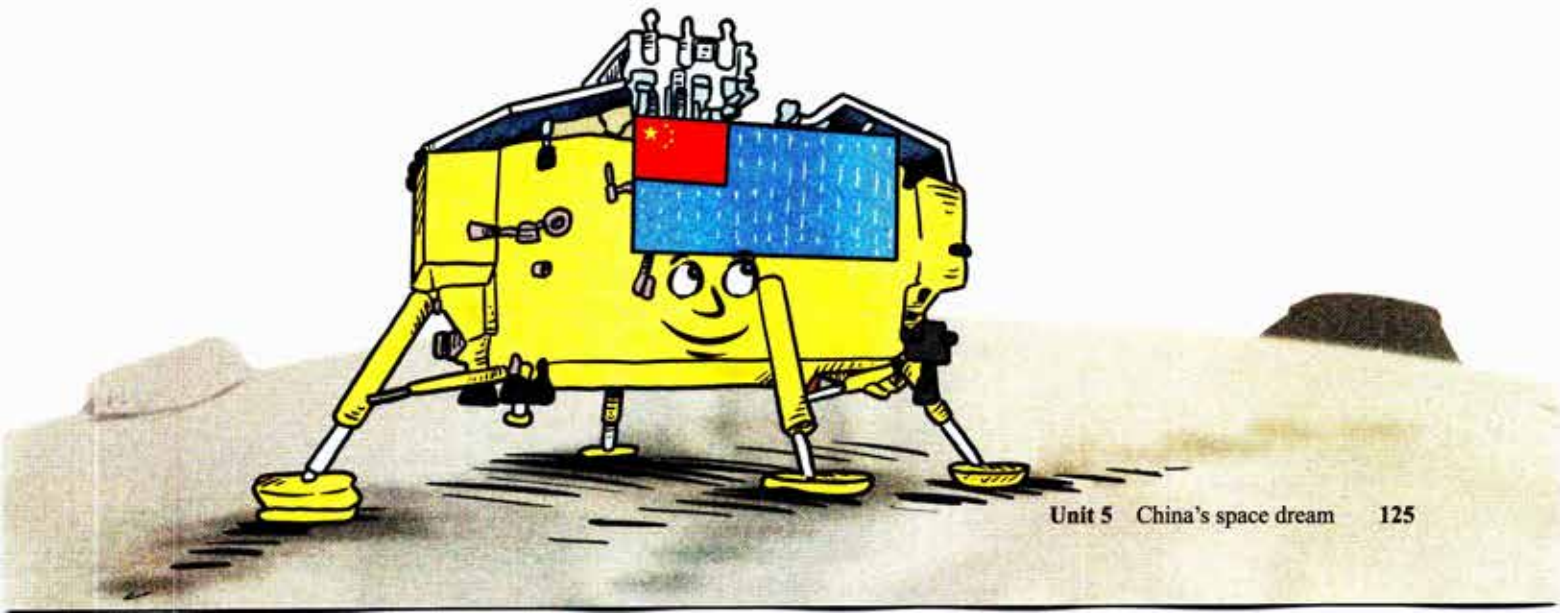
Text B

Chang'e-4 kicked off a new space odyssey

1 No wind blows and no rain falls there. Only **crashing meteorites** occasionally **disrupt** the stillness. The **desolate** landscape on the moon's far side has waited billions of years to see the **first-ever soft landing** of a visitor from the earth – *Chang'e-4* from China.

2 As the nearest heavenly body, the moon has fascinated humankind since we first gazed at the sky. The silver **disc** in the sky is always a **captivating** theme in our legends, myths, and dreams. Its ever-changing face has inspired ambitious aspirations. We admire its beauty from the earth, so why are we so eager to reach the moon? It's an ideal place to peer into the deep reaches of the universe. It inspires our imaginations and dreams of space travel.

3 The moon and the earth share a similar "childhood", yet traces of the remote past on earth have been erased by geological activities. Exploration of the moon might provide some insights into the early history of the earth. But due to the **tidal** locking effect, we only get to see one side of the moon from the earth, and the far side remains a mystery.



It's also called the dark side, although it's not darker than the near side. The word *dark* only shows how we feel about the unknown.

4 Nobody had ever seen the moon's far side before the Soviet Union launched the *Luna 3* probe in 1959. It was the first-ever mission to photograph the far side. The United States Apollo 8 mission sent three astronauts around the moon in 1968, the first time humans saw the moon's far side with their own eyes. Now China sent the first-ever probe to soft-land and **rove** on the far side, which has **deepened** our understanding of the moon, the earth, and the universe.

5 Between the 1950s and 1970s, the United States and the Soviet Union raced against each other in early **lunar** exploration. After a **lull**, new interest was triggered in the 1990s when scientists found there might be water on the moon. Since the turn of the **millennium**, more countries such as China, Japan, and India have joined the lunar exploration club. To date, the world has launched over 100 manned or **unmanned** missions to the moon.

6 Flying to the moon has been a dream of the Chinese since ancient times. The moon has long been a major theme in Chinese poems, music, and paintings, with artists and writers using the moon to express their emotions and thoughts about the universe. Since the 1990s, Chinese scientists and engineers have endeavored to make the dream a reality. China announced in 2000 that its space planning agenda contained **preparatory** research about lunar exploration. It officially began the lunar exploration program in 2004, with the aim of orbiting and landing on the moon, and bringing samples back to the earth. The program was named after the moon goddess Chang'e, who, in Chinese **mythology**, lived on the moon and was accompanied by the **Jade** Rabbit.

7 Although China is a **latecomer** in lunar exploration, its program has made many achievements in a few expeditions. The country verified its lunar probe technologies in 2007 with the successful launch of *Chang'e-1*, the first **spacecraft** stemming from the program. In 2013 *Chang'e-3* accomplished China's first soft-landing on the moon, which was the first **man-made** craft to achieve this goal in nearly four decades.

8 After *Chang'e-3*'s accomplishment, Chinese space experts aimed high to make the Chang'e-4 mission more innovative and challenging: to realize the first-ever soft-landing on the far side of the moon. In order to achieve that goal, China launched a **relay** satellite, named *Queqiao* (**Magpie** Bridge) after an ancient legend, to set up a

communication link between the earth and the moon's far side. Chinese space experts also overcame difficulties with the **rugged terrain** on the far side, making the probe land on the moon with high precision.

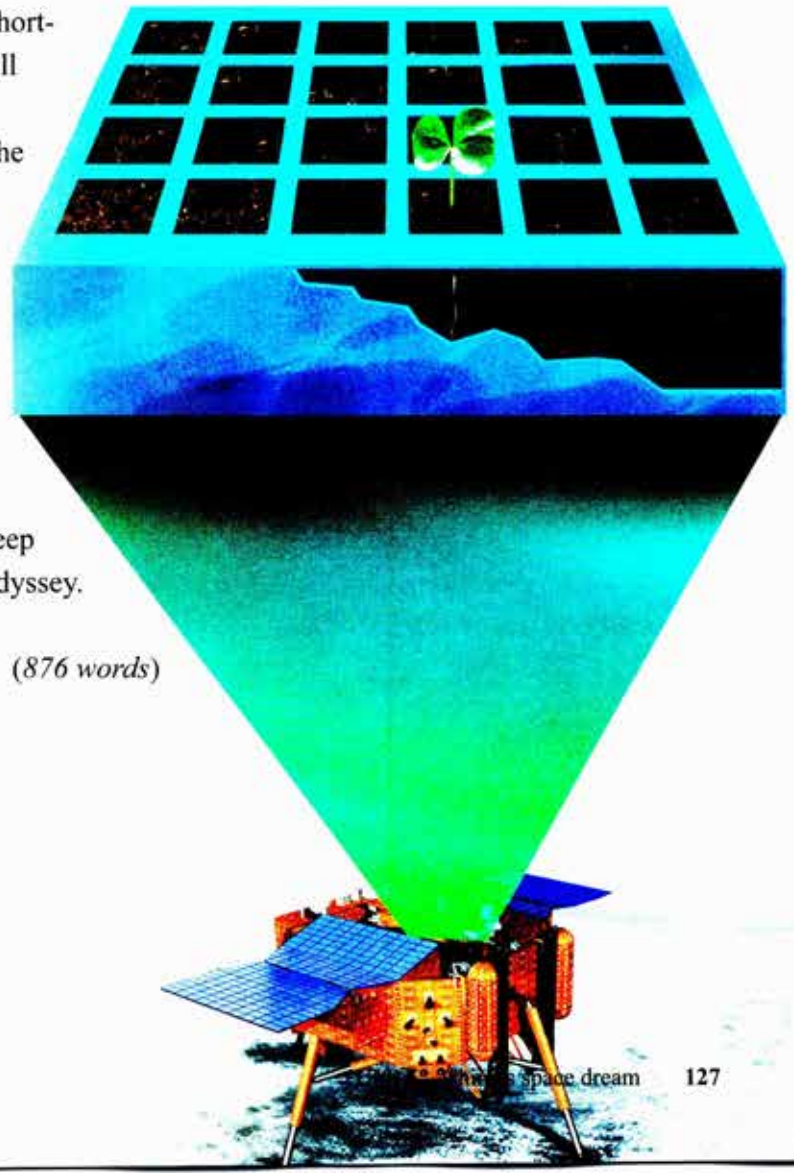
9 The Chang'e-4 mission carried instruments that had been developed by scientists from Sweden, Germany, the Netherlands, and Saudi Arabia, providing more opportunities for the world's scientists and combining human wisdom to explore the universe. Now China is drawing up plans to explore the moon's polar **regions** and inviting other countries to join in further expeditions. "I think one of the beauties of space science is that we do **cooperate** internationally. Space science to me is something important, also as a message of peace worldwide," said a German professor in the program.

10 The probe took some live **species** like cotton and potato to the lifeless environment to form a **mini biosphere**, which is expected to produce the first flower on the moon. Engineers also plan to get data by constantly measuring temperatures on the surface of the moon.

11 From **robotic** to manned missions, from short- to long-term, China's lunar exploration will go deeper. The Chinese will leave their **footprints** on the surface of the moon in the foreseeable future.

12 Exploring the moon has inspired scientists and engineers, fascinated young and old, and motivated young people to pursue scientific careers, not only in space but also in the depths of the ocean or in the **nucleus** of an atom. Reaching the moon, the first **outpost** in deep space, is just the beginning of our space odyssey.

(876 words)



New words

▲ **crash** /kræʃ/ *v.*
1 hit sth. hard while moving, causing noise and / or damage; make sth. hit sb. or sth. in this way（使）猛撞，碰撞
2 have an accident in a car, plane, etc. by violently hitting sth. else（使）（车）碰撞，（飞机）坠毁

meteorite /ˈmiːtiəraɪt/ *n.* [C] a piece of rock or metal from space that has landed on the ground 陨石；陨铁

▲ **disrupt** /dɪsˈrʌpt/ *vt.* prevent sth. from continuing in its usual way by causing problems 扰乱；使混乱

desolate /ˈdesələt/ *a.* (of a place) empty and without people, making you feel sad or frightened（地方）无人居住的，荒无人烟的，荒凉的

first-ever *a.* (*only before noun*) happening for the first time 第一次的

soft landing *n.* [C] a situation in which a spacecraft comes down onto the ground gently and without any damage（航天器的）软着陆

▲ **disc** /dɪsk/ *n.* [C] a round flat shape or object 圆盘形状；圆盘状物

captivating /ˈkæptəveɪtɪŋ/ *a.* very attractive and interesting, in a way that holds your attention 迷人的；很有魅力的

▲ **tidal** /ˈtaɪdl/ *a.* relating to the regular rising and falling of the sea 潮汐的；潮水的

rove /rəʊv/ *v.* (*written*) travel from one place to another 漫游（于）；流浪（于）

deepen /ˈdiːpən/ *v.*
1 become stronger or greater, or make sth. stronger or greater（使）变强烈；加强
2 become worse; make sth. worse（使）变糟，恶化，严重

▲ **lunar** /ˈluːnə/ *a.* relating to the moon or to travel to the moon 月球的；登月的

lull /lʌl/
n. [C] a short period of time when there is less activity or less noise than usual（活动或噪声的）暂停，暂时平静期
vt. make sb. feel calm or as if they want to sleep 使平静下来；使昏昏欲睡

millennium /mɪˈleniəm/ *n.* [C] (*pl.* **millennia**)
1 [usu. sing.] the time when a new 1,000-year period begins 新千年开始的时刻；新千年开始之际
2 a period of 1,000 years 一千年；千年期

unmanned /ˌʌnˈmænd/ *a.* used to refer to a spacecraft or a place that has no people present to operate or be in charge of it（宇宙飞船或地方）无人的

▲ **preparatory** /prɪˈpærətəri/ *a.* (*only before noun*) done in order to get ready for sth. 预备的；准备的

▲ **mythology** /mɪˈθɒlədʒi/ *n.* [C, U] set of ancient myths 神话（统称）

jade /dʒeɪd/ *n.* [U] a hard, usu. green, stone often used to make jewelry 碧玉；翡翠

latecomer /ˈleɪtˌkʌmə/ *n.* [C] sb. who arrives late 迟到者；后来者

▲ **spacecraft** /ˈspeɪskrɑːft/ *n.* [C] (*pl.* **spacecraft**) a vehicle that is able to travel in space 航天器；宇宙飞船

man-made *a.*
1 made by people, rather than by natural processes 人工制造的；非天然的
2 man-made materials and substances are not natural（材料、物质）人造的，人工的

▲ **relay** /ˈriːleɪ/ *n.*
1 [C, U] a piece of electrical equipment that receives radio or television signals and sends them on 中继设备；转播设备

2 [C] (*also* ~ **race**) a race between teams in which each member of the team runs or swims one section of the race 接力赛

magpie /ˈmægpaɪ/ *n.* [C] 雀；喜鹊

rugged /ˈrʌgɪd/ *a.* (of the landscape) not level or smooth and having rocks rather than plants or trees（地形）崎岖的，凹凸不平的，多岩石的

terrain /teˈreɪn/ *n.* [C, U] a particular type of land 地形；地势；地带

▲ region /ˈriːdʒən/ *n.* [C] a large area of a country or of the world, usu. without exact limits（通常无明确界线的）地区，区域，地带

▲ cooperate /kəʊˈɒpəreɪt/ *vi.* work with sb. else to achieve sth. that you both want 合作；协作

▲ species /ˈspiːʃiːz/ *n.* [C] (*pl.* **species**)（动植物的）物种，种

mini /ˈmɪni/ *a.* small in relation to others of the same kind 小型的

biosphere /ˈbaɪəsfɪə/ *n.* [sing.] (*technical*) the part of the world in which animals, plants, etc. can live 生物圈

▲ robotic /rəʊˈbɒtɪk/ *a.* (*only before noun*) robotic equipment, etc. is related to robots or is part of a robot 机器人的

▲ footprint /ˈfʊtprɪnt/ *n.* [C] (*also* **footmark**) a mark made by a foot or shoe 脚印；足迹

▲ nucleus /ˈnjuːkliəs/ *n.* [C] (*pl.* **nuclei**)（原子）核

outpost /ˈaʊtpəʊst/ *n.* [C]
1 a small military camp away from the main army, used for watching an enemy's movements, etc. 前哨（基地）
2 a small town or group of buildings in a lonely part of a country 偏远村镇；孤零居住区

Phrases and expressions

kick sth. off start a discussion, a meeting, an event, etc. 开始进行讨论（或会议、项目等）

to date until now 迄今；到目前为止

stem from sth. develop as a result of sth. else 源于；来自；由…引起

draw sth. up prepare a written document, such as a list or contract 起草，拟定（名单、合同等）

Proper names

Chang'e-4 嫦娥四号（中国月球探测器，2018 年 12 月 8 日发射升空）

Luna /ljuːnə/ *3* 月球三号（苏联月球探测器，1959 年 10 月 4 日发射升空）

Apollo /əˈpɒləʊ/ *8* 阿波罗八号（美国载人航天飞船，1968 年 12 月 21 日发射升空）

Chang'e-1 嫦娥一号（中国月球探测器，2007 年 10 月 24 日发射升空）

Chang'e-3 嫦娥三号（中国月球探测器，2013 年 12 月 2 日发射升空）

Queqiao 鹊桥（“嫦娥四号”的中继卫星，2018 年 5 月 21 日发射升空）

Sweden /ˈswiːdn/ 瑞典（欧洲国家）

Reading comprehension

Understanding the text

2 Choose the best answer to each of the following questions.

1 Why do we want to explore the moon according to the text?
- A To solve resource problems on earth.
- B To build a similar biosphere on the moon.
- C To peer into and explore the deep universe.
- D To learn more about the other side of the moon.

2 Why is the far side of the moon also called the dark side?
- A It is covered by black rocks.
- B It is relatively unknown to us.
- C It is darker than the near side.
- D It is more dangerous than the near side.

3 Which of the following is the first-ever mission to photograph the moon's far side?
- A The Luna 3 mission.
- B The Apollo 8 mission.
- C The Chang'e-1 mission.
- D The Chang'e-4 mission.

4 When did China join the lunar exploration club?
- A In the 1950s.
- B In the 1970s.
- C At the beginning of 2007.
- D At the turn of the millennium.

5 Which of the following is a goal of China's lunar exploration program according to the text?
- A To find signs of life on the moon.
- B To bring samples back to the earth.
- C To establish a settlement on the moon.
- D To find a good location to observe the earth.

6 Which mission accomplished China's first soft-landing on the moon?
- A The Chang'e-1 mission.
- B The Chang'e-2 mission.
- C The Chang'e-3 mission.
- D The Chang'e-4 mission.

7 Why did China launch the satellite *Queqiao*?
- A To survey the rugged terrain on the moon's far side.
- B To take on the role of *Chang'e-4* if it failed to function.
- C To help with the Chang'e-4 mission by carrying more instruments.
- D To set up a communication link between the earth and the moon's far side.

8 What is special about *Chang'e-4*?
- A It brought fresh flowers and potato seeds with it to the moon.
- B It is the first man-made craft to soft land on the far side of the moon.
- C It helped humans see the moon's far side with their own eyes for the first time.
- D It carried instruments developed by foreign scientists from Japan and Germany.

Critical thinking

3 Work in pairs and discuss the following questions.

1 What are the benefits of enhancing international cooperation in space exploration?
2 What accomplishments do you think humans could achieve in the future lunar exploration?
3 What roles do you think disciplines other than science and technology play in space exploration?

Collocation

More language exercises

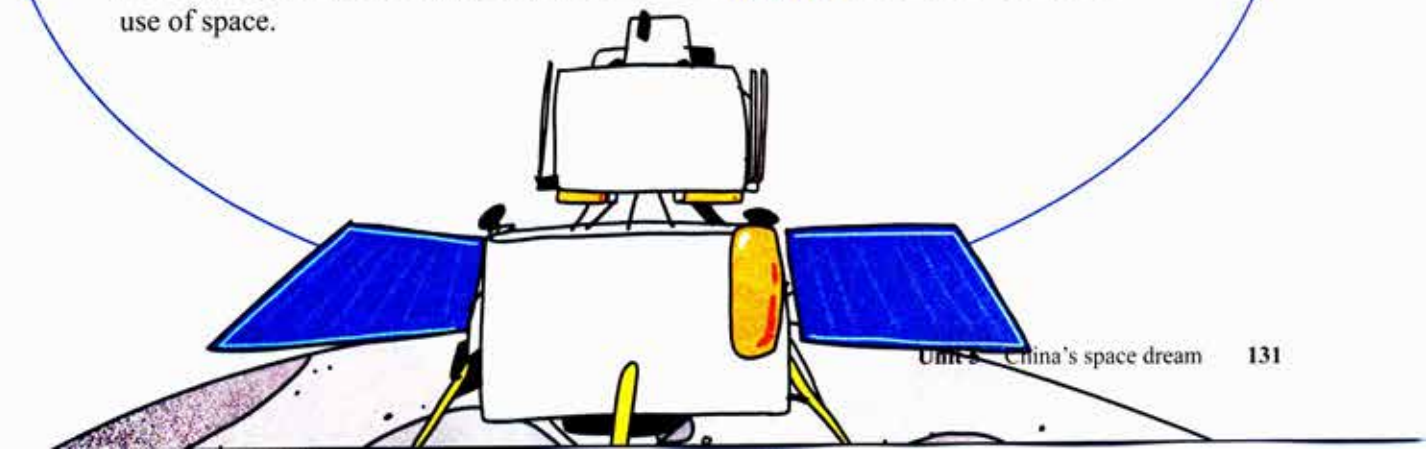
At present, our country is prosperous, people's lives are improving, and the development of our social economy has ***reached milestone*** (B3U5A) after milestone. These all lay the groundwork for making ***gigantic progress*** (B3U5A) in science and technology. The demand for scientific and technological innovation has never been so strong, and scientists are trying their best to ***deepen our understanding*** (B3U5B) of the world around us. For the general public, the achievements in science and technology, like those in space exploration, ***trigger great interest*** (B3U5B) and technological innovation has become one of the most ***captivating themes*** (B3U5B) of discussion.

To ***accomplish the mission*** (B3U5A) of scientific and technological innovation, we must attract, retain, and make good use of high-end talent worldwide to ***combine human wisdom*** (B3U5B). The barriers that ***restrict their ability*** (B3U5A) should be removed and ***continuous support*** (B3U5A) for ***verifying new technologies*** (B3U5B) should be provided. Meanwhile, in order to cultivate more talent, it is equally important to inspire ***ambitious aspirations*** (B3U5B) in young students and encourage them to ***pursue scientific careers*** (B3U6B) and ***shed sweat*** (B3U5A) to ***realize their ambitions*** (B3U5A). ***Inspiring their academic imagination*** (B3U5B) to promote original innovation is helpful in achieving self-reliance and strength in science and technology. This is not only the heartfelt wish of scientists and engineers with strong ***patriotic sentiments*** (B3U5A), but also one of the most ***spectacular endeavors*** (B3U5A) of China to realize ***national rejuvenation*** (B3U5A).

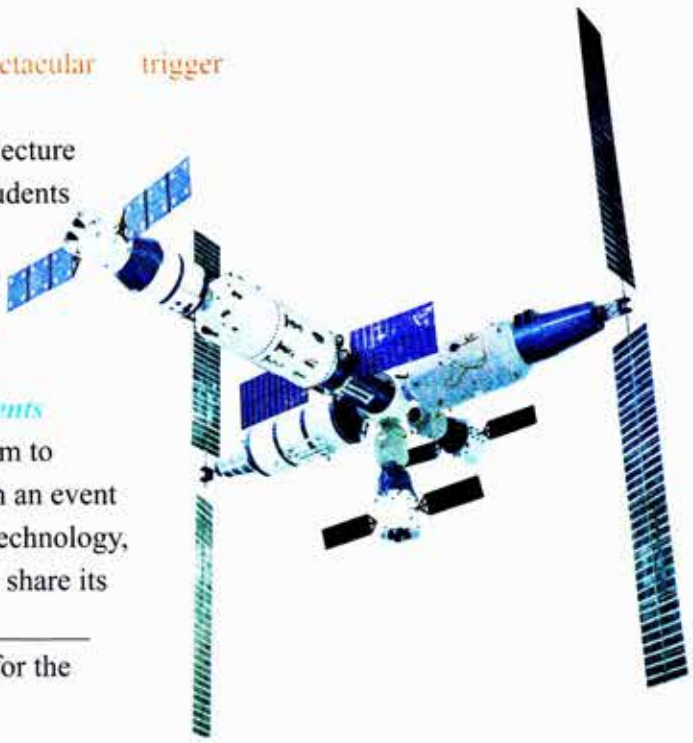
4 Complete the following paragraphs by choosing appropriate words from the boxes. Change the form where necessary. Each word can be used only once.

accomplish continuous deepen gigantic reach

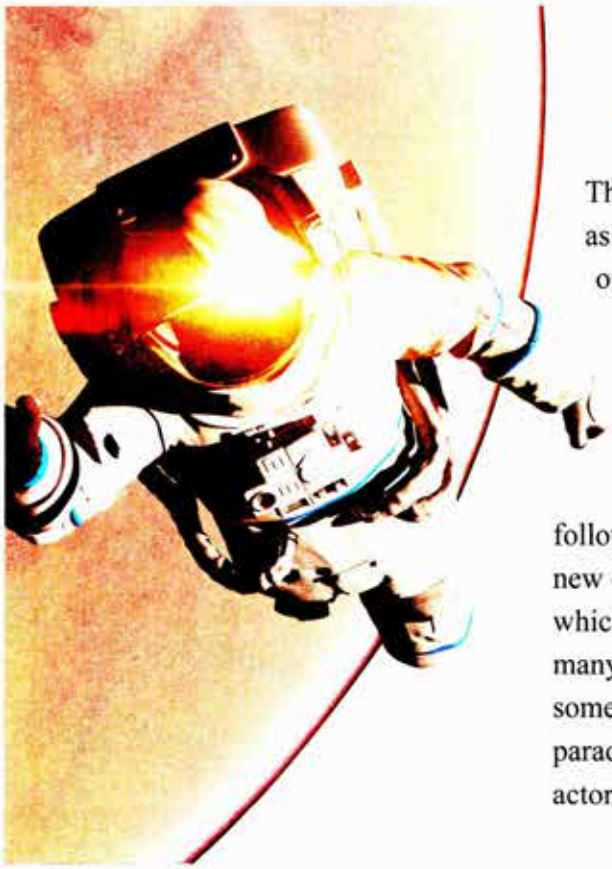
The successful re-entry and landing of the *Chang'e-5* probe has enabled China to obtain its first lunar samples, marking a(n) 1) _____ ***progress*** in lunar and planetary research. With this achievement, China has 2) _____ ***a new milestone*** in the space domain. The primary goal of *Chang'e-5* was to bring back samples from the moon's surface. This will 3) _____ ***our understanding*** of the state, temperature, and material content of the moon. No matter how far China goes into space, it always aims at 4) _____ ***its original mission*** – revealing the secrets of the universe and providing great and 5) _____ ***support*** for humanity's peaceful use of space.



combine patriotic pursue spectacular trigger



Chinese astronauts conducted a science lecture 400 km above the earth to millions of students as they orbited in the *Tiangong* space station. This eye-opening experience not only successfully 6) _____ *students' interest* in science and technology, but also greatly aroused 7) _____ *sentiments* among young citizens and motivated them to 8) _____ *science-based careers*. Such an event further demonstrates China's advanced technology, and reveals its 9) _____ *endeavors* to share its space program with the world and 10) _____ *human wisdom* to explore the universe for the benefit of humankind.



ambitious captivating inspire verify

Through the years, space has often been identified as the new frontier, 11) _____ *the imagination* of writers and film directors, who have made it a(n) 12) _____ *theme* related to the fantastic developments in space technologies. History has shown us that after an initial phase of "exploring" a new environment and 13) _____ *relevant technologies*, what follows is an explosion of businesses to exploit the new opportunities offered by this new environment, which would inspire 14) _____ *aspirations* among many people. This is where we are today, a period sometimes called Space 4.0. It has seen a shift of paradigms (模式), with changes of motivations, actors, and technologies.

Stories of China

China aims for peaceful use of space exploration

Over the past few years, China has made great achievements and experienced a number of breakthroughs pertaining to (关于) outer space. The Chang'e-5 mission successfully brought back samples of lunar rock. The core module of *Tiangong*, the space station, was launched and astronauts were sent up there. China also became just the second nation to land a rover on Mars with the Tianwen-1 mission and *Zhurong* probe. Furthermore, China and Russia have released a joint road map for building the International Lunar Research Station, which will be the first structures built on the moon, by 2035.

Long before the modern era, Chinese culture and tradition attached great importance to the heavens and the moon, and from here emerged many of the world's earliest astronomers and cosmologists (宇宙学家). China's vision for the exploration of outer space should be understood through the lens of its economic strategy for "peaceful development" and "a global community of shared future" for the good of humankind. China has a nonmilitary view of space exploration and sees advances in science as a means for accelerating global prosperity and economic development.

Since the 20th century, outer space has been the newest frontier of humankind, and understanding it and knowing how to use it productively are crucial for humanity. The advancement of space-related activities has the potential to overcome many problems on earth, including shortages of energy and resources as



Tianwen-1 launched by a *Long March-5* heavy-lift carrier rocket

well as pollution. As a consequence, progress made in space is ultimately progress in the name of all, and serves to benefit all.

Each civil feat in space subsequently transforms the way we live, even if we do not realize it. The achievements of the 20th century transformed our world in communications and expanded our capability to understand ourselves. The invention of the satellite and similar resources has been invaluable in promoting globalization and interconnectivity.

As a result, the *Tiangong* space station and the planned International Lunar Research Station will aim to shape the future of humanity accordingly, by expanding the scope of knowledge to new levels.

The Chinese endeavor is not a zero-sum game; China invites all countries to participate in its projects as a peaceful initiative and to help shape humanity's future. China will pursue the path of peaceful development in space with a view to the moon, Mars, and beyond.

Exercises

Translation

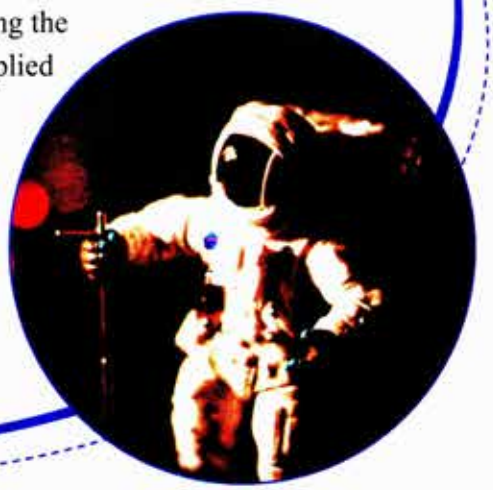
Translate the following paragraph into English.

实现中华民族伟大复兴是近代以来中国人民最伟大的梦想，我们称之为“中国梦”，其基本内涵是实现国家富强、民族振兴、人民幸福。每个中国人都是中国梦的参与者和创造者。我们要把自己的前途与国家的命运紧紧相连。中国梦是民族的梦，也是每个中国人的梦。我们应坚定信心、同心同德，为全面推进中华民族伟大复兴而团结奋斗。

Unit project

Reporting on "Space exploration and our lives"

When thinking of space exploration, what pops into our mind are rockets, spacecraft, or satellites, all of which seem far away from everyday life. However, it is increasingly recognized that progress made in space exploration has been transforming the way we live. Space technologies are widely applied to our daily life, bringing greater convenience and efficiency. In this unit project, you are going to find out and report on how space technologies have changed our lives.



Step 1 **Work in groups of three or four. As the benefits of space technologies might be observed in various fields of our daily life, work together to decide on a particular field for each member to explore based on personal interest.**

Step 2 **Look for relevant information on the Internet and summarize the information you have found. Note that you should find specific examples to illustrate the roles of space technologies in our lives.**

Step 3 **Work in groups to share and discuss the information.**

Step 4 **Work together to prepare a report based on the result of your discussion. Make sure that the application of space technologies in each field is illustrated by two or three examples.**

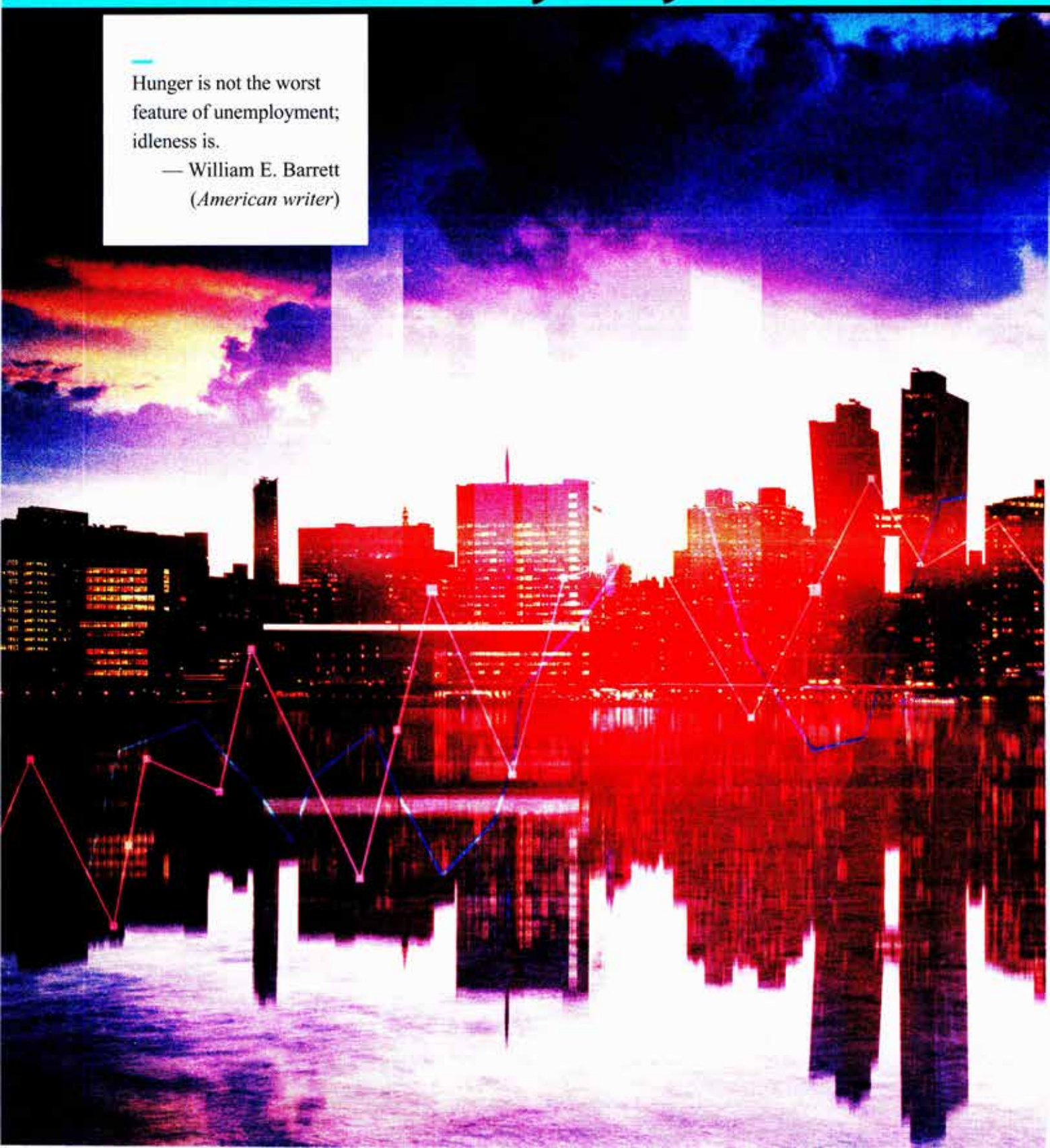
Step 5 **Present your report to the class.**

Unit 6

The economy: power behind everyday life

Hunger is not the worst feature of unemployment; idleness is.

— William E. Barrett (*American writer*)



Preview

Like life, the economy flows in cycles. A strong, healthy economy brings people opportunities for education, work, and well-being. However, when the economic cycle shifts downward, employment declines, people suffer as their standard of living is severely affected, and their anxiety and uncertainty about the future grow.

To avoid potential economic risks and provide people with basic living allowances when necessary, governments **implement laws and regulations to monitor and adjust the economy**. As individuals, we also **take an active part in the economic life**. It is necessary that we acquire some knowledge about basic economic phenomena and learn to understand the relationship between the economy and society. So, how much do you know about the government's financial regulations? What are the long-term effects that economic bubbles have on people and society? Do you have a financial plan for economic downturns?



Section A

Pre-reading activities

Look at the pictures and answer the following questions.



1 What situations are the people in the pictures likely to be in?
2 How will these situations affect ordinary people?
3 What suggestions do you have to help prevent economic crises?

Text A

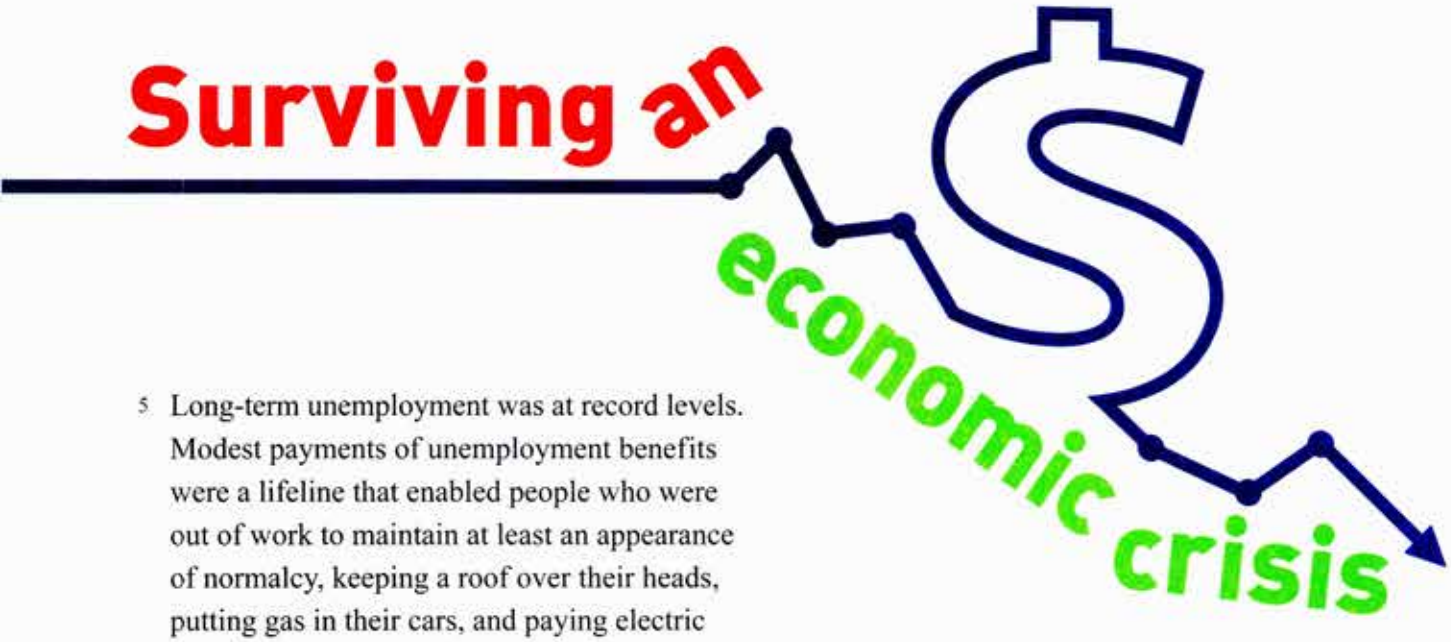
1 The economic **slump** that so many people suffered through **originated** in the United States, with a regulatory failure of **mortgages** rated less risky than they turned out to be. As large numbers of homeowners proved unable to repay their **loans**, the companies that owned the loans (as well as their **subsidiaries** and shareholders) lost **sizable** amounts of money. The effects of these **drastic** losses soon **spiraled** into the U.S. job market as **lay-offs** and **terminations**. The **rebound** was slow in coming. Many people experienced long months of financial difficulties just like the character in this story.

2 Facing **tenant eviction** after several months of unpaid rent, Sue Johnson packed up whatever she could fit into her two-door automobile and drove out of town.

3 She wound up at a motel, putting down the $260 she had managed to scrape together from friends and from selling her living room set. It was all the money Sue had after her unemployment benefits had **expired**. She faced life as a **migrant**, a previously unimaginable situation for a woman who, not that long before, had held a corporate job in a **metropolitan** city and had been **enrolled** in a graduate business school.

4 Sue knew that, in all likelihood, she would end up living in her car. She was part of a hard-luck group of jobless people who called themselves "99ers", because they had exhausted the maximum 99 weeks of unemployment insurance benefits that they could claim.

Surviving an economic crisis



5 Long-term unemployment was at record levels. Modest payments of unemployment benefits were a lifeline that enabled people who were out of work to maintain at least an appearance of normalcy, keeping a roof over their heads, putting gas in their cars, and paying electric and phone bills.

6 Without the checks, people like Sue, who had once been a director of **client** services at a technology company, began to **tumble** over the economic cliff. The last **remnants** of their former working-class or middle-class lives were gone, and all of them faced unsure futures.

7 When Sue received her last unemployment check, she felt a wave of profound grief. With no income to **deposit**, Sue's **checking account** went into a negative balance. Her car was on the **verge** of being **repossessed**. And, the constant **harassment** of the financing company for her car loan added to her daily stress. Each day, like a ping pong ball, Sue went back and **forth** between **resolve** and despair.

8 It was a **sickening** plunge considering that only a short year and a half before, Sue had earned $56,000 a year at her old job, enjoyed vacationing in places like Mexico and the Caribbean, and started business school at an excellent university.

9 Initially, Sue had tried to finish her university **certification** remotely, but finally dropped out because of the stress from her sinking finances. She applied for every possible job in the employment spectrum, from minimum-wage **retail** jobs to director positions.

10 Sue should have been evicted from her two-bedroom apartment for non-payment several months before she was, but, thankfully, the process was delayed by paperwork and bureaucracy. Eventually, the bureaucracy caught up with her, and she was given 10 days to leave her apartment for good. She had no choice but to **comply**.

11 That last day of her old life, Sue wept as she drove away. She wondered if she would ever again be able to **reclaim** that life of comfort and respect. She fell into complete despair and didn't know what would happen to her next.

12 Friends came to her aid. One friend wired her $200 while she was driving away from her old apartment, enabling her to find refuge in

a motel along the way. But Sue worried there wouldn't be any more charity that she desperately needed.

13 Helped by gas cards donated by a church, Sue decided to return to her hometown. She figured the health-care safety net there was better, as well as the job market. She contacted a local shelter but learned there was a waiting list. Welfare was not an option, because she didn't have young children. And, Sue knew that none of her three adult sons were in a position to help her.

14 "I knew the only help I was going to get was from me myself," Sue said. "I thought to myself: I have to take care of myself. I really, really need to get work. I need a job. I don't want to be seen as a parasite."

15 Sue's motel room was depressing. Lining the shelves underneath the television were her food supplies: rice and noodles that she mixed with water in the motel's ice bucket and heated up in a microwave, peanut butter and jelly, a loaf of white bread – the subsistence of a desperate person. Sue's days were spent surfing Internet job indexes and applying for jobs where the silent "No", "No", "No" led to a feeling of helplessness.

16 Sue had all new problems and obstacles to deal with, too, like what to do for an address for job applications. She worried about what would happen when her cell phone was cut off for non-payment, and calls to her number would disappear into an invisible world she could not reach.

17 Finally, an old friend sent Sue a ray of hope, a small miracle: $300 cash – just enough for another brutal week of financial struggles.

(890 words)



New words

slump /slʌmp/

n. [C, usu. sing.] 1 a period when there is a reduction in business and many people lose their jobs（经济的）不景气，萧条
2 a sudden decrease in prices, sales, profits, etc.（价格、销售额、利润等的）突然下跌

vi. fall or lean against sth. because you are not strong enough to stand（因无力站立而）倒下，倚，靠

▲ originate /əˈrɪdʒəneɪt/ *vi.* (always + *ad.* / *prep.*) begin to exist or appear for the first time 发源；开始

▲ mortgage /ˈmɔːgɪdʒ/ *n.* [C] a legal arrangement by which you borrow money from a bank or similar organization in order to buy a house, and pay back the money over a period of years 抵押贷款；按揭

▲ loan /ləʊn/

n. [C] an amount of money that you borrow from a bank, etc.（银行等的）贷款

vt. (*AmE*) lend sb. sth., esp. money 借给（尤指钱）

subsidiary /səbˈsɪdiəri/ *n.* [C] a company that is owned or controlled by another larger company 子公司；附属公司

▲ sizable /ˈsaɪzəbəl/ *a.* (*also* **sizeable**) fairly large 相当大的

▲ drastic /ˈdræstɪk/ *a.* extreme and sudden 激烈的；严厉的；突然的

spiral /ˈspaɪərəl/

vi. (always + *ad.* / *prep.*) 1 continuously become worse, more, or less 不断地恶化（或增长、减少）
2 move in a continuous curve that gets nearer to or further from its central point as it goes round 螺旋形上升（或下降）

n. [C] a line in the form of a curve that winds around a central point, moving further away from the center all the time 螺线；螺旋线

▲ lay-off *n.* [C] an act of making people unemployed because there is no more work left for them to do（因工作不多的）解雇，裁员

termination /ˌtɜːməˈneɪʃən/ *n.* [C, U] the end of an agreement, job, or situation 结束；终止

rebound

n. /ˈriːbaʊnd/ [C] (*business*) a positive reaction that happens after sth. negative 复兴；振兴

vi. /rɪˈbaʊnd/ hit a surface and then move quickly backward again 弹回；跳回

tenant /ˈtenənt/ *n.* [C] sb. who lives in a house, room, etc. and pays rent to the person who owns it 房客；租户

eviction /ɪˈvɪkʃən/ *n.* [C, U] the act or process of officially forcing sb. to leave a house or piece of land 驱逐；驱赶

expire /ɪkˈspaɪə/ *vi.* (of a document, an agreement, etc.) be no longer valid because the period of time for which it could be used has ended（文件、协议等）到期，因到期而失效、终止

▲ migrant /ˈmaɪgrənt/ *n.* [C] sb. who goes to live in another area or country, esp. in order to find work（尤指为寻找工作而迁移的）移民，移居者

metropolitan /ˌmetrəˈpɒlətən/ *a.* (*only before noun*) relating or belonging to a very large city 大城市的；大都会的

▲ enroll /ɪnˈrəʊl/ *v.* (*BrE* **enrol**) officially arrange to join a school, university, or course, or arrange for sb. else to do this 招（生）；吸收（成员）；注册（课程）

▲ client /ˈklaɪənt/ *n.* [C] sb. who gets services or advice from a professional person, company, or organization 客户；客人；顾客

tumble /ˈtʌmbəl/ *vi.*

1 (always + *ad.* / *prep.*) fall down quickly and suddenly, esp. with a rolling movement 倒下；跌倒；摔倒；滚落

2 fall rapidly in value or amount（价格或数量）暴跌，骤降

remnant /ˈremnənt/ *n.* [usu. pl.] a small remaining part of sth. 残余；剩余

▲ **deposit** /dɪˈpɒzɪt/

vt. put money or sth. valuable in a bank or other place where it will be safe（往银行账户）存（钱）；存放（贵重物品）

n. [C] an amount of money that you pay as the first part of the total payment for sth. 订金；预付款

▲ **account** /əˈkaʊnt/

n. [C] 1 (*abbr.* **a/c** *or* **acct.**) an arrangement that sb. has with a bank, etc. to keep money there, take some out, etc. 账户

2 a written or spoken description of sth. that has happened 描述；叙述；报告

vi. (**~ for sth.**) form a particular amount or part of sth. 占（一定数量或比例）

checking account *n.* [C] (*BrE* **current account**) a personal bank account which you can take money out of at any time using your checkbook or cash card 活期存款账户

verge /vɜːdʒ/ *n.* [C] (**on the ~ of sth.**) at the point where sth. is about to happen 濒于…；即将…

repossess /ˌriːpəˈzes/ *vt.* take back cars, furniture, or property from people who cannot continue to pay for them as they have arranged 收回（购物者未能按计划付款的货物）

harassment /ˈhærəsmənt/ *n.* [U] annoying or unpleasant behavior toward sb. that takes place regularly, e.g. threats, offensive remarks, or physical attacks 骚扰；侵扰

▲ **forth** /fɔːθ/ *ad.*

1 toward a place; forward 向某处；向前

2 away from a place; out 离去；外出

▲ **resolve** /rɪˈzɒlv/

n. [U] (*fml.*) strong determination to succeed in doing sth. 决心；决意

vt. 1 find a satisfactory way of dealing with a problem or difficulty 解决（问题、困难）

2 (*fml.*) make a definite decision to do sth. 决定，决意（做某事）

▲ **sicken** /ˈsɪkən/ *vt.* make sb. feel very shocked and angry 使大为震惊；使愤怒

sickening /ˈsɪkənɪŋ/ *a.* very shocking, annoying, or upsetting 令人震惊的；令人恼火的；令人难受的

certification /səˌtɪfɪˈkeɪʃən/ *n.* [C, U] an official document that says sb. is allowed to do a certain job, that sth. is of good quality, etc. 证书

▲ **retail** /ˈriːteɪl/

n. [U] the sale of goods in shops to customers, for their own use and not for selling to anyone else 零售；零卖

vi. (*technical*) be sold for a particular price in a shop（以某价格）零售

vt. (*technical*) sell goods in shops 零售；零卖

▲ **comply** /kəmˈplaɪ/ *vi.* (*fml.*) do what you have to do or are asked to do 服从；遵守

reclaim /rɪˈkleɪm/ *vt.*

1 get back sth. that you have lost or that has been taken away from you 恢复；夺回

2 get back an amount of money that you have paid 取回（已付的金钱）

▲ **donate** /dəʊˈneɪt/ *v.* give sth., esp. money, to a person or an organization in order to help them 捐赠，捐献（尤指钱）

parasite /ˈpærəsaɪt/ *n.* [C]

1 (*infml.*) a lazy person who does not work but depends on other people – used to show disapproval 靠他人为生的人，寄生虫（含贬义）

2 a plant or animal that lives on or in another plant or animal and gets food from it 寄生植物；寄生动物；寄生虫

jelly /ˈdʒeli/ *n.* [C, U] a type of jam that does not contain any pieces of fruit（不含水果块的）果酱

subsistence /səbˈsɪstəns/ *n.* [U]
1 the smallest amount of food or money that you need to stay alive 赖以活命的食物（或钱）
2 the state of having just enough money or food to stay alive 勉强维持生活

▲ surf /sɜːf/
vt. look quickly through information on the Internet for anything that interests you 网上冲浪；浏览因特网
v. ride on waves while standing on a special board 冲（浪）

▲ index /ˈɪndeks/ *n.* [C]
1 (*pl.* **indexes**) a set of cards or a database containing information, usu. arranged in alphabetical order and used esp. in a library（尤用于图书馆的）卡片（或资料库）索引
2 (*pl.* **indices** *or* **indexes**) (*technical*) a system by which prices, costs, etc. can be compared to those of a previous date（用于比较今昔价格、费用等的）指数

▲ obstacle /ˈɒbstəkəl/ *n.* [C]
1 sth. that makes it difficult to achieve sth. 障碍；阻碍；妨碍
2 an object which blocks your way, so that you must try to go around it 障碍物

▲ brutal /ˈbruːtl/ *a.*
1 extreme and unpleasant 令人不快的
2 very cruel and violent 野蛮的；凶残的

Phrases and expressions

pack sth. up put things into boxes, suitcases, bags, etc. in order to take or store them somewhere 把…打包；把…装盒（或箱、袋等）

wind up (*infml.*) be in an unpleasant situation or place after a lot has happened 以（难堪的境况）告终

put sth. down pay part of the total cost of sth., so that you can pay the rest later 付（订金）

scrape sth. together / up get enough money for a particular purpose, when this is difficult（为某目的）勉强筹集，凑足（钱款）

a roof over one's head a place to live 栖身之所；住处

back and forth going in one direction and then in the opposite direction, and repeating this several times 来回地

catch up with sb. finally find sb. who has been doing sth. illegal and punish them（终于）抓住并惩罚（某人）

for good permanently 永远

come / go to sb.'s aid help sb. 帮助某人

be in a position to do sth. be able to do sth. because you have the ability, money, or power to do it（因为有能力、金钱或权力而）能够做

Proper names

Sue Johnson /ˈdʒɒnsən/ 苏·约翰逊（人名）

Mexico /ˈmeksɪkəʊ/ 墨西哥（北美洲国家）

the Caribbean /ˌkærɪˈbiːən/ 加勒比地区（由加勒比海和包括西印度群岛在内的岛屿，以及周边海岸组成）

Reading comprehension

Understanding the text

1 Answer the following questions.

1 What was the consequence when large numbers of homeowners failed to repay their loans?
2 Who were the "99ers"?
3 What did the unemployment benefits mean to the jobless people?
4 Why does the author say Sue spent each day like a ping pong ball?
5 Why did Sue decide to return to her hometown?
6 Why did Sue think the only help she was going to get was from herself?
7 What new problems and obstacles did Sue have to face when she applied for a job?
8 What does the author intend to tell us by Sue's story?

Critical thinking

2 Work in pairs and discuss the following questions.

1 In what sense is the establishment of a social security system important to economic development?
2 What initiatives can the government undertake to save people like Sue from economic crises?
3 What role do you think economic regulation and free competition play in the market?

Language focus

Words in use

3 Fill in the blanks with the words given below. Change the form where necessary. Each word can be used only once.

comply donate expire
harassment lay-off originate
reclaim resolve
spiral subsistence

1 When you _____ clothes, you not only free up room in your closet but also help people in need.
2 The young man watched his financial life _____ downward just when he thought he had overcome the obstacles which had dominated his past.
3 Setbacks are the things in life that test your _____ to achieve your goals.
4 The company was reportedly going bankrupt and this would result in _____ of thousands of employees.
5 She has always lived a life of wealth and doesn't understand that many things she is used to are unimaginable luxuries to people on _____ wages.
6 The social media giant has announced that it is to roll out new tools to protect its users from _____ or unwanted contact from other people.
7 Our practices should _____ with the local rules so that we can better adapt to the local community.
8 Though she lost the title of female world swimming champion last year, she _____ it this year when she gave it all she could.

9 As a healthy drink that _____ in China and has become popular around the world, tea serves as a cultural ambassador for the nation.

10 Drivers do not need to apply to renew their license until they receive a reminder before their extension _____.

Word building



与某些动词结合构成名词，表示相关的行为或状态。其常见的变体形式包括 -ation、-ition、-sion 和 -tion。

compete		competition
conclude		conclusion
reduce		reduction
accumulate	>	**accumulation**
accuse	>	**accusation**
assassinate	>	**assassination**
calculate	>	**calculation**
exhaust	>	**exhaustion**



与某些名词或形容词结合构成新名词，表示相关的状态、条件或经历某事的时期。

child		childhood
false	>	**falsehood**
man	>	**manhood**

4 Fill in the blanks with the words given below. Change the form where necessary. Each word can be used only once.

accumulation accusation
assassination calculation
exhaustion falsehood manhood

1 Through years of service, the _____ of experience and knowledge was invaluable to the agency.

2 The village was divided into two groups: those who wanted him cleared of the crime and those who wanted the _____ against him proven to be true.

3 As the boys grow to _____, they are encouraged to learn important lessons about each other, their fathers, and themselves.

4 We have made some _____ within our own organization and found the method was not really a practical way of recovering the heat energy.

5 After days of hunger and _____, the two puppies found one of our feeding stations and made it their new home.

6 The proposed plan is designed to support the crackdown (严厉打击) against drug dealers, which was launched by the government after the _____ of the president.

7 It is difficult to imagine a world without common sense and the distinction between truth and _____.

Banked cloze

5 Fill in the blanks by selecting suitable words from the word bank. You may not use any of the words more than once.

A artificial	F confessions	K relay
B beneficial	G embody	L repay
C boost	H embrace	M sessions
D burdensome	I mortgages	N tempted
E comply	J postage	O tumbled

While older people in China typically believe that saving is a virtue, their children might have other ideas. Many young people refuse to 1) _____ with the traditional wisdom. They prefer to spend their money, buy now, and worry about paying later. According to a recent report, China's household savings rate has 2) _____ in recent years.

The younger generation is more willing to spend money on fine food, tourism, gymnasium and fitness 3) _____, and high-tech products. Some of them spend all their salary by the end of each month, with part of the salary used to 4) _____ loans.

In recent years, Chinese banks and finance companies have launched various kinds of consumer credit services to encourage consumption. Unlike 5) _____, they don't require guarantees (抵押品). The services have quickly become popular with the younger generation, who are also the main force for mobile payment, and are willing to 6) _____ new technology and financial products. Generally, consumption on credit can be 7) _____ to the development of the financial and retail sectors, and will eventually 8) _____ economic growth.

However, to ensure the healthy development of consumer finance, it is important for financial institutions to manage the default (违约) risks, especially for people who have 9) _____ debts and may have difficulty in repaying their loans. It is also important to educate young people about the importance of maintaining a good credit record, especially for those easily 10) _____ by compulsive buying. They need to know a good credit record is important for their financial well-being.

Expressions in use

6 Fill in the blanks with the expressions given below. Change the form where necessary. Each expression can be used only once.

a roof over one's head account for
come to sb.'s aid for good on the verge of
pack … up scrape … together wind up

1 If you have _____, food in your refrigerator, and clothes on your back, you are richer than many people in this world.
2 The team _____ in fifth place at the most recent Asian Games, failing to earn a medal for the first time in 48 years.
3 He and four classmates formed the company and _____ a combined start-up sum of 40,000 yuan.
4 They shoulder the task of conducting research on the protection of rare plants or plants _____ extinction (灭绝).
5 The treatment was completely successful and the pain disappeared _____.
6 According to a report, Asian market _____ 62 percent of the company's revenue last year.
7 When he is in a difficult situation, his friends _____, giving emotional and material support.
8 Any construction waste and household waste generated during construction must be _____ and taken away.

Structure analysis and writing

Structure analysis

Further developing a cause-and-effect essay

In this unit, the technique for writing cause-and-effect essays is explored in terms of organization. When writing a cause-and-effect essay, you have to consider two strategic points: (1) whether you are exploring causes or effects, or both, and (2) what order of the causes or effects you are going to follow, e.g. from the least to the most important or vice versa. Unlike the texts in B2U6 and B3U3, in which the authors intend to explore causes, Text A in this unit mainly presents effects, namely how the economic crisis greatly affects almost every aspect of the lives of individuals, through the story of Sue Johnson.

Para. 1 is the introduction of the text, introducing the root cause of the economic slump and the great impact of the crisis – so many people experienced long months of financial difficulties. And the rest of the story touches upon how the crisis affected individuals, such as Sue. The effects are explored in detail from different aspects of Sue's life in Paras. 7-11. The following analysis (Paras. 7-11) explains what happened to Sue as a result of the economic crisis.

Effects

- Her loss of income (Para. 7)
- Her loss of a high standard of living (Para. 8)
- Her loss of an opportunity for an education (Para. 9)
- Her loss of shelter (Para. 10)
- Her loss of belief and confidence in life (Para. 11)

The effects, as can be seen, are arranged from those on everyday life such as the loss of income and a high standard of living to the psychological consequence: the loss of belief and confidence in life.

Structured writing

Read the sample essay and see how the effects are developed.

Topic
Career opportunities created by the aging population

Introduction
Thesis statement: The aging population in America creates career opportunities in the medical and health professions, in the legal field, and in business.

Body
Effect 1: Medical and health professionals are needed.
Effect 2: Lawyers are in need.
Effect 3: Business people see huge opportunities.

Conclusion
The expansion of America's elderly population provides good career opportunities in many areas.

Old is suddenly in. The current growth of the population aged 65 and older is unprecedented in U.S. history. This trend poses profound problems for the government and society. But it also creates career opportunities in the medical and health professions, in the legal field, and in business.

Medical and health professionals are imperatively (迫切地) needed. Every year, thousands of medical and health professions students are trained at community-based sites. However, a large number of rural counties in the U.S. still suffer from a shortage of primary care health professionals.

Lawyers specializing in elder law are in need. Elder law covers everything from trusts and estate (个人财产) planning to nursing home abuse and age discrimination. The U.S. society needs those specialists desperately because of their focus on the legal needs of elderly adults.

Business people see huge opportunities in the market catering for the needs of the elderly. The longevity economy, representing all economic activity serving the needs of American senior citizens, is expected to top $13.5 trillion by 2032, according to Oxford Economics. Many business owners can find their career opportunities in this huge market and finally reap rewards from it.

In short, the expansion of America's elderly population provides good career opportunities in many areas.

7 Write an essay of no less than 140 words on one of the following topics. One topic has an outline that you can follow.

Topic

The negative effects of staying up late

Introduction

Thesis statement: Staying up late can do severe harm to us mainly in three aspects.

Body

Effect 1: Staying up late can have negative impacts on our physical health.
Effect 2: Staying up late can lower our work efficiency.
Effect 3: Staying up late can bring about mental stress.

Conclusion

Staying up late is by no means a good choice for us.

More topics

- The effects of peer pressure
- The effects of excessive packaging

Section B

Reading skills

Recognizing definitions in a text

The decoding of a written word or phrase is a very important aspect of the act of reading. Without decoding the important written words or phrases, reading comprehension is impossible. This explains why some readers can "read" but cannot understand what they are reading. Sometimes the author offers the reader the definitions of difficult written words or phrases in context to facilitate understanding. If the reader can recognize the definitions and integrate what is read with their prior knowledge, common sense, etc., the words or phrases can be easily decoded. Usually, definitions may be developed in the following ways.

- A definition typically starts with the meaning of a term. The meaning is then explained with a series of details.
- A definition may be developed through examples.
- A definition may be developed through comparison and contrast.
- A definition may be developed by describing how a certain event happens.

Take the sentences from Text A, for example.

Example 1

She was part of a hard-luck group of jobless people who called themselves "99ers", because they had exhausted the maximum 99 weeks of unemployment insurance benefits that they could claim. (Para. 4)

Question: Who are the "99ers"?
Answer: The "99ers" are a hard-luck group of jobless people who have exhausted the maximum 99 weeks of unemployment insurance benefits that they could claim.

The author provides the meaning of "99ers" by explaining how people became "99ers" in the crisis.

Example 2

Modest payments of unemployment benefits were a lifeline that enabled people who were out of work to maintain at least an appearance of normalcy, keeping a roof over their heads, putting gas in their cars, and paying electric and phone bills. (Para. 5)

Question: What does "lifeline" mean in this particular context?
Answer: "Lifeline" in the context means something that enables people who are out of work to maintain at least a normal life.

The author here uses an attributive clause to explain what a "lifeline" means.

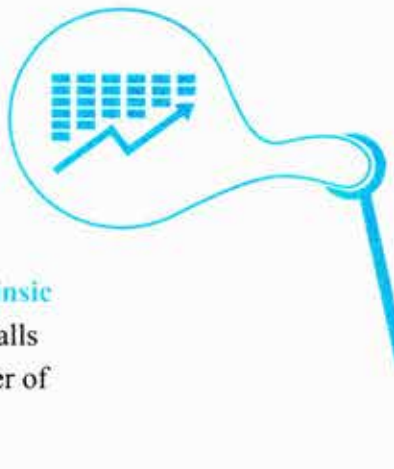
Question: What does "normalcy" refer to in the text?
Answer: "Normalcy" in the text refers to the normal living conditions in which people are able to keep a roof over their heads, put gas in their cars, pay electric and phone bills, etc.

The author explains the meaning of "normalcy" by giving specific examples.

1 Read Text B and answer the questions between the paragraphs. Then try to identify how the definitions of the terms are developed in the context.

Text B

Economic bubbles: causes and conditions



1 Economic bubbles occur when, for any number of reasons, excessive investment in **commodities** (such as oil), securities (such as stocks and bonds), **real estate**, or collectibles drives up prices well beyond the item's **intrinsic** value. The inevitable result of this **boom** in price is a crash or **bust**. The price falls sharply once it becomes clear that it has grown far beyond the purchasing power of potential customers.

Q1 What are "economic bubbles"?

2 Speculators risk money in such investments because they hope that the price of an asset they purchase will quickly increase. Since most speculators are nervous about where they invest their money, bubbles are by no means the norm. After all, every investment **entails** the risk that it is overpriced. Speculators also know that rising prices will encourage either greater production of a commodity or greater willingness of current owners to sell. Either of these conditions can serve as a "negative **feedback**" mechanism that adjusts prices downward. As an **analogy**, think of negative economic



feedback like your eyes. As the light gets brighter, your pupils get smaller and let in less light. But what if, instead, your eyes worked as a "positive feedback" mechanism? In sunlight, your pupils would open wide and damage your eyes.

Q2 What is the "negative feedback mechanism" of the economy?

3 Economic bubbles occur when prices trending sharply upward spur positive, rather than negative, feedback. For whatever reason (fear of shortages, greed, an excessively optimistic attitude toward the future, or flaws in the analysis of an asset's underlying value), buyers believe that the value of the asset will continue to rise. If the price rises, overly enthusiastic speculators buy more, or those who missed out on the lower price flock to buy before the price rises any higher. The foremost explanation is the "greater fool theory": Buyers justify their purchases by assuring themselves they will find "a greater fool" who will pay even more. Buyer enthusiasm infects other buyers, amplifying the effect even further. Under the right conditions, prices can reach dizzying heights before falling. One famous example is the tulip-buying bubble which happened in the Netherlands in the 1630s when a single tulip bulb could cost a year's salary.

Q3 What is the "greater fool theory"?

4 Most bubbles are easily assimilated or averted by an elastic market. Provided the bubble is small enough, the losers earn wisdom in retrospect, and the winners earn a lot of money. But the effects of a bubble might become cumulative if many owners of an overpriced asset feel rich and spend foolishly, especially in a period of deregulation. Imagine this: You buy a house for $200,000, for which you borrowed $160,000 beforehand. You have $40,000 in equity in the house. Over the next five years, the market appraisal rises to $500,000. Now you have $340,000 in equity ($500,000 – $160,000), so you borrow another $240,000 from a bank using this equity to secure the loan. You still have $100,000 in equity in your home, and you have $240,000 to spend. You suddenly feel less need to be economical with your purchases and allocate more money for things like a vacation home and a new car.

5 But equity is not revenue. The market holds long enough for you to spend the money. Then it crashes and the value of your home falls to $325,000. Now you have negative equity and owe the bank $400,000. So you default on your loan and give your house,



car, and vacation home to the bank. If this situation is widespread, it can culminate in the failure of those banks and a severe blow to the lending needed to grow the economy.

6 There are also stock market bubbles. In a normal market, investors buy stock in a company because they anticipate that future profits will become dividends and they believe the value of the company's assets will increase. Sometimes, though, a "herd mentality" sets in and too many brokers rush to buy, driving prices like mercury up a thermometer to levels that prove unrealistic. Eventually, it becomes clear that further increases are not forthcoming and price deterioration develops, followed by a swift drop. When this happens to too many companies in aggregate, it is called a stock market crash.

Q4 How is "herd mentality" defined here?
Q5 What is a "stock market crash"?

7 A striking example of a stock market bubble is the "dot-com" bubble. The buzz about the economic possibilities of the Internet encouraged investors to fund the creation of many dot-com companies – too many, it turned out. For several years, dozens of entrepreneurs sought to duplicate for themselves the results of those that had come before. Many investors envisaged wealth for any business with a website that could advertise on TV or billboards, even if its actual services were ambiguous. Instead, on March 10, 2000, the dot-com boom reached its peak when the stock index hit 5,132.52. Over the next two and a half years, the index dropped to as low as 1,108.49. Very few companies bucked the trend. Most had blundered into awful financial difficulties, selling off their assets to healthier companies.

Q6 What is the "dot-com bubble"?

8 Bubbles are not limited to the arena of real estate or "get-rich" stock offerings. In the 1990s, a series of stuffed animal toys became such a fad that speculators bought up large quantities, assuming that their value as collectibles would continue to rise. Did anyone make money on that fad? If you check out their prices on an online auction site, you can decide whether any of these sellers have struck it rich.

(893 words)

New words

▲ commodity /kəˈmɒdəti/ *n.* [C] a product that is bought and sold 商品

▲ estate /ɪˈsteɪt/ *n.*

1 [C] (*BrE*) an area of land with a lot of houses or factories of the same type on it 住宅区；工业区；工厂区

2 [sing.] (*law*) all of sb.'s property and money, esp. everything that is left after they die 个人全部财产；（尤指）遗产

real estate *n.* [U] (*also* **realty**) (*esp. AmE*) property in the form of land or houses 房地产；不动产

intrinsic /ɪnˈtrɪnsɪk/ *a.* being part of the nature or character of sb. or sth. 本质的；内在的；固有的

▲ boom /buːm/ *n.* [C]

1 an increase in amount, frequency, or success 增长

2 an increase in economic activity, e.g., in the number of things that are being bought and sold（经济）繁荣

bust /bʌst/

n. [C] a period of economic difficulty or depression 经济萧条（或不景气）时期

vt. (*BrE* **bust, bust**; *esp. AmE* **busted, busted**) (*infml.*) break sth. 打烂；打碎；弄坏

entail /ɪnˈteɪl/ *vt.* involve sth. as a necessary or inevitable part or consequence 使成为必需；使成为必然

▲ feedback /ˈfiːdbæk/ *n.* [U]

1 the modification or control of a process or system by its results or effects, e.g. in a biochemical pathway or behavioral response（生化途径或行为反应等的）反馈

2 advice, criticism, or information about how good or useful sth. or sb.'s work is 反馈的意见（或信息）

analogy /əˈnælədʒi/ *n.* [C, U] a comparison between two situations, processes, etc. that is intended to show that the two are similar 比拟；比喻；类比

▲ spur /spɜː/ *vt.*

1 cause or promote the development of ; stimulate 促使；促进；刺激

2 (*also* ~ **sb. on**) encourage sb. or make them want to do sth. 激励；鼓励

▲ flaw /flɔː/ *n.* [C]

1 a mistake or problem in an argument, plan, set of ideas, etc.（论点、计划、思想等中的）错误，缺陷

2 a mistake, mark, or weakness that makes sth. imperfect 瑕疵；缺点

underlying /ˌʌndəˈlaɪɪŋ/ *a.*

1 (*business*) an underlying number or amount shows what the true amount or level of sth. is（数量或水平）实际的

2 important in a situation but not always easily noticed or stated clearly 根本的；潜在的；隐含的

▲ flock /flɒk/

vi. gather together in a large group, usu. because there is sth. interesting or exciting（通常因某种有趣或刺激的事物而）群集，聚集，蜂拥

n. [C] a group of birds, sheep, or goats（禽类、绵羊或山羊的）一群

▲ foremost /ˈfɔːməʊst/ *a.* the best or most important 最好的；最重要的

▲ justify /ˈdʒʌstɪfaɪ/ *vt.*

1 give an acceptable explanation for sth. that other people think is unreasonable 证明（别人认为不合理的事）有道理；为…辩护

2 be a good and acceptable reason for sth. 是…的正当理由

amplify /ˈæmplɪfaɪ/ *vt.*

1 (*fml.*) increase the effects or strength of sth. 增强

2 make sound louder, esp. musical sound 放大（声音，尤指音乐声）

tulip /'tju:lɪp/ *n.* [C] 郁金香

▲ bulb /bʌlb/ *n.* [C]
1 （植物的）鳞茎
2 灯泡

assimilate /ə'sɪməleɪt/
v. (cause sth. to) become absorbed into the body after digestion（使某物）经消化而吸收
vt. fully understand an idea or some information so that you are able to use it yourself 透彻理解；消化；吸收

avert /ə'vɜ:t/ *vt.* prevent sth. unpleasant from happening 防止，避免（不快之事）

elastic /ɪ'læstɪk/ *a.*
1 able to change when the situation changes 易顺应的；灵活的；随意的
2 able to return to its normal or previous size or shape after being pulled or pressed 有弹性的；有弹力的

▲ provided /prə'vaɪdɪd/ *conj.* (*also* ~ **that**) used to say that sth. will only be possible if sth. else happens or is done 只要；如果…的话

retrospect /'retrəspekt/ *n.* (**in** ~) thinking back to a time in the past, esp. with the advantage of knowing more now than you did then 回顾；回想

cumulative /'kju:mjələtɪv/ *a.* increasing gradually as more of sth. is added or happens 积累的；渐增的

▲ beforehand /bɪ'fɔ:hænd/ *ad.* before sth. else happens or is done 事先；预先；事前

equity /'ekwəti/ *n.* [U]
1 (*technical*) the amount of money that you would have left if you sold your house and paid off the money you borrowed to buy the house（还清贷款后的）房产净值
2 (*fml.*) a situation in which all people are treated equally and no one has an unfair advantage 公平；公正

appraisal /ə'preɪzəl/ *n.* [C, U] a statement or opinion judging the worth, value, or condition of sth. 评价；估计；鉴定

allocate /'æləkeɪt/ *vt.* use sth. for a particular purpose, give sth. to a particular person, etc., esp. after an official decision has been made 分配；配给

default /dɪ'fɔ:lt/
vi. fail to pay money that you owe at the right time 债务违约；拖欠
n. [C, U] (*fml.*) failure to pay money that you owe at the right time 债务违约；拖欠

culminate /'kʌlməneɪt/ *vi.* (**~ in / with sth.**) happen or exist as the final result of a process or situation 以…告终

dividend /'dɪvədənd/ *n.* [C] a part of a company's profit that is divided among the people with shares in the company 股利；股息；红利

▲ herd /hɜ:d/
n. [C] a group of animals of the same type that live and feed together 兽群；牧群
vt. (always + *ad.* / *prep.*) bring people together in a large group, esp. roughly（尤指粗暴地）使集合在一起

▲ mentality /men'tæləti/ *n.* [C] a particular attitude or way of thinking, esp. one that you think is wrong or stupid（尤指被视为错误或愚蠢的）心态

▲ broker /'brəʊkə/ *n.* [C] sb. who buys and sells things such as shares in companies or foreign money for other people（为他人买卖股票或外汇的）经纪人

mercury /'mɜ:kjəri/ *n.* [U] 汞；水银

▲ **thermometer** /θəˈmɒmɪtə/ *n.* [C] a piece of equipment that measures the temperature of the air, of your body, etc. 温度计；寒暑表；体温计

▲ **deterioration** /dɪˌtɪərɪəˈreɪʃən/ *n.* [C, U] the fact or process of becoming worse 恶化；堕落；退化

aggregate /ˈægrɪgət/ *n.* [C] (*fml.*) the total after a lot of different figures or points have been added together 总数；合计

▲ **striking** /ˈstraɪkɪŋ/ *a.* interesting and unusual enough to attract attention 引人注目的；异乎寻常的；显著的

buzz /bʌz/

n. [sing.] 1 (*infml.*) a strong feeling of pleasure or excitement 高兴；兴奋
2 a continuous noise 嗡嗡声；嗖嗖声

vi. make a continuous sound, like the sound of a bee 发出嗡嗡声

duplicate /ˈdjuːplɪkeɪt/ *vt.* copy sth. exactly 复制

envisage /ɪnˈvɪzɪdʒ/ *vt.* think that sth. is likely to happen in the future 展望；设想

billboard /ˈbɪlbɔːd/ *n.* [C] (*BrE* **hoarding**) a large sign used for advertising 广告牌（或板）

ambiguous /æmˈbɪgjuəs/ *a.*

1 confusing or not definite, and so difficult to understand 不明确的；难以理解的；暧昧的
2 not clear, or capable of being understood in more than one way 含糊不清的；模棱两可的

▲ **buck** /bʌk/

v. oppose sth. in a direct way 反抗；抵抗

n. [C] (*infml*) a U.S., Canadian, or Australian dollar 美元；加元；澳元

blunder /ˈblʌndə/

vi. 1 (~ **into / in**) enter a place or become involved in a difficult situation by mistake 误入（某地）；不小心陷入（困境）
2 (always + *ad.* / *prep.*) move in an unsteady way, as if you cannot see properly 踉踉跄跄地走；跌跌撞撞

n. [C] a careless or stupid mistake 疏忽；愚蠢的错误

fad /fæd/ *n.* [C] sth. that people like or do for a short time, or that is fashionable for a short time 一时的狂热；时尚；风尚

auction /ˈɔːkʃən/

n. [C, U] a public meeting where land, buildings, paintings, etc. are sold to the person who offers the most money for them 拍卖（会）

vt. (*also* ~ **off**) sell sth. at an auction 拍卖

Phrases and expressions

any number of sth. a lot of sth. 好多某事物

drive sth. up make a price or amount rise to a higher level 提高（价格）；增加（数量）

by no means / not by any means not at all 绝不；一点儿都不

let sb. / sth. in allow sb. or sth. to enter 允许…进入

set in (of rain, bad weather, infection, etc.) begin and seem likely to continue（雨、恶劣天气、感染等）到来，开始

in (the) aggregate (*fml.*) added together as a total or single amount 总共；作为总体

sell sth. off sell sth. quickly and for a low price, usu. because you need money（通常因需要钱而快速地）廉价出售

be limited to sth. exist or happen only in a particular place, group, or area of activity 局限于某处（或团体、范围）

buy sth. up buy large amounts of sth. or all of it that is available 大量买进；全部买下

strike it rich suddenly make a lot of money 暴富

Reading comprehension

Understanding the text

2 Choose the best answer to each of the following questions.

1 Which of the following is the consequence of economic bubbles?
- A Panic buying.
- B A crash in price.
- C Excessive investment.
- D Raised purchasing power.

2 Why are economic bubbles by no means the norm?
- A Speculators are nervous about their investment.
- B People usually know the intrinsic value of an asset.
- C Manufacturers are reluctant to expand production for fear of risk.
- D Overpriced products are beyond the purchasing power of customers.

3 In a positive feedback system, what would happen when prices increase sharply?
- A Speculators know the prices will fall in the near future.
- B Speculators are eager to sell their assets to make a profit.
- C Speculators become greedier and buy more assets.
- D Speculators become more united to get the best prices.

4 The "greater fool theory" explains _____.
- A how prices reach dizzying heights
- B how people's foolishness can be avoided
- C why buyers buy more than necessary
- D why speculators do not flock to the market

5 What will happen when big economic bubbles occur?
- A The involved banks may fail.
- B You will be economical with your purchases.
- C The market can easily assimilate the bubbles.
- D The market can help the winners earn wisdom.

6 The "herd mentality" explains _____.
- A how the stock market goes bust
- B what happens to a company in economic crises
- C how brokers drive the stock prices to unrealistic heights
- D how investors buy stock in a company in a reasonable way

7 What do we know about the "dot-com" bubble?
- A The stock index dropped by about 40 percent in 2002.
- B Many companies ended up selling off their assets to other companies.
- C The investors were provided with false information about the business.
- D The stock index dropped to 1,108.49 right after the boom reached its peak.

8 What can we learn from the text?
- A Economic bubbles reflect the laws of economics.
- B Economic bubbles often occur in the stock market.
- C Economic bubbles mostly result in very bad consequences.
- D Economic bubbles first appeared at the turn of the 21st century.

Critical thinking

3 Work in pairs and discuss the following questions.

1 How do you understand the relationship between people's greed and economic bubbles?
2 What measures should be taken to curb speculation in economic activities?
3 Should basic economics be part of the required school curriculum? Why or why not?

Collocation



The ***economic slump*** (B3U6A) in 2008 was caused by many factors, including the rise in subprime lending (次级贷款) which made it too easy for ***overly enthusiastic*** (B3U6B) people to buy houses. Since credit went unchecked, thousands of people took out loans larger than they could afford in the hope that they could get profit from the ***elastic market*** (B3U6B). It's true that a lot of people got rich quickly and gained more ***purchasing power*** (B3U6B). However, the optimism eventually caused a ***stock market crash*** (B3U6B) and ***drastic losses*** (B3U6A) in the mortgage-backed assets sector, which inevitably set off a chain reaction in the economy such as ***long-term unemployment*** (B3U6A), ***sinking finances*** (B3U6A), and ***negative equity*** (B3U6B).

Many people were in an ***unimaginable situation*** (B3U6A). When companies across the ***employment spectrum*** (B3U6A) announced more job cuts than expected, more and more people had to face job insecurity and ***unsure futures*** (B3U6A), which substantially added to their ***daily stress*** (B3U6A). With personal income ***falling sharply*** (B3U6B), some might suffer ***constant harassment*** (B3U6A) from debt collection agencies and even have to face ***tenant eviction*** (B3U6A). They were easily stricken with ***profound grief*** (B3U6A), which led to a ***further increase*** (B3U6B) in the risk of depression that could badly affect their mental health.

4 Complete the following passage by filling in the blanks with appropriate collocations from the texts. You are provided with the first letter(s) for each of the collocations. Change the form where necessary.

In recent years, much of the media focus in the U.S. has been on "the new poor" due to the economic crisis. While it is undoubtedly true that there are many people whose incomes are 1) *f*_____ *s*_____, those who have been worst hit come from distinctly vulnerable groups. They are now in an 2) *un*_____ *si*_____, particularly people who were already experiencing poverty before the crisis, as well as young people and the elderly.

Because of the 3) *ec*_____ *s*_____, the incomes of poor people have been squeezed. Many people are facing 4) *t*_____ *ev*_____ due to their inability to pay their rent. Furthermore, the erosion (削弱) of 5) *pur*_____ *p*_____ is increasingly seen as a major threat, an inevitable result of 6) *fu*_____ *in*_____ in the price of basic commodities. Gas, electricity, and water charges, as well as bank charges, the cost of food, and rent, are rising.

The 7) *long-*_____ *un*_____, especially youth unemployment that often leads to 8) *dr*_____ *l*_____ of social labor, also affects vulnerable groups. As the situation gets worse across the 9) *em*_____ *sp*_____, men's unemployment rises first, but women become mostly affected by cuts in social sector jobs, which account for a large part of employment.

Moreover, many of the worst social impacts of 10) *si*_____ *fi*_____ are not readily apparent, but are likely to have serious long-term implications. Such impacts include hidden unemployment, family tensions, risks of violence, 11) *un*_____ *f*_____, a loss of confidence and aspiration among children, as well as the 12) *d*_____ *s*_____ from housing insecurity, declining living standards, and 13) *ne*_____ *eq*_____.

Stories of China

The sharing economy turns a new page with books

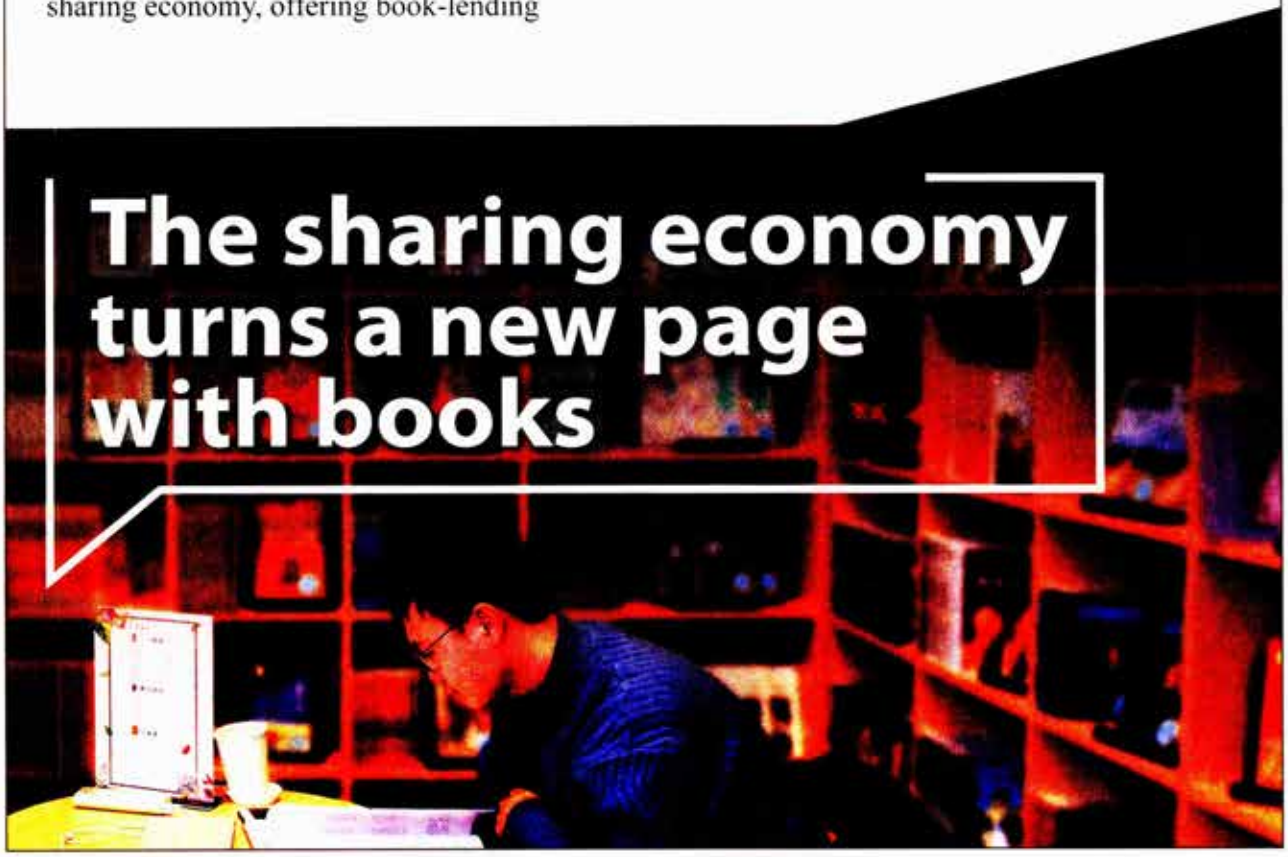
From sharing bicycles to sharing cars, China's sharing economy has now swept into the book industry. Book-sharing services have been launched in cities such as Shanghai, Suzhou, and Hefei.

Sanxiaokou Xinhua Bookstore in Hefei of Anhui Province, which declared itself the "first sharing bookstore in the world", opened to the public in July 2017. Readers need to download an app and pay a deposit online. Then they can borrow books by scanning the QR code. During the first month of the bookstore's operation, the number of books borrowed and returned reached nearly 80,000.

In addition, banks are also involved in the sharing economy, offering book-lending services. Users can borrow books after registering through the official account on social media and paying the deposit.

"It doesn't matter if books are sold or shared; as long as they are read, they benefit society. Culture can be delivered in different forms," said a woman who is a book lover and likes the sharing of books. "Compared with borrowing books from libraries, the large bookstores update their shelves more frequently, so readers can enjoy their favorite books more easily."

A national reading survey showed that on average, Chinese people read less than eight



books a year. Jumping on the bandwagon (风尚) of the sharing economy may tempt young people to return to bookstores first, and help develop their reading habits.

However, there is still no specific definition of "book sharing", and many problems need to be resolved in the actual operation.

Some experts claim that some "book sharing" is just a gimmick (噱头), the same stuff with a new label. From a business perspective, they think that today's "book sharing" is no different from the book-lending services some small bookstores have long offered. This is not real sharing as long as the book-sharing services require a deposite or impose a fine.

Some people claim that the "sharing bookstore" is only a concept, just like the previous "flowing bookstall" on the street, which can also be labeled as "sharing".

Many people believe that "book sharing" is a new business attempt in the book industry and the public should give it a chance. There is a long way to go, for "book sharing".

Exercises

Translation

Translate the following paragraph into English.

当前，中国实行更加积极主动的开放战略，构建面向全球的高标准自由贸易区网络，加快推进自由贸易试验区、海南自由贸易港建设。中国已成为140多个国家和地区的主要贸易伙伴，吸引外资和对外投资（outbound investment）居世界前列。未来，中国将不断推进高水平对外开放，提升贸易投资合作质量和水平，加快建设贸易强国。

Unit project

Conducting an interview on Chinese college students' finances

As a college student undergoing the transition from living at home to living independently, you need to learn to manage your money wisely and become a financially responsible adult. You should carefully consider how to improve your finances. In this unit project, you are expected to conduct an interview on Chinese college students' finances and prepare a report on it.

Step 1 **Work in groups of three or four. Each group member gets prepared to interview three or four students. You can use the following questions as references.**

1 Where does your money come from?
2 How do you plan your finances?
3 How do you think you can build a good credit record?
4 Have you ever experienced any financial difficulty in life? If so, what was the cause of it and how did you overcome it? If not, could you give any suggestion on how to manage money wisely?
5 Do you think the impact of the global economic crisis is distant from college students? Why?

Step 2 **Do the interview.**

Step 3 **Work in groups again. Summarize and analyze the information you have collected and prepare a report which includes:**

- People you interviewed
- Questions you asked
- Analysis of the responses you obtained
- Your thoughts and suggestions on how to improve students' finances

Step 4 **Present your report to the class.**